THE OFFICIAL ART BOOK OF

# ZERO-SUM: OMEN

DRAFT LAYOUT · v1.0





# FOREWORD

## Every number in this world is spinning. This book is about the people who live under them.

The Tally began as a question: what would a world look like if luck were a currency everyone could see? Our answer was a city that counts and a ring of lands that remember older ways of counting: thread, karma, contracts and books of the dead.

We built every style from that history. The brass of the Basilica, the scrap of the Remainder Wards, the gaudy charms of the street, the gold leaf of the fortunate few, and the painted, breathing lands beyond the gate.

*The Zero-Sum: Omen team*

**"A WORLD WITHOUT LUCK IS A WORLD WITHOUT LOSS."**

Comptroller Lucan Thale

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## A ledger of the Tally, as drawn so far.

Page numbers in the corner of each spread. Placeholder stamps mark pass-1 art kept for layout; colour-key and design-figure stamps mark the designed stand-ins.


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PART I

# FIXED ART SPEC

The numbers and rules every artist, modeller and animator works to (docs/ART_SPEC.md).

1. Registers, line, shading, colour
2. Scale and proportion
3. Cameras and the battle stage
4. Light by land
5. Faction costume keys

# ART SPEC · REGISTERS, LINE, SHADING, COLOUR

| REGISTER | FOR | LOOK |
|---|---|---|
| A · Concept / art book | Key art, store page, art book | Painterly semi-realistic concept art over 3D bases; human overpaint |
| B · In game | Gameplay, cutscenes, UI | Painted world (gouache backgrounds), inked people (flat cel, coloured lines) |

TURNAROUND STANDARD

- FRONT · LEFT · RIGHT · BACK, orthographic, one baseline, 1 m = 260 px
- Relaxed A-pose; props in their canon hand
- Every story outfit gets its own full turnaround
- Sheet extras: height bar, palette hex, canon locks, 64 px silhouette test

| ELEMENT | RULE |
|---|---|
| Outer contour | 4 px at 1080p for a 600 px-tall character (scale linearly); tapered at ends |
| Interior lines | 1.5–2 px; folds only where the cloth turns |
| Line colour | Coloured: local colour × 0.45 value, never pure black (except ink-black garments, which get `#3A2E3A`) |
| Shading | 2 tones + 1 rim. Shadow = local colour multiplied by the land's shadow tint (Meridian `#5E4F7A`, Hyakki `#2E3A6B`, River `#3E5A4A`, Śūnyapura `#6B4A5A`, Kroton `#4A5E7A`, Crossroads `#6A3E5A`, Basilica `#4A4A5A`) at 35%; one hard-edged shadow shape per form |
| Rim light | One rim from the background's key light colour, 2–4 px, on the side away from camera |
| Highlights | Hair and metal only; flat shapes, no gradients |
| Saturation | The signature colour is the most saturated thing on the character (Character Bible §0) |
| Palette | Max 4 main colours + 1 accent per character; NPCs 3 + 1 |
| Skin | Real, varied tones; never grey-shifted; flushed cheeks only for children and comedy |
| Eyes | Heroes: large, coloured iris, one hard catch-light; NPCs: smaller; keepers: calm, half-lidded |

# ART SPEC · SCALE AND PROPORTION

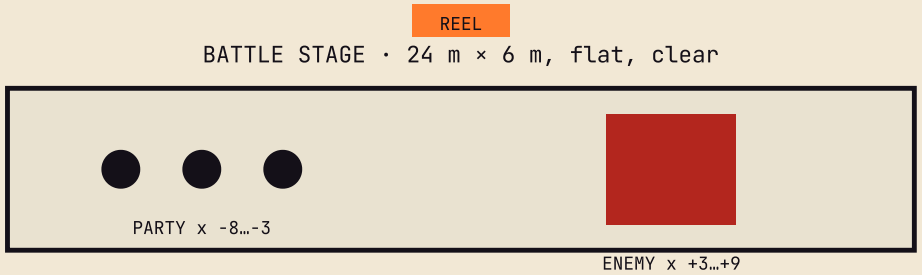
Heroes and secret recruits at one scale (1 m = 260 px in the model sheets). Adults are 7.5 heads tall; children 5–6; elders 6.5; bosses 8–9. Heights are canon locks.

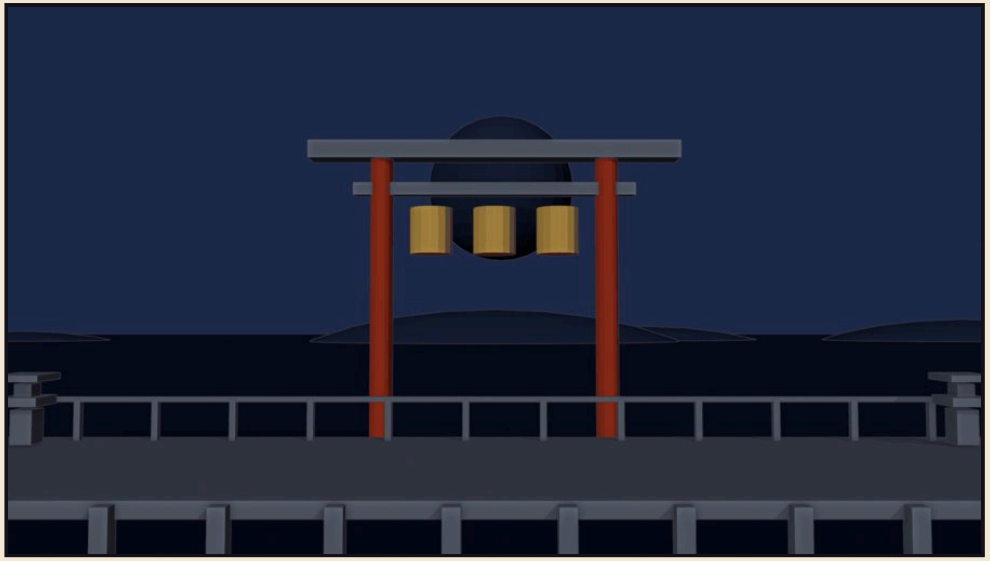



| CLASS | HEIGHT RANGE | SHOULDER WIDTH | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|
| Heroes | 1.35 (Hina) – 1.95 (Bai Si) | 0.20–0.27 | Each hero's height is a canon lock (Character Bible) |
| Children | 1.20–1.35 | 0.22–0.24 | Tobi, Niko, Penny, Little Lantern |
| Elders | 1.45–1.70 | 0.24–0.25 | Ofuku, Liu Shun, Vidya Rao |
| Heavies | 1.88–2.15 | 0.29–0.37 | Collectors, Varro, Ox-Head and Horse-Face |
| Bosses | 1.8–2.5 | by design | Rahu & Ketu and Jin Chan use special bodies |

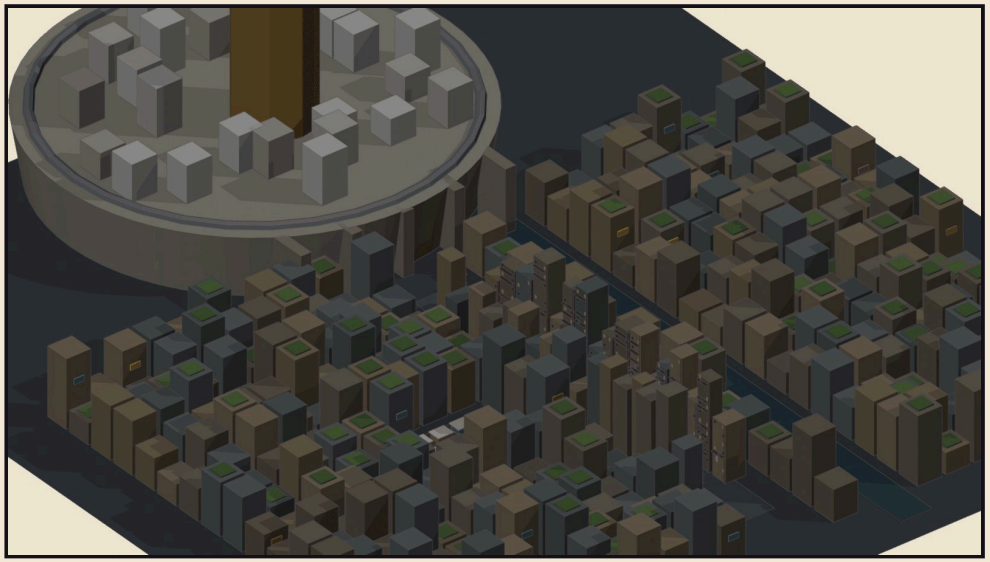
# ART SPEC · CAMERAS AND THE STAGE

| CAMERA | PROJECTION | ANGLE | USE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Battle (front view)** | Perspective, 30 mm (≈ 40° vertical FOV) | Eye at 1.7–3.2 m, 17 m from the stage line, pitch 0–5° | All fights; side-on |
| **Exploration (2.5D)** | Orthographic | Pitch 57° down, yaw –38° | Map, towns, overworld |
| **Plan (top-down)** | Orthographic | Straight down | Level design, minimap, art book plans |
| **Cinematic** | Perspective, 18–85 mm | Free | Cutscenes; respect the 180° rule toward the reel |



BATTLE · FRONT VIEW



EXPLORATION · 2.5D



# ART SPEC · LIGHT BY LAND · FACTION COSTUME KEYS

| LAND | TIME | KEY LIGHT | FILL / AMBIENT | ATMOSPHERE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Meridian Undercity** | Rainy dawn / dusk | Window amber + Nixie signage | Wet slate blue | Rain, haze, wet ground |
| **Hyakki** | Summer night, full moon | Lantern gold | Indigo moonlight | Mist over water, fireflies |
| **River Empire** | Golden afternoon (harbor) / misty dark (Courts) | Low sun | Jade bounce | Incense, lantern smoke |
| **Śūnyapura** | Monsoon break | Sun through cloud | Wet sandstone bounce | Rain sheets, puddle mirrors |
| **Kroton Nova** | Hard noon | White sun | Aegean sky blue | Heat haze, sharp shadows |
| **Crossroads** | Sunset → neon night | Sunset orange / neon | Dusk violet | Dust, card storms |
| **Basilica** | Interior, no sun | Nixie amber | Brass bounce | Still air, motes |

| FACTION | BASE COLOURS | MATERIALS | MUST HAVE | NEVER |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Basilica** | Steel white, brass, olive | Enamel, brass, wool | Steel numerals; gear motifs | Glowing numbers |
| **Collectors** | Rust, gunmetal | Riveted leather, glass jars | Debt jars; peaked caps; masks for captains | Clean surfaces |
| **Charm Bazaar** | Magenta, sign yellow, cyan | Plastic, nylon, stickers | ≥ 3 cultures' charms worn at once | Matching outfits |
| **Remainder Wards** | Ash, old brass, moss | Patched cloth, scrap | A cracked tube on a cord | New clothes |
| **Yokai Courts** | Violet, vermilion, foxfire cyan | Silk, paper, lacquer | Fox ears / tails, paper charms | Neon |
| **Luck Exchange** | Jade, gold, lacquer red | Silk, gold leaf | Gold numerals; abacus motifs | Rust |
| **Ten Courts** | Ink black, rice paper, seal red | Lacquer, lamellar | Brushes, seals | Bright colour |
| **Observatory** | Indigo, saffron, brass | Cotton, mirror-work | Astrolabe pins | Steel |
| **Synod** | Bronze, chalk, Aegean | Bronze, linen | Sieve shields, prime glyphs | Composite numbers on gear |
| **The House** | Casino red, ivory, gold | Satin, felt | Cards, waistcoats | Dust |
| **Open Hand** | Road dust, gold mark | Homespun | Open-hand cord; a die | Badges |

PART II

# THE WORLD

How the Tally works: the god of luck, the logic of luck, the schools of power, the people, the money, the politics and the past (docs/WORLD_ENCYCLOPEDIA.md).

1. Hap, the god of luck
2. The logic of luck
3. The six schools of power
4. How people use power
5. History and timeline
6. Politics and power
7. How things operate
8. Jobs
9. Stores
10. Factions and their styles

# THE GOD OF LUCK · HAP



FRONT LEFT RIGHT BACK

## "Hap deals. People choose."

Hap is the Tally's one god of luck: the will inside chance. Hap never commands; it deals. Every land built its own way of talking to Hap, and those ways became the many ledgers. In TR 702 the Basilica's Even Hand engine closed around the god itself: the amber eye over Meridian is Hap's eye, caged. The Rounding shaves the god every dawn, and the shavings became NIL: the part of luck that refused to be counted.

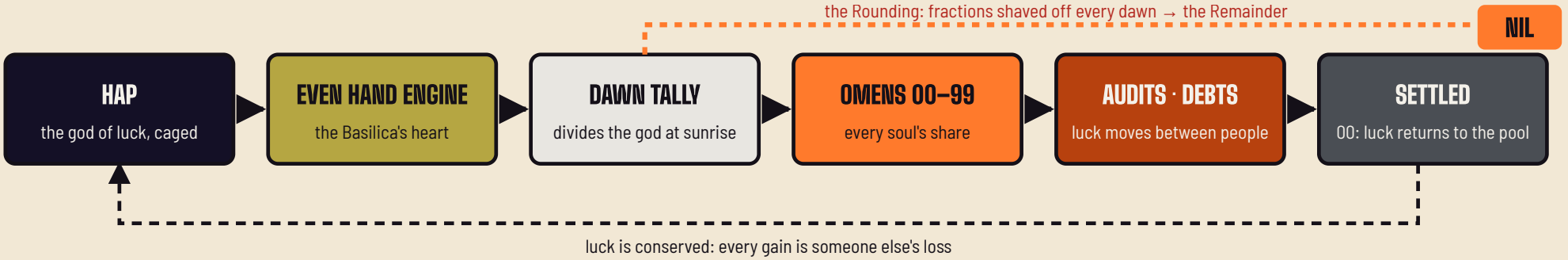
- Never the same face twice (each land's face, in its art style)
- Dice eyes and orbiting digits 0–9 never change
- Never a monster, a boss, or a stand-in for a real deity
- Speaks only in dreams, coincidences and the finale



The Open Hand: Hap's symbol

# THE LOGIC OF LUCK

| RULE | WHAT IT MEANS | CONSEQUENCE |
|---|---|---|
| 1. Luck is real and finite. | Luck is the substance Hap dealt into the world: the chance that things go your way. Under the Basilica it is conserved: the total never changes. | For your luck to rise, someone else's must fall. Every gain is a transfer. |
| 2. Every soul holds a share. | The Basilica divides the caged god into shares every dawn. Your share is your Omen, 00–99, floating over your head. | Everyone can see everyone's luck. It decides loans, jobs, marriages and how dangerous a staircase is for you today. |
| 3. Luck acts through numbers. | Luck resolves events by the digits they produce. A dropped coin, a dice roll, a door code, a clock time: each is a little lottery the world runs. Higher Omens tilt them. | Numbers are everywhere because numbers are where luck happens. |
| 4. Resonance. | At the Naming Rite (age seven) each soul states a lucky digit. That digit resonates: luck flows more easily through it. | People wear their digit, choose house numbers, wedding dates and jobs by it. |
| 5. Stopping. | Auditors can summon a Fate Wheel (a visible strip of the digits an event could produce) and stop it, choosing which digit the event takes. Skill and resonance decide how well. | This is the only "magic" in the world, and it's licensed (§3). |
| 6. Settlement. | At Omen 00 a soul is Settled: misfortune finds them within days and their remaining luck flows back to the pool. | Debt collectors drain Omens; a 01 is a death sentence with a short delay. |
| 7. The Rounding. | Every Dawn Tally rounds each share down to a whole number. The fractions vanish… into NIL. | Nobody noticed for three centuries. |
| 8. Noise. | Where the books don't balance, luck stops being dealt and starts boiling: Noise storms scramble numbers and spawn Noiselings. | The Deficit is growing; storms are more frequent every year. |



# HOW A FATE WHEEL WORKS

The in-world physics behind the one verb: stop the number.

**1**

An Audit begins when two Omens contest the same outcome (a fight, a deal, a debt).

**2**

Each Auditor's will draws a wheel of digits from the event. Faces are the possible outcomes; a face's width is its odds, shaped by the Auditor's Omen, resonance and tools (charms, enhanced faces).

**3**

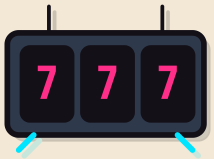
The tens of every strike are fixed by training and gear (tens are safe); the ones are fate and must be stopped (ones are fate).

**4**

Three stopped digits fall into the reel, the shared ledger of the moment. When the digits form a pattern, the world itself pays out: a Pair is a coincidence, a Jackpot a miracle, a Zero-Sum a perfectly balanced book that cancels the other side's next move.

**5**

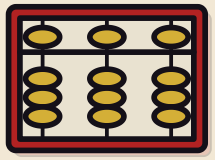
The loser's staked luck (Balance) drains toward the winner's side. Nobody dies in an Audit; they are rounded down, and may Settle later.



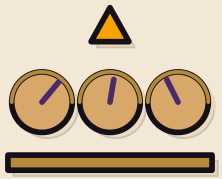

Neon sign




Torii with three lanterns



Golden abacus



Observatory dials

# THE SIX SCHOOLS OF POWER

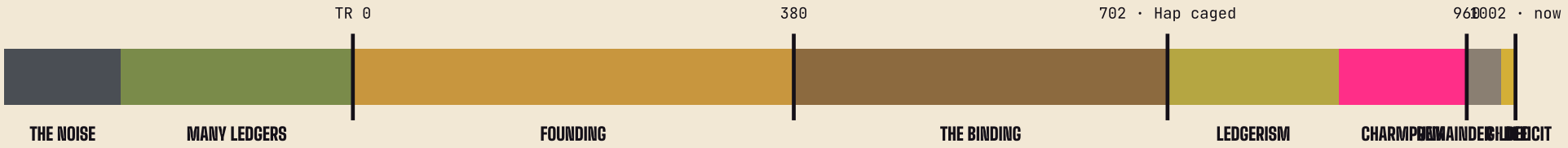
| SCHOOL | LAND | SOURCE OF POWER | HOW IT LOOKS | SIGNATURE TECHNIQUES | PRACTITIONERS |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Ledger Auditing (licensed)** | Meridian | Brass wrist-wheels that tap the Basilica's count | Steel numerals, Nixie amber light, ledger lines | Debt Jar (steal a reel digit), Seizure (freeze a face), Interest | Basilica Auditors, Collectors, Varro, Thale |
| **Shrine Binding** | Hyakki | Belief: charms, shrines and old objects with souls | Paper talismans, foxfire, ukiyo-e waves | Omamori wards, illusion faces (foxfire), tsukumogami awakening | Shrine keepers, yokai, Hina, Tamamo |
| **Brush Writing** | River Empire | The written word in the Book of Life and Death | Ink strokes, gold leaf, red seals | Ink (rewrite a digit), Interest (compounding), Oracle sticks | Judge Cui's clerks, Exchange brokers, Jinling, Bai Si |
| **Karma Weaving** | Śūnyapura | Deeds recorded and returned; zero as the place that holds everything | Geometric light, rangoli patterns, brass instruments | Karma (bank and spend), Place Value, eclipses | Observatory astronomers, Shunya, Rahu & Ketu |
| **Sieve Geometry** | Kroton Nova | Number properties: primes, ratios, the thread's measure | Marble, mosaic glyphs, white light through holes | Prime pierce, Sieve (strike out faces), Factor | Synod knights, Prima, Archon Seventeen |
| **Dealing** | Crossroads | Contracts: luck bought, borrowed and owed | Cards, neon, dust, the black book | Deals, Wagers, Loops | The Stranger, croupiers, Fibi, the House |
| **The Remainder (unique)** | — | The god's lost change | NaN glitches, orange digits that refuse to round | Splice, Carry, Divide by Zero | NIL only |

Licensing: since TR 760 only Ledger Auditing is licensed. Every other school is folk practice: tolerated at home, illegal in Meridian unless registered.

## HOW PEOPLE USE POWER

| USE | WHO | HOW |
|---|---|---|
| **Protection** | Everyone | Charms widen good faces a little for everyday lotteries (slips, accidents, exams). Weak everywhere, strongest in their home land. |
| **Lending luck** | Luck banks, the Exchange | Lend Omen points at interest; repayments are drained at dawn by licensed Auditors. |
| **Insurance** | Insurers (Meridian) | Pool many small Omens to cover one big misfortune; premiums are paid in luck-ins. |
| **Law** | Courts | Disputes between Omens are settled by Audit under a magistrate (a formal, non-lethal duel). |
| **Medicine** | Clinics | Doctors can't create luck, but Omen clinics move luck from donors to the critically ill ("luck transfusion"), for a price. |
| **Work** | Trades | Builders, pilots and miners need high Omens for safety; low Omens are pushed into dangerous jobs, which is how the Remainder Wards grew. |
| **Games** | Casinos, festivals | Legal small Audits for show; big Audits for money are illegal in Meridian, legal in Lucky Strike. |
| **Faith** | Temples, shrines, the outlawed Open Hand | Offerings ask for a land's way of luck; the Open Hand leaves a die in an open palm for Hap. |

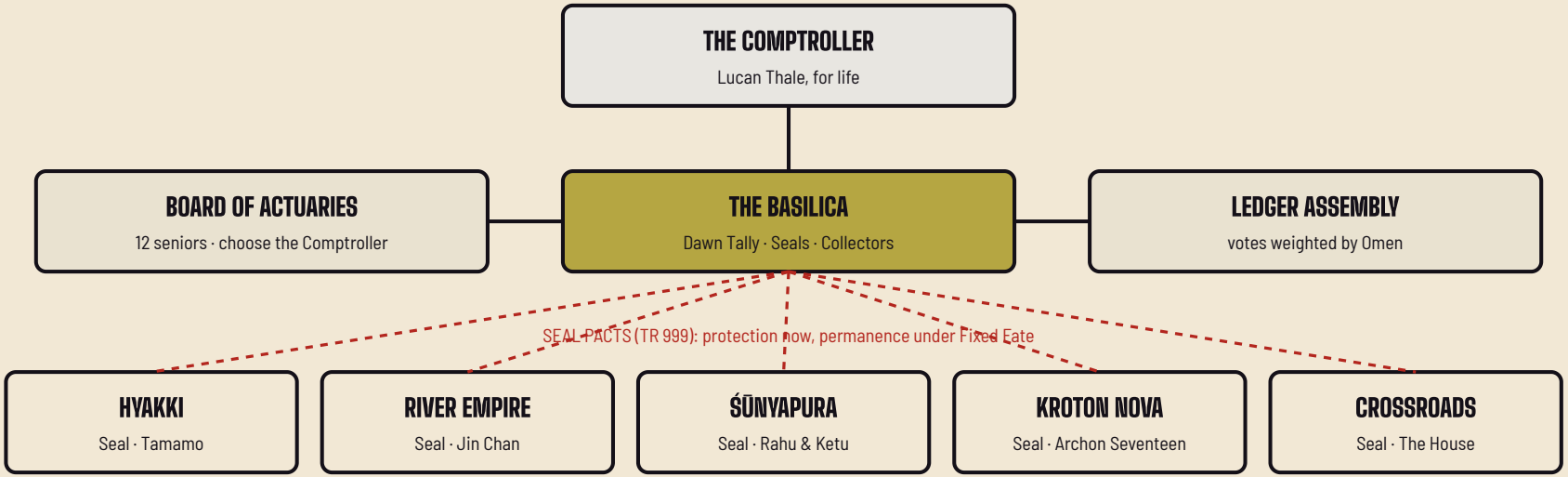
# HISTORY AND TIMELINE




| WHEN | ERA | EVENT |
|---|---|---|
| Before reckoning | The Noise | Hap deals freely; nobody keeps accounts. Fortune moves like weather. |
| Ancient | The Many Ledgers | Each people learns to talk to Hap: the Moirai's thread (Kroton Nova), Chitragupta's records (Śūnyapura), the Book of Life and Death (River Empire), Enma's ledger (Hyakki), the black book (Crossroads). |
| ~1,000 years before TR | | Zero formalised in Śūnyapura; place value travels the trade roads. |
| TR 0 | Founding | Meridian founded as a trading town at the crossroads of the Tally. |
| TR 120 | | The first Charm Bazaar: every caravan's charms on one street. |
| TR 380–690 | The Binding | Meridian's actuaries copy, buy or seize each land's ledger. |
| TR 512 | | Kroton Nova's thread is "borrowed" for a century; the Synod hardens. |
| TR 640 | | The Exchange opens in Bāfā Harbor under Meridian charter. |
| TR 702 | The Basilica | The engine completed; the Final Binding cages Hap; the first Dawn Tally; the Rounding begins. Worship of Hap outlawed in Meridian. |
| TR 760 → | Ledgerism | Brass-and-steel style; Auditing licensed; the Collectors founded. |

| WHEN | ERA | EVENT |
|---|---|---|
| TR 850 → | Charmpunk | Immigrant quarters fill Meridian; every culture's charms on one door. |
| TR 911 | | The Lucky Strike casino opens on Basilica money; the House's first deal. |
| TR 960 → | Remainder | A storm destroys Lucan Thale's street (he is 12); the Undercity fills with low Omens. |
| TR 962 | The Deficit | Śūnyapura's observatory first measures the leak. Noise storms begin. |
| TR 985 | | Thale becomes Comptroller. |
| TR 990 → | Gilded Fortune | The 99s flaunt gold leaf, jade and gardens. |
| TR 999 | | Thale proves the Rounding, finds Hap in the engine, drafts the Final Audit, signs the Seal pacts. |
| TR 1001 | | Varro Kade becomes a Collector. The Ghost Train's loop count reaches 1,596. |
| TR 1002 | Now | NIL wakes in Rain Alley 9. REMAINDER DETECTED. The game begins. |
| TR 1002 (finale) | The Open Hand | Depends on the ending: Balance, Overflow, Positive-Sum or Divide by Zero. |

# POLITICS AND POWER




| LAND | WHO RULES | THE BASILICA'S GRIP | WHAT THE PACT PROMISED |
|---|---|---|---|
| Meridian | The Comptroller; the Board; the Assembly | Total | Order |
| Hyakki | The Yokai Courts with human village councils | Toll gates on shrine roads; Collectors in harbours | Yokai never fade (Tamamo) |
| River Empire | The Chancellor of the Exchange (de facto); the Ten Courts below | The Exchange is half a Basilica office | Jin Chan's bank holds the frozen luck |
| Śūnyapura | City council of scholars and guilds; the Observatory | Surveyors rewriting measurements | Rahu & Ketu made whole |
| Kroton Nova | The Pythagorean Synod (the Archon) | The Sieve "accelerated" | Purity |
| Crossroads | The House (by money), the sheriff (by law) | Basilica finance | The night never ends |

Luck is wealth, health and safety at once, so whoever controls the count controls everything. The game's politics is unmasking that.

# HOW THINGS OPERATE

## Money

Two currencies: **fen (small coins of brass, everyday trade across the Tally) and luck** itself (Omen points, traded at the Exchange and lent by banks). Prices are posted in fen; luck is for big things (loans, licences, medicine).

## Law

Disputes go to an **Audit court**: a magistrate oversees a formal Audit between the parties' Auditors (or themselves). Crimes are punished in luck (Omen fines) or time. The death penalty doesn't exist; Settlement does the work, which is worse.

## Transport

Meridian: cliff lifts and stairs between the Undercity and the plateau (lift fares are by Omen: the lower your number, the higher the fare, "for safety"). Between lands: ferries (Hyakki), river junks (River Empire), rail (Crossroads), the monsoon road (Śūnyapura), the Aegean packet boats (Kroton Nova).

## Education

Children learn their digit's meaning before the Naming Rite at seven; the Basilica's schools teach arithmetic as morality.

## The day

The **Dawn Tally** at sunrise recomputes every Omen (a beam sweeps each city; clocks strike 0). Debts are drained in the hour after. Markets open at the second bell.

## Health

Omen clinics transfuse luck; doctors still heal bodies. The poor sell luck-ins to pay for medicine and then need more medicine.

## Media

Omen boards in squares; the *Daily Tally* broadsheet (every Omen change of note); radio plays in the Crossroads; street criers in Bāfā.

## Architecture rule

Floors 4, 9 and 13 are skipped in lifts; buildings face east for the Dawn Tally; the Basilica's eye is visible from every street in Meridian (a planning law).

# JOBS IN THE TALLY

| JOB | WHERE | WHAT THEY DO | TYPICAL OMEN | TOOLS / LOOK |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Auditor** | Everywhere (licensed in Meridian) | Stops Fate Wheels in disputes, debts and duels | 50–90 | Wrist-wheel, field coat |
| **Collector** | Meridian | Drains debts at dawn; hunts bounties | 40–60 | Debt jars, rust armour |
| **Actuary** | Basilica | Computes the Dawn Tally; the Basilica's mathematicians (NIL's coat is an actuary's) | 50 | Ledgers, slide rules |
| **Ledger-priest** | Basilica | Performs the Dawn Tally and the Naming Rite | 50 (steel) | Mitre, chained ledger |
| **Dawn-bell ringer** | Meridian | Rings the bells that start the Tally; the city's clocks strike 0 | 30–60 | Bell ropes |
| **Nixie-tuber** | Meridian | Repairs the Nixie tubes that display Omens and signs | 20–50 | Glass, wire, gloves |
| **Charm-smith** | Bazaar, everywhere | Makes and repairs charms from every culture | 20–70 | Forge, anvil (Maeve) |
| **Luck-broker** | Exchange | Trades Omen points like shares | 70–99 | Abacus, ticker |
| **Pawnbroker of luck** | River Empire, Meridian | Lends against charms and future luck | 60–90 | Ledgers, safes (Jinling) |
| **Omen clinician** | Meridian, River Empire | Luck transfusion from donor to patient | 60–80 | Brass cannulas, Nixie meters |
| **Insurer** | Meridian | Pools luck against misfortune | 70+ | Contracts |

## JOBS IN THE TALLY (CONT.)

| JOB | WHERE | WHAT THEY DO | TYPICAL OMEN | TOOLS / LOOK |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Shrine keeper | Hyakki | Keeps shrines, paints daruma eyes, sells omamori | any | Brush, charms (Ofuku) |
| Ferryman | Hyakki | Carries travellers between the islands | any | Oar (Tetsu) |
| Oracle-stick reader | River Empire temples | Reads the fortune sticks | any | Cylinders, poem books |
| Astronomer | Śūnyapura | Measures the sky and the Deficit | any | Astrolabes (Shunya) |
| Stepwell diver | Śūnyapura | Recovers what falls into the wells | any | Rope, lamp (Meera) |
| Synod knight | Kroton Nova | Guards the Sieve | prime | Sieve shield |
| Croupier / dealer | Crossroads | Runs legal Audits for money | any | Cards (Fibi) |
| Sheriff | Crossroads | Keeps the peace in the loop | any | Badge (Vance) |
| Luck-in seller | Remainder Wards | Sells single Omen points for food | 01–10 | Nothing left to sell |
| Rounding-sweeper (urban legend) | Meridian | Said to sweep up dropped fractions at dawn; nobody has seen one | — | A broom made of digits |

# STORES AND SERVICES

| STORE | LAND | WHAT IT SELLS | SIGN | IN PLAY |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Charm stall | Meridian (Bazaar) | Every culture's charms | Hand-painted lucky number + a charm silhouette | Markets (charms) |
| Luck pawnshop | River Empire, Meridian | Loans against charms or future luck | Three gold coins on a red board | Markets (fen, Deals later) |
| Omen clinic | Meridian | Luck transfusions, Omen checks | White cross made of two 1s | Story; healing at a price |
| Nixie repair | Meridian | Tubes for Omen displays and signs | A glowing tube in the window | Face enhancements |
| Forge | Meridian (Celtic quarter), Kroton | Charm upgrades, horseshoes | An anvil with a clover | Forge nodes (Maeve) |
| Noodle stall | Everywhere | Food priced in sevens and eights | Steam and a number | Rest (Teahouse/Campfire) |
| Teahouse | Hyakki, River Empire | Tea, gossip, a place to rest the party | Paper lantern with a digit | Teahouse nodes |
| Shrine | Hyakki, Śūnyapura | Omamori, daruma, offerings | Torii / temple bell | Shrine nodes |
| Oracle-stick temple | River Empire | Fortune sticks | Smoke and a cylinder | Oracle sticks |
| Gem bazaar | Śūnyapura | The nine planetary gems | Nine coloured lamps | Navaratna gems |
| Agora stalls | Kroton Nova | Gems, wheel crafting at a "prime discount" | Prime numerals on marble | Markets |
| Casino / card room | Crossroads | Legal Audits for money | Neon dice | Wagers |
| Motel | Crossroads | Rooms on Route 7 | "VACANCY" with the C burnt out | Campfire nodes |
| Open Hand shrine | Everywhere | Nothing: a stone hand and a die | An open palm carved in stone | Open Hand nodes |

FACTION

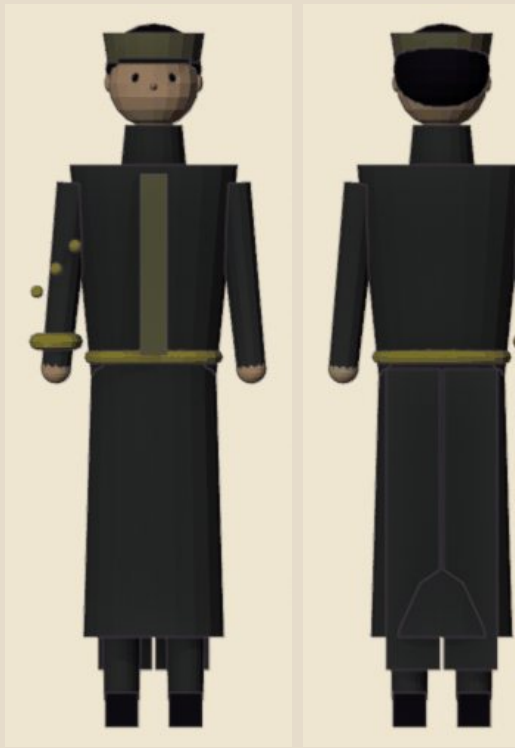
# The Basilica

| Steel white | Brass | Olive | Nixie |
|---|---|---|---|
| #E8E6E1 | #B5A642 | #6E6B4E | #FF7A2C |

| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Meridian |
| WANTS | Order; the Final Audit |
| POWER | Ledger Auditing; the Dawn Tally |
| STYLE | Ledgerism: brass, steel, white enamel, cathedral arches; steel numerals |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | White-and-brass vestments, gear-crested mitres (priests); olive field coats (Auditors) |
| RANKS | Comptroller → Ledger-priests → Senior Auditors → Clerks → Novices |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | Wrist-wheels, chained ledgers, Seal stamps |



Ledger-priest



Basilica Auditor

FACTION

# The Collectors

| Rust | Gunmetal | Debt glow | Bone |
|---|---|---|---|
| #B7410E | #4A4E54 | #FF7A2C | #E3DCCB |

| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Meridian |
| WANTS | Debts paid; bounties |
| POWER | Licensed debt Auditing |
| STYLE | Rust armour, gunmetal, glass debt jars with orange glow |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | Rust trench armour, peaked caps, hound-skull masks for captains |
| RANKS | Chief Collector → Captain (masked) → Collector → Hound handler |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | Debt jars, chains, Debt Hounds |



Collector



Varro Kade, the Ledgerhound

FACTION

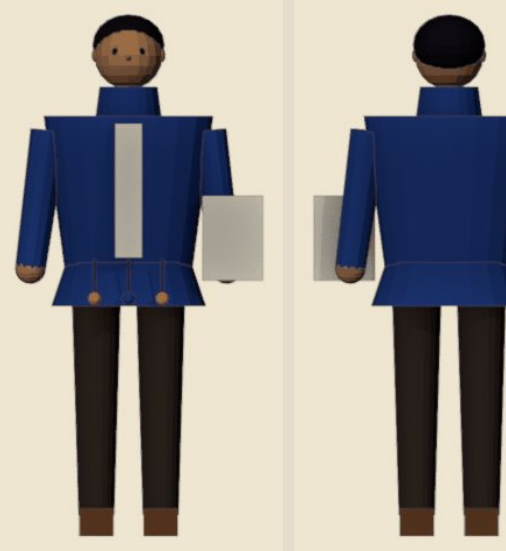
# 7 Charm Bazaar guilds

| Magenta | Sign yellow | Cyan | Clover |
|---|---|---|---|
| #FF2E88 | #F5E400 | #00E5FF | #3BB273 |

| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Meridian |
| WANTS | Trade, survival, folk luck |
| POWER | Charm-smithing (every culture's) |
| STYLE | Charmpunk: plastic gold, neon, stickers, every culture at once |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | Puffer jackets hung with charms; painted numbers; fake holo-halos |
| RANKS | Guild masters → stallholders → runners |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | Charms, Nixie pendants, forged horseshoes |



Charm Bazaar local



Gus Mendoza

FACTION

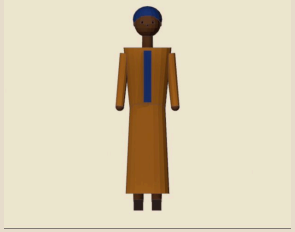
# The Remainder Wards (not a faction: a people)

| Ash | Old brass | Moss | Leather |
|---|---|---|---|
| #8A7F72 | #C8963E | #5E7D4A | #6B4226 |

| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Meridian Undercity |
| WANTS | To get through the week |
| POWER | Mutual aid; luck-ins |
| STYLE | Remainder: scrap brass, patched cloth, salvaged Nixie tubes, rope |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | Ponchos, patched coats, a cracked tube on a cord instead of a glowing Omen |
| RANKS | Elders, block captains |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | Tools, salvage |



Wards mechanic



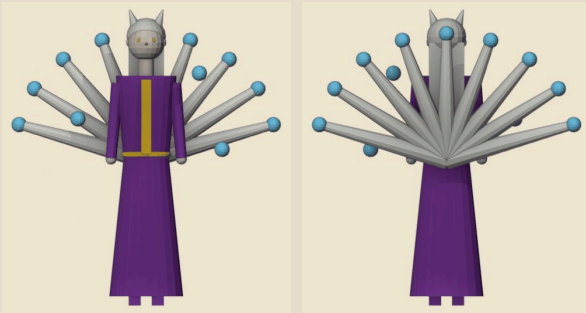
Ama Okoro

FACTION

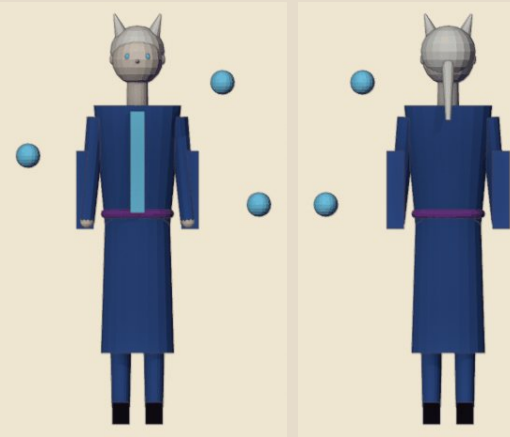
# The Yokai Courts

| Violet | Vermilion | Foxfire | Gold |
|---|---|---|---|
| #8E44AD | #E34234 | #7FDBFF | #F4C430 |

| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Hyakki |
| WANTS | To keep existing |
| POWER | Shrine Binding; belief |
| STYLE | Ukiyo-e flatness, vermilion, foxfire cyan-violet, paper and lacquer |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | Court robes, fox ears and tails for kitsune; tsukumogami are their objects |
| RANKS | Tamamo → kitsune retainers → yokai of every kind |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | Foxfire, illusion faces |



Tamamo, the Nine-Tailed Auditor



Ao (Kitsune twin)

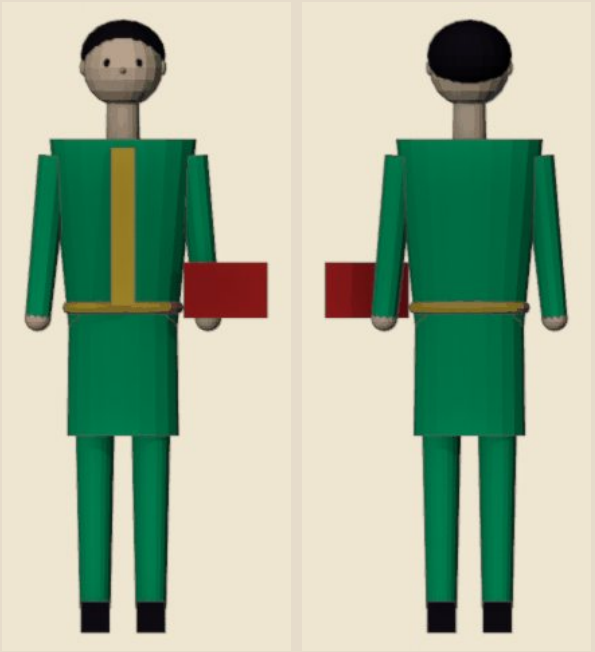
FACTION



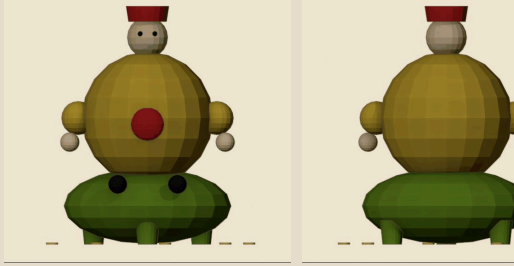
# The Luck Exchange

| Jade | Gold | Lacquer | Paper |
|---|---|---|---|
| #00A86B | #D4AF37 | #B22222 | #E9E2D0 |

| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Bāfā Harbor |
| WANTS | Profit |
| POWER | Brush Writing for contracts; interest |
| STYLE | Gilded Fortune: jade, gold leaf, red lacquer, live price boards |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | Jade mandarin-collar suits, gold trim, pocket abacus, ear tickers |
| RANKS | Chancellor → Directors → Brokers → Runners |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | Abacus fans, contracts, Debt Junks |



Exchange Broker



Chancellor Jin Chan

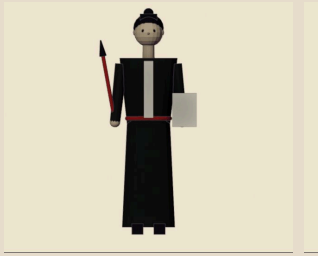
FACTION



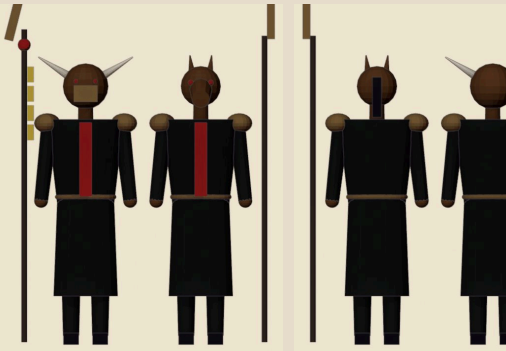
# The Ten Courts (keepers)

| Ink | Rice paper | Seal red | Bronze |
|---|---|---|---|
| #1B1B1B | #E9E2D0 | #B22222 | #8C6A3F |

| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Under the River Empire |
| WANTS | The true count of the dead |
| POWER | Brush Writing on the Book |
| STYLE | Ink-wash, rice paper, red seals; near silence |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | Black official robes; wardens in lamellar armour (Ox-Head, Horse-Face) |
| RANKS | Judges → wardens → clerks → executioner (Bai Si) |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | The Brush, the Book, halberds |



Judge Cui



Ox-Head and Horse-Face

FACTION

# The Observatory

| Indigo | Saffron | Brass | Sandstone |
|---|---|---|---|
| #3F3D99 | #F4A300 | #B5893B | #D8A86B |

| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Śūnyapura |
| WANTS | Truth by measurement |
| POWER | Karma Weaving; astronomy |
| STYLE | Sandstone, brass instruments, saffron and indigo, mirror-work |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | Layered indigo-and-saffron, brass astrolabe pins |
| RANKS | Acharya → astronomers → students |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | Astrolabes, dials, palm-leaf records |



Acharya Vidya Rao



Shunya

FACTION

# The Pythagorean Synod

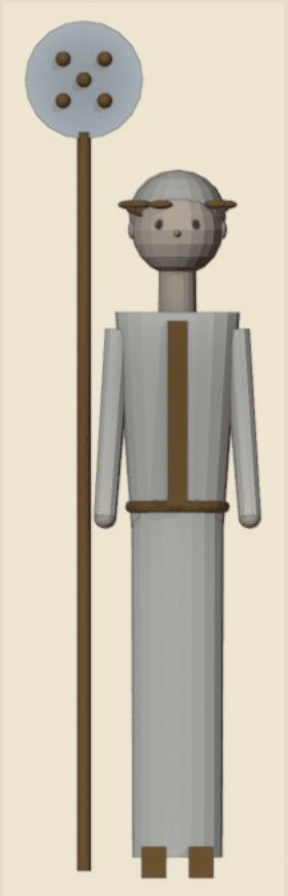
| Bronze | Chalk | Aegean | Olive |
|---|---|---|---|
| #8C6A3F | #F4F1EA | #1F6FB2 | #7A8B4A |

| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Kroton Nova |
| WANTS | Purity of number |
| POWER | Sieve Geometry |
| STYLE | White marble, bronze, Aegean blue, mosaic glyphs |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | Bronze cuirass, chalk tunic, sieve shields |
| RANKS | Archon → Synod elders → knights → novices |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | Sieve shields, prime glyphs |





Composite Knight





Archon Seventeen

FACTION

# The House

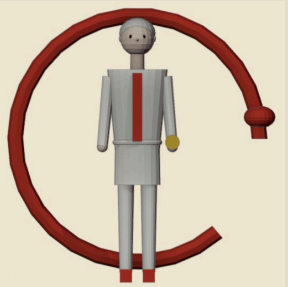
| Casino red | Ivory | Gold | Midnight |
|---|---|---|---|
| #C0392B | #F4F1EA | #D4AF37 | #1D1A3A |

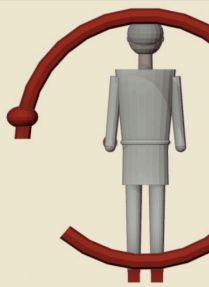
| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Lucky Strike |
| WANTS | The night never ending |
| POWER | Dealing; the loop |
| STYLE | Casino red, ivory, gold, desert neon |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | Red waistcoats, sleeve garters, green-felt trays |
| RANKS | The House → floor bosses → dealers |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | Marked decks, Wagers, the loop |





House dealer





The House, Octavian Nine

FACTION

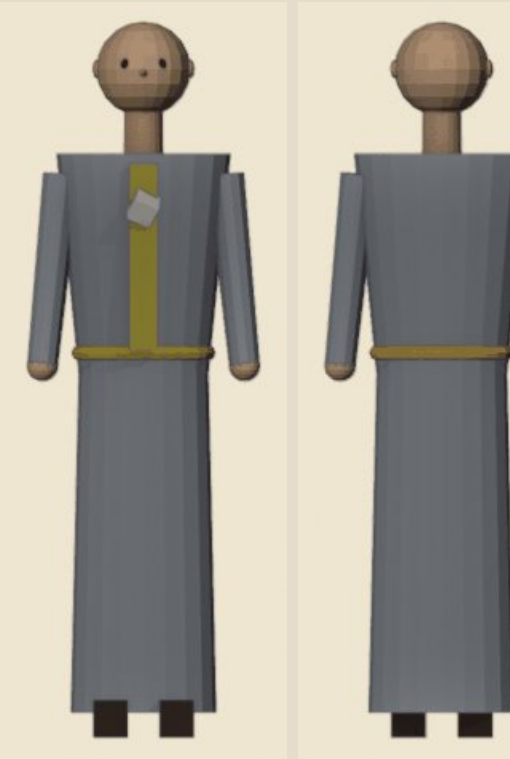
# The Open Hand (outlawed)

| Road dust | Open Hand gold | Homespun | Ink |
|---|---|---|---|
| #B9A58A | #D4AF37 | #8C6A3F | #141018 |

| | |
|---|---|
| SEAT | Everywhere, quietly |
| WANTS | To free Hap; second chances for all |
| POWER | Prayer; coincidence |
| STYLE | Road dust, plain cloth, one gold open-hand mark |
| UNIFORM / LOOK | Travelling cloaks, a carved open hand on a cord, a smooth die |
| RANKS | No ranks: "hands" |
| TOOLS AND WEAPONS | Dice, shrines, safe houses |



Open Hand pilgrim



Brother Nought

STYLES

# THE FOUR ERAS OF LUCK

Meridian's styles come from its history: the binding of the ledgers, the Rounding, the Deficit. Every street mixes them; every outfit tells you which side of the Zero-Sum Law its owner lives on.

**TR 702**
Basilica completed

**TR 760→**
Ledgerism

**TR 850→**
Charmpunk

**TR 960→**
Remainder

**TR 990→**
Gilded Fortune

**TR 1002**
Today



# CHARMPUNK

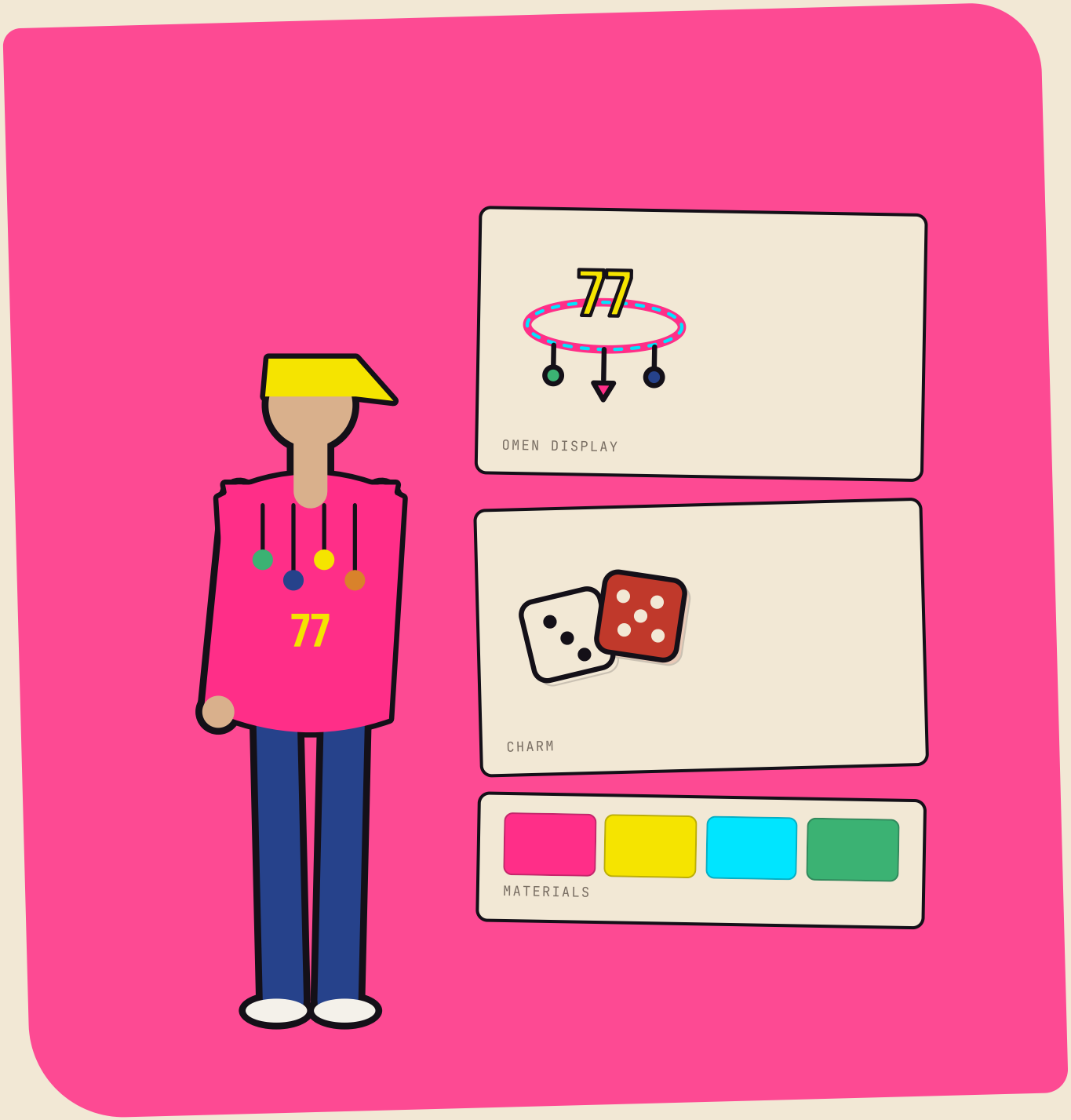
## → LUCK OVER SENSE ←

TR 850→

The street's lingua franca. Every culture's charms worn at once, hand-painted lucky numbers, plastic gold and neon. Charmpunk is loud because luck is a performance: if you can't raise your Omen, you can at least look like you're winning.

**ART NEEDED · CHARMPUNK keyframe**

- Line-up of 6 Bazaar locals in Charmpunk
- Keyframe: the Charm Bazaar at night, every stall a different culture
- Omen display: gaudy holo-halos, fake Omen projectors



# REMAINDER

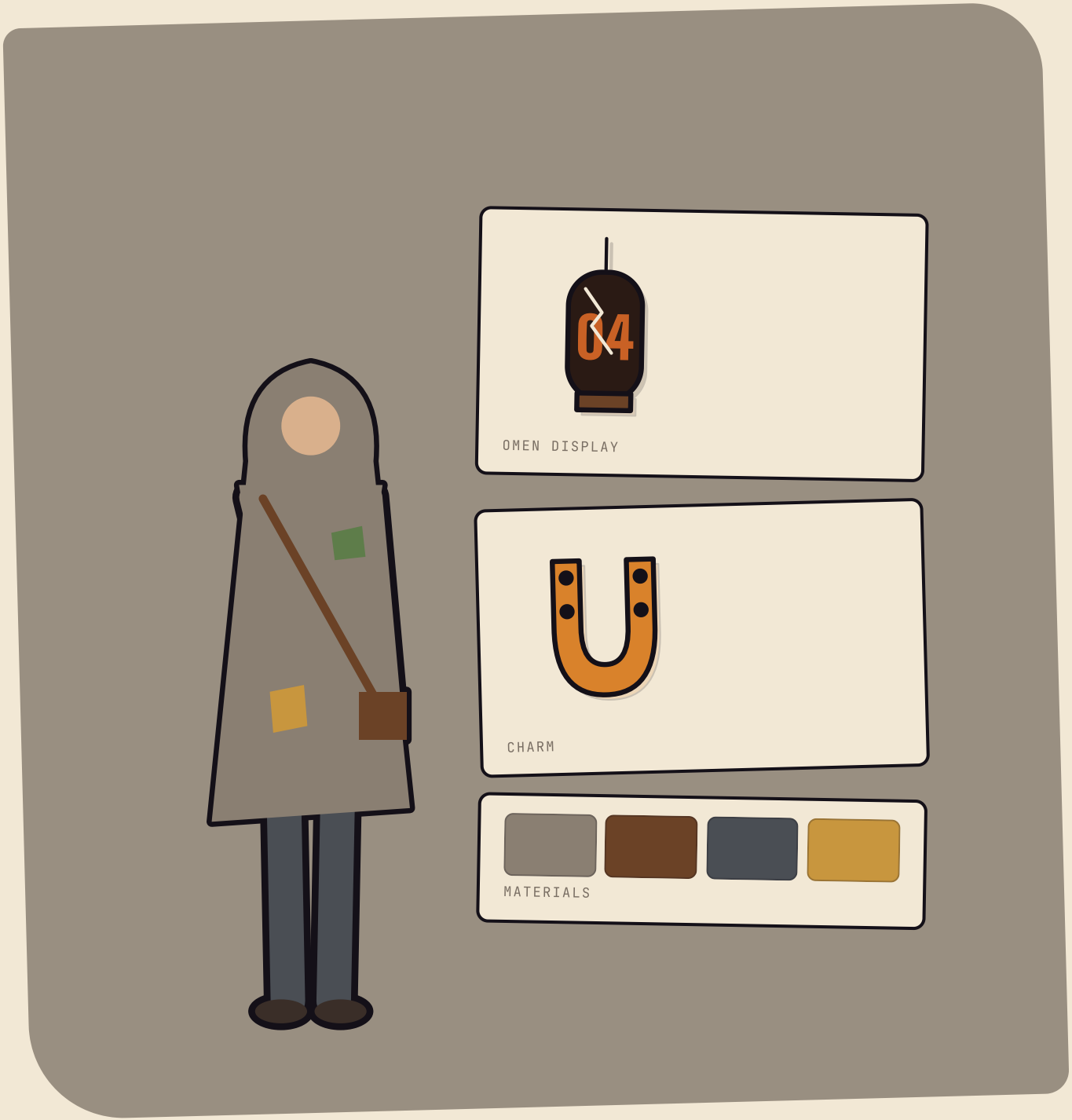
## → SURVIVAL OVER LUCK ←

TR 960→

The style of the Undercity, where Omens run low. Scrap brass from old Basilica parts, patched cloth, salvaged Nixie tubes and rope. Durable, ugly, honest. People hide their numbers here out of shame.

**ART NEEDED · REMAINDER keyframe**

- Line-up: Remainder Wards residents (mechanic, cook, debt-ridden mother, kids)
- Environment: Rain Alley 9 at dawn
- Omen display: a cracked tube on a cord



# LEDGERISM

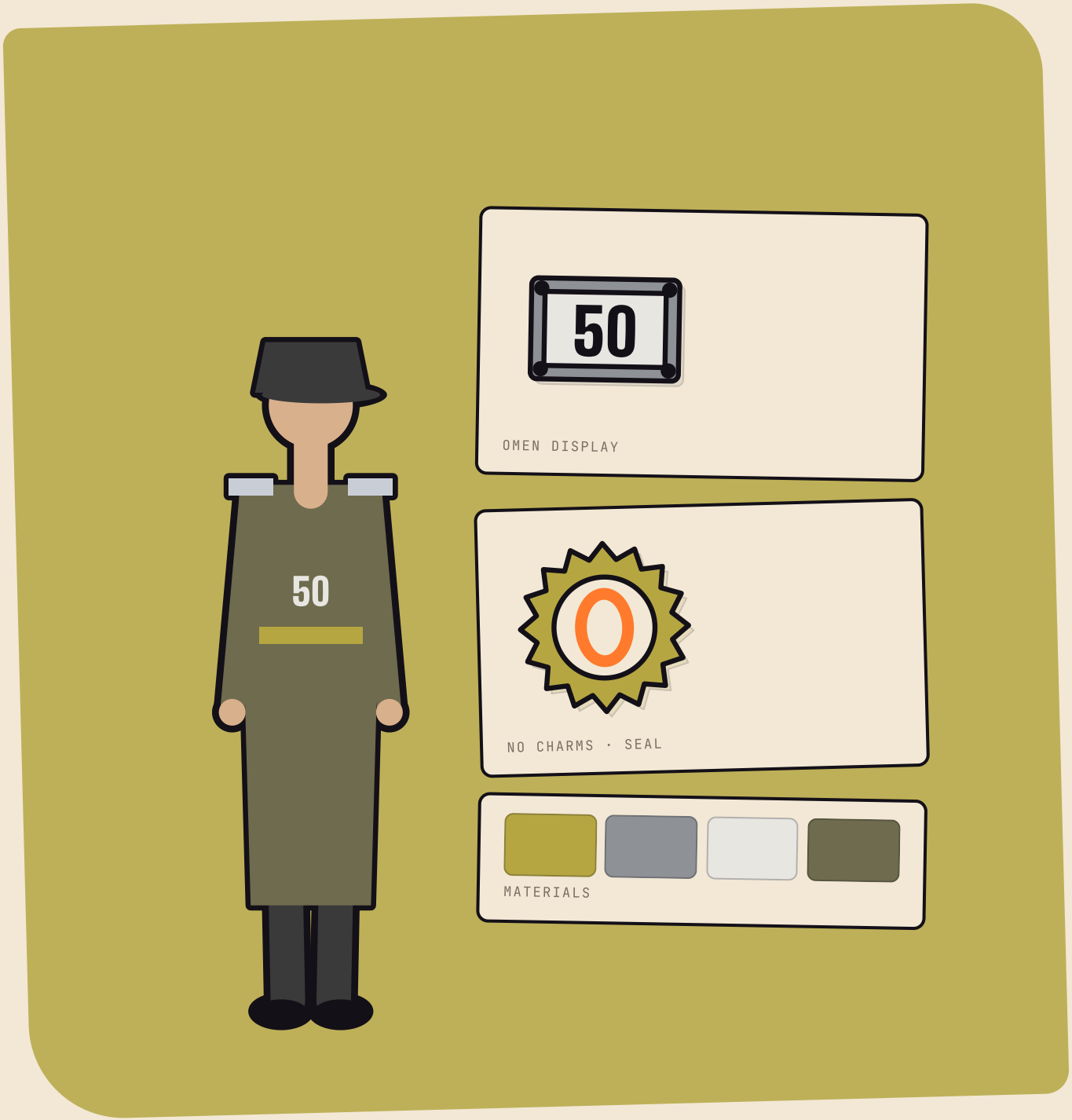
## → ORDER OVER CHANCE ←

TR 760→

The style of the Basilica and its servants. Brass, steel and white enamel; cathedral arches; clockwork; uniforms with stamped seals. Cold, formal and threatening, it says that chance has been abolished and you are being counted.

**ART NEEDED · LEDGERISM keyframe**

- Line-up: Collectors, Ledger-priests, Basilica clerks, Auditors
- Environment: the Basilica Ring checkpoint
- Omen display: steel numerals, never glowing



# GILDED FORTUNE

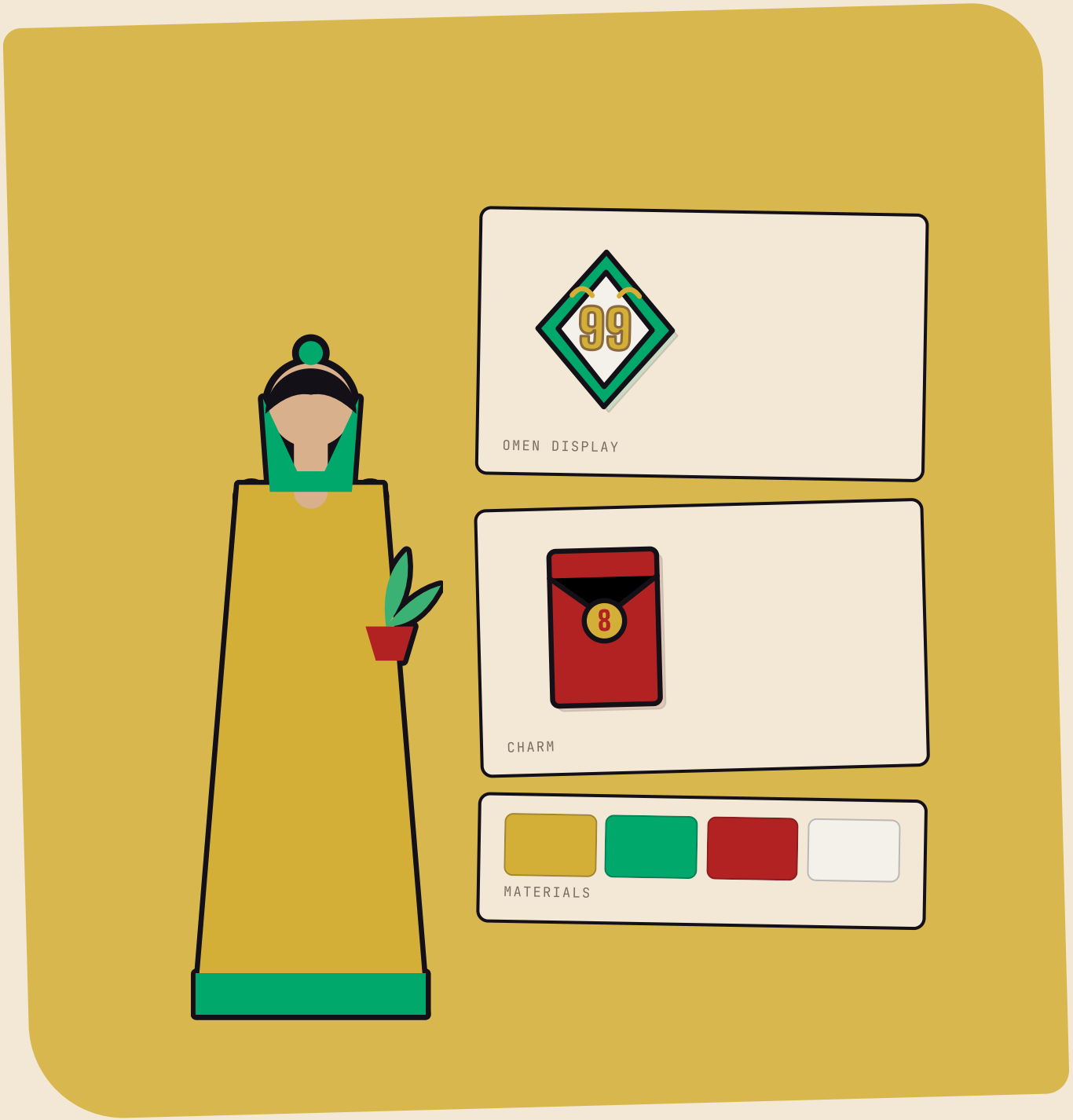
## → FORTUNE AND ORDER ←

TR 990→

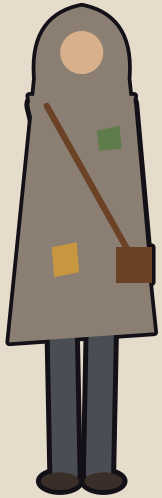
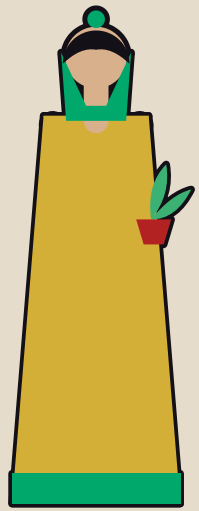
The style of the 99s: old money and Exchange magnates. Real gold leaf, jade, silk and living plants. In Meridian a garden is luck you can see; a bonsai on a balcony is a fortune worn in public.

**ART NEEDED · GILDED FORTUNE keyframe**

- Line-up: Exchange magnates, heirs, their guards
- Environment: the Exchange Terraces garden-villas
- Omen display: embroidered or gold-leaf numerals



# COMPARISON

| CHARMPUNK | REMAINDER | LEDGERISM | GILDED FORTUNE |
|---|---|---|---|
|   |  |   |  |
| Charm  | Charm  | Charm  | Charm   |
| Omen display   | Omen display   | Omen display   | Omen display   |
| LUCK OVER SENSE | SURVIVAL OVER LUCK | ORDER OVER CHANCE | FORTUNE AND ORDER |

The same three slots per era (a person, a charm, an Omen display), side by side so the eras read as one system. Design figures stand in until the painted comparison sheet (Art Book Production Guide §7, image 3).

# THE TALLY

A ring of lands around Meridian's plateau. The upper city is sealed, so to go up you must go around. Each land kept its own ledger of fate before the Basilica bound them all.

Red dotted line: the party's road, from Meridian's Undercity through five lands and back. The Upper Gate needs seven Seal Digits: 1 (Varro), 9, 8, 0, 2, 7, and the seventh is the player's own lucky number.

SEALED



PART III

# THE LANDS

Seven places, seven palettes. Every land: its colour-script opener, then its 3D blockout from above, in 2.5D and from the battle camera.

1. Meridian Undercity
2. Hyakki
3. The River Empire
4. Śūnyapura
5. Kroton Nova
6. The Crossroads Territory
7. The Basilica

# MERIDIAN UNDERCITY

Prologue · cosmopolitan capital · cyber-noir painted city

| | |
|---|---|
| ACT | Prologue |
| INSPIRED BY | a cosmopolitan modern capital; the immigrant quarters of every great port city. |
| LAW OF THE LAND | Debt: everyone owes luck |
| AUDITOR | Varro Kade, the Ledgerhound |
| ENEMIES | Debt Hounds · Collectors · Noiselings |
| LITTLE THINGS | charms of every culture over every door; laundry between tenements; balcony gardens (a garden is luck you can see); cats; hand-painted lucky numbers. |
| SOUND | rain, Nixie hum, distant Dawn Tally bells, street musicians, Collector sirens. |







00–99

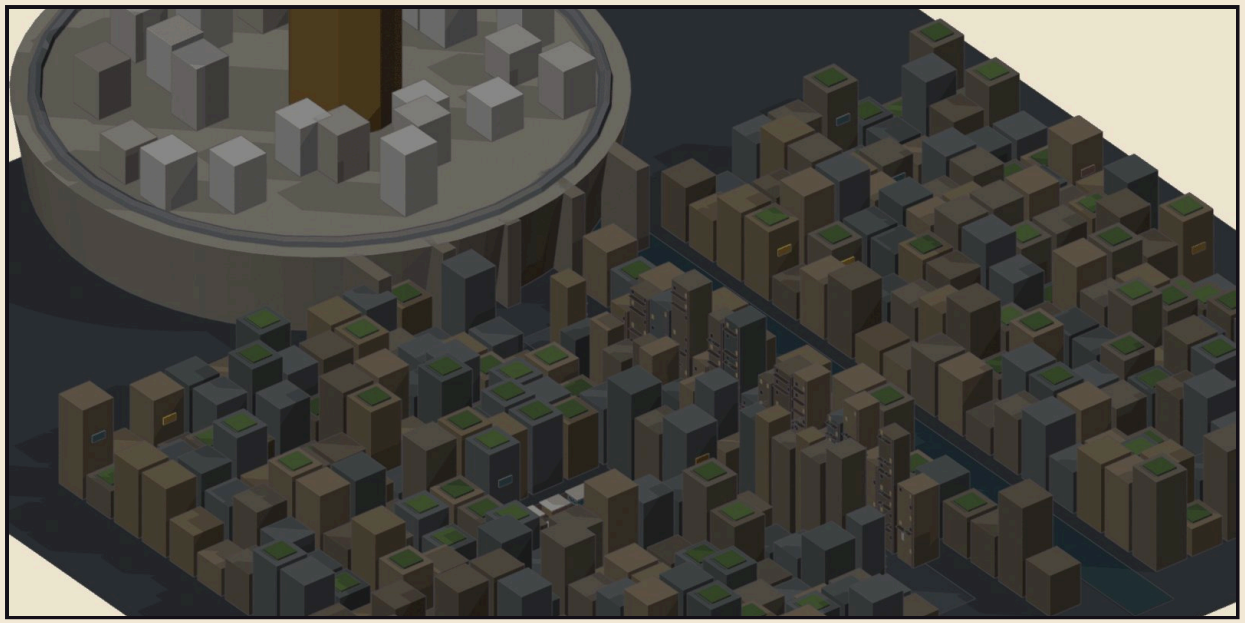
| Wet slate | Window amber | Moss | Nixie | Neon yellow | Neon magenta | Neon cyan |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| #2E3A4B | #E8A04B | #5E7D4A | #FF7A2C | #F5E400 | #FF2E88 | #00E5FF |

**ART NEEDED · Meridian Undercity paintings**

- Establishing: the Wards at dawn after rain, the Basilica's eye at the end of the street
- Battle stage: Rain Alley 9
- District keyframes: Charm Bazaar, Exchange Terraces, Basilica Ring

COLOUR SCRIPT

# MERIDIAN UNDERCITY · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

PROLOGUE · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

| | |
|---|---|
| TIME | Rainy dawn / dusk |
| KEY LIGHT | Window amber + Nixie signage |
| FILL | Wet slate blue |
| ATMOSPHERE | Rain, haze, wet ground |

First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

# MERIDIAN · REMAINDER WARDS

Stacked in the drains and cliffs beneath the plateau. The Wards began as workers' housing for the Basilica's builders and became the place where low Omens end up. Remainder scrap meets Charmpunk colour: every door wears a different culture's charm.

**What happened here:** the Rounding. Every fraction of luck dropped since TR 702 flowed downhill, and so did everyone who lost theirs.



# KEY · REMAINDER WARDS

Colour key over the 3D base: overcast dawn after rain. Slate, ochre and moss walls, warm windows, every culture's laundry, the brass Basilica at the end of the canyon. Nixie orange, magenta and cyan live only on the signs.

**Pipeline stage 1b · colour key.** Perspective, scale and light are solved in 3D first (see the pipeline page). Stage 2 paints over this; stage 3 is the artist's overpaint.

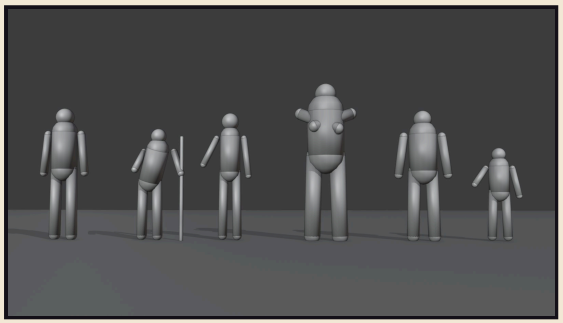


## LINE-UP · REMAINDER WARDS

Six locals, shoulder to shoulder, slightly low camera, over the district painting. Ages, builds and origins vary; every outfit is evidence of the Wards' economy.

**ART NEEDED · Remainder Wards line-up**

- Brass-scrap mechanic (Remainder)
- Grandmother with jade and evil-eye charms (Charmpunk)
- Teen dice-gambler (Charmpunk)
- Collector in rust armour (Ledgerism)
- Noodle cook with a lemon-and-chilli charm
- Kid with a cracked Nixie-tube necklace (Remainder)



3D BASE FOR THIS LINE-UP · STAGE 1

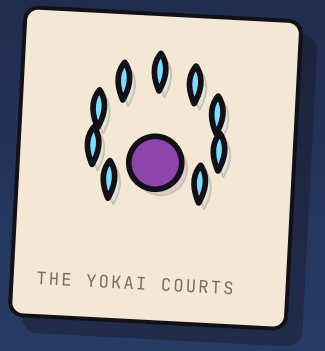


# HYAKKI

Act I · Japanese folklore · ukiyo-e + painted night

| | |
|---|---|
| ACT | Act I |
| INSPIRED BY | Japanese folklore (yokai, tsukumogami, the Seven Lucky Gods, Enma); ukiyo-e and Edo-period towns. |
| LAW OF THE LAND | The Rule of Shi and Ku: 4 and 9 are cursed; 7 is blessed |
| AUDITOR | Tamamo, the Nine-Tailed Auditor |
| KEEPER | Enma |
| ENEMIES | Kasa-obake · Chōchin-obake · Kappa · Oni enforcers |
| LITTLE THINGS | daruma dolls with one eye painted; beckoning cats; fireflies; wind chimes; one tired kappa selling cucumbers. |
| SOUND | shamisen, shakuhachi, taiko for battle, cicadas and wind chimes. |
| MERIDIAN INTRUSION | a Ledgerist toll gate on the shrine road; Collectors in the harbour. |



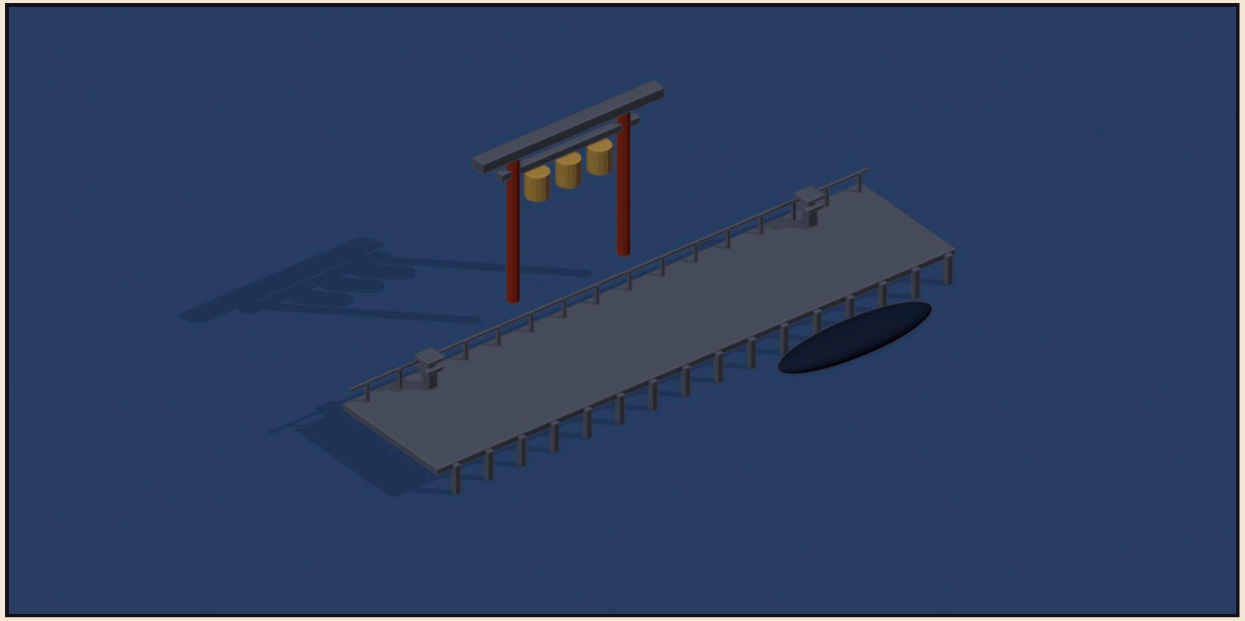

| Indigo | Ink blue | Paper | Vermilion | Lantern gold | Firefly |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| #1B2440 | #2E4A7A | #F2E6C9 | #E34234 | #F2B33D | #9BD15A |

**ART NEEDED · Hyakki paintings**

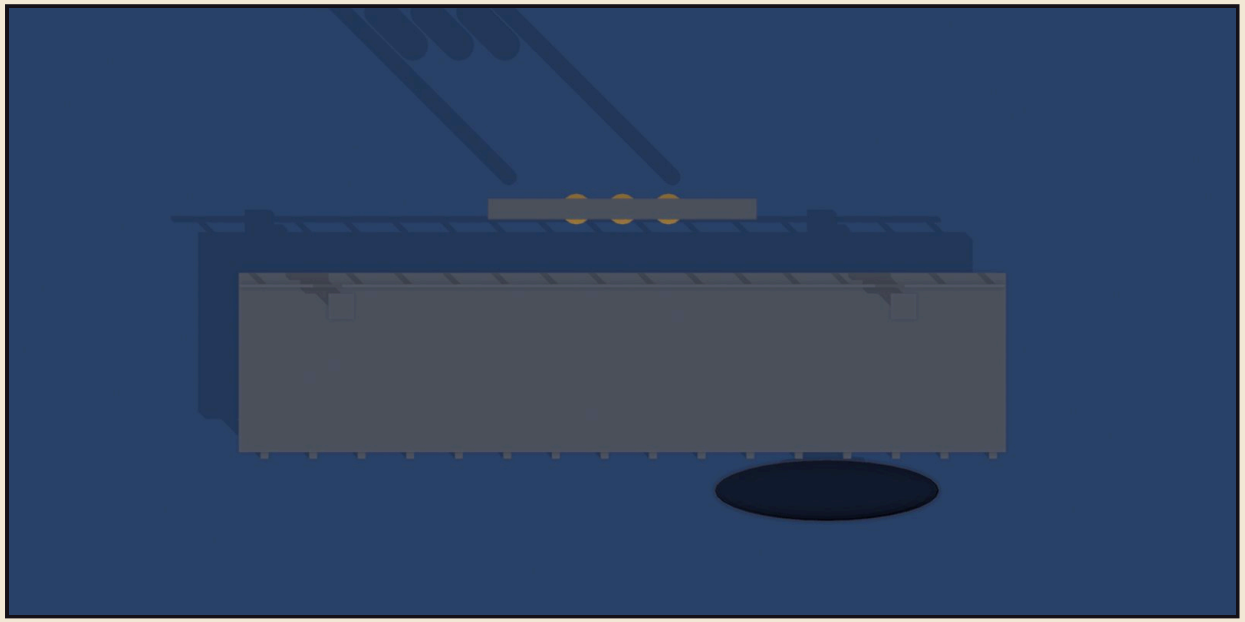
- Establishing: the Moon Pier at night
- The Night Parade crossing the red bridge
- Shrine of the Seven Lucky Gods; Tamamo's foxfire palace

COLOUR SCRIPT

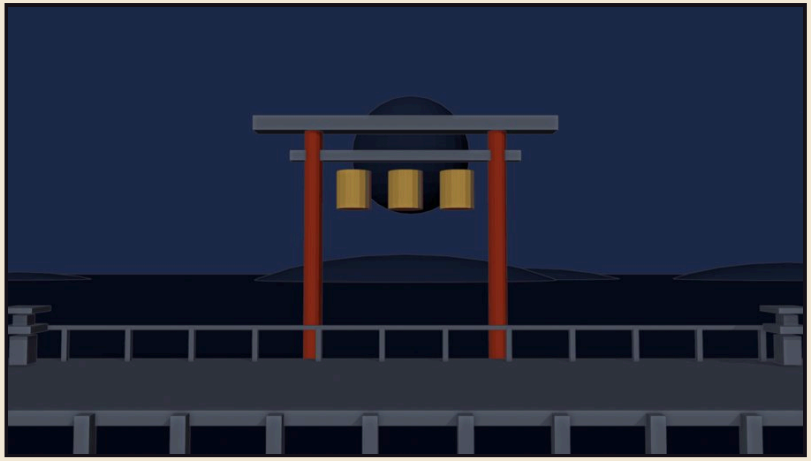
# HYAKKI · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

ACT I · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

| | |
|---|---|
| TIME | Summer night, full moon |
| KEY LIGHT | Lantern gold |
| FILL | Indigo moonlight |
| ATMOSPHERE | Mist over water, fireflies |

First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

# HYAKKI · MOON PIER

Volcanic islands where humans and yokai share festivals. The pier is where the party lands: lanterns, fireflies, and the Night Parade crossing the far ridge. Its deck is the Act I battle floor; the torii's three lanterns are the reel.

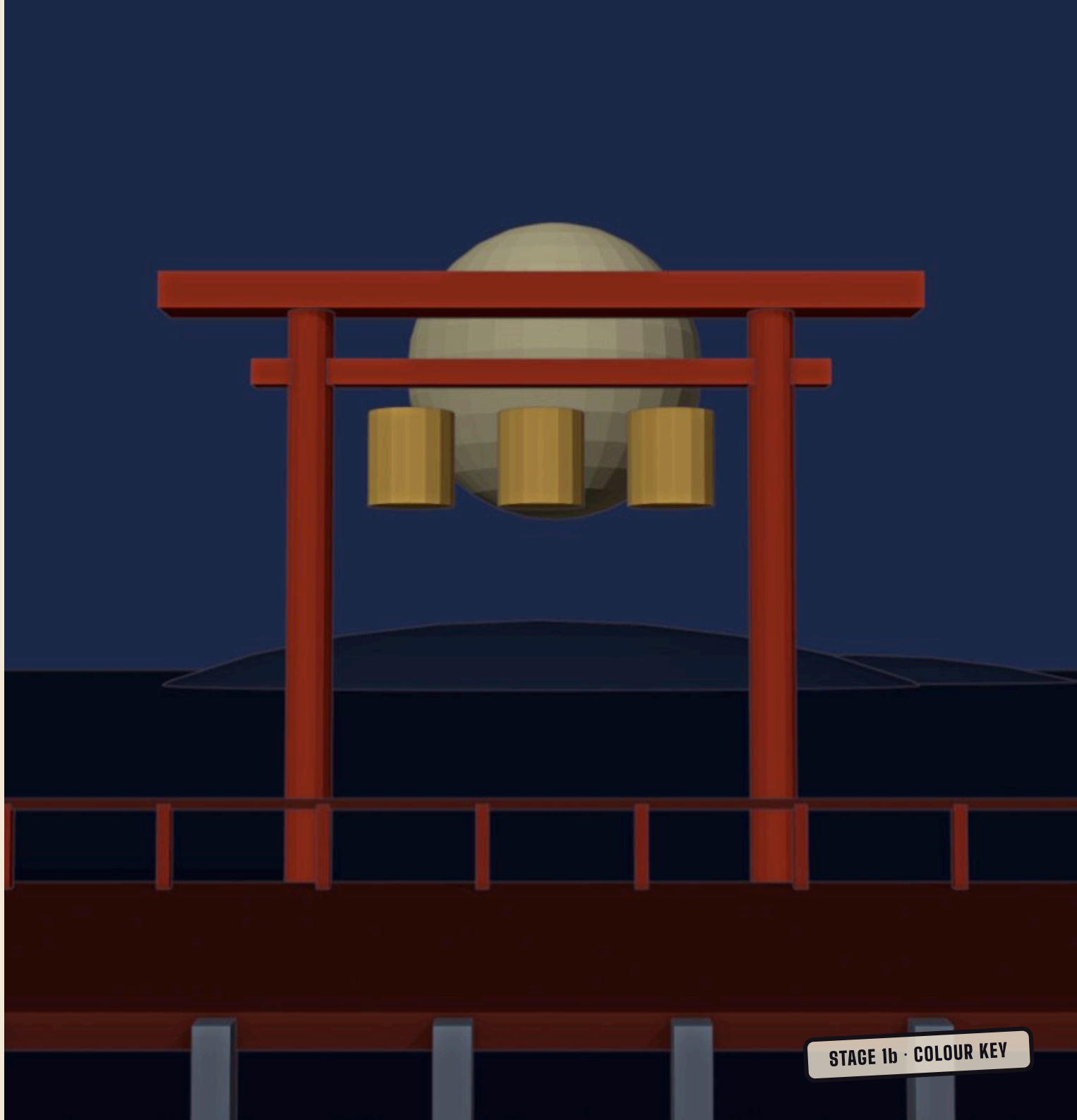
**Meridian intrusion:** a Ledgerist toll gate on the shrine road.



# KEY · MOON PIER

Colour key: indigo night, vermilion torii, lantern gold, moon cream. The paint pass adds mist, fireflies, sea glints and the Night Parade on the ridge, and keeps the deck clear for the fight.

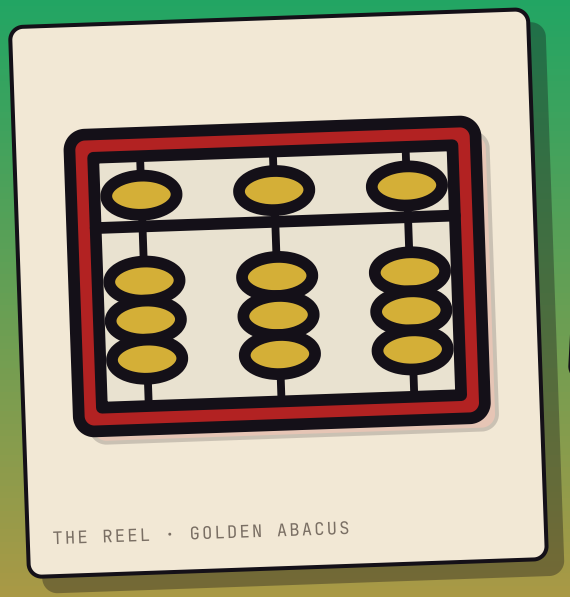
**Pipeline stage 1b · colour key** over the 3D base on the pipeline page.



# THE RIVER EMPIRE

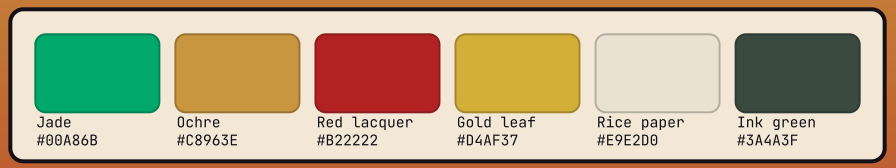
Act II · Chinese folk religion · gongbi gold + ink-wash underworld

| | |
|---|---|
| ACT | Act II |
| INSPIRED BY | Chinese folk religion, festival culture and river trade. |
| LAW OF THE LAND | The Rule of Interest: luck compounds |
| AUDITOR | Chancellor Jin Chan, the Golden Toad |
| KEEPER | Judge Cui |
| ENEMIES | Abacus Golems · Debt Junks · Golden Koi · Ox-Head & Horse-Face · Hungry Ghosts · Jiangshi |
| LITTLE THINGS | red envelopes, mahjong tables, dragon boats, joss paper drifting into the river, lucky 8s on every price tag. |
| SOUND | erhu, guzheng, firecrackers, abacus clicks; the underworld is silent except for brush strokes. |
| MERIDIAN INTRUSION | the Exchange is half Basilica office, half temple. |







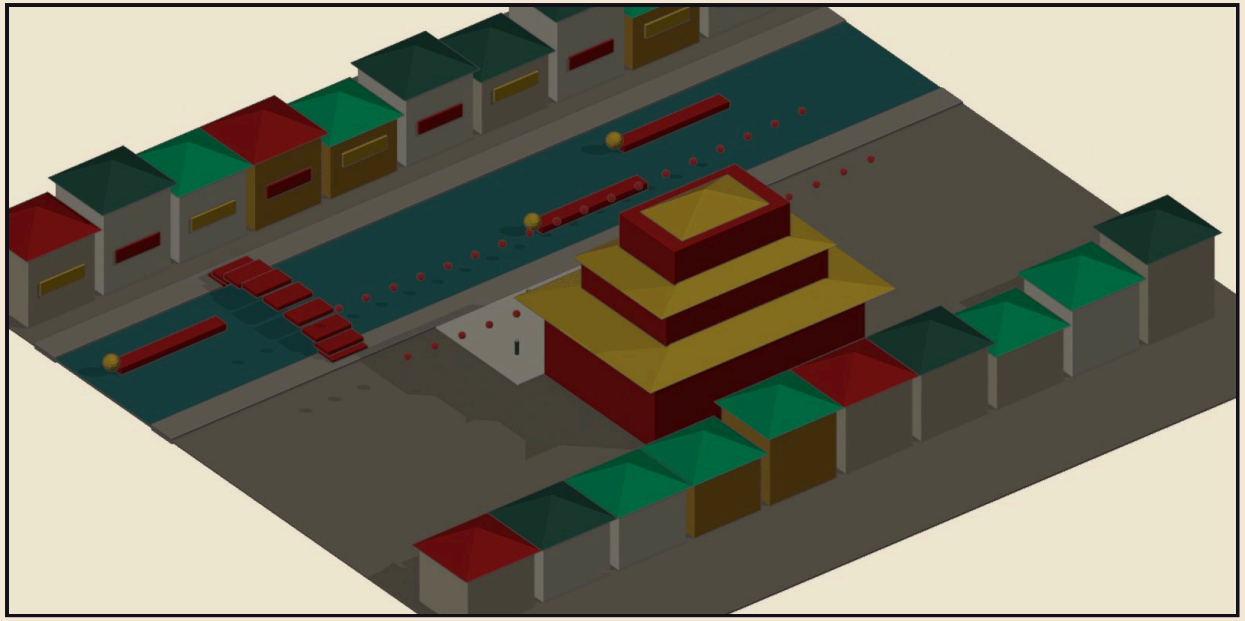



**ART NEEDED · The River Empire paintings**

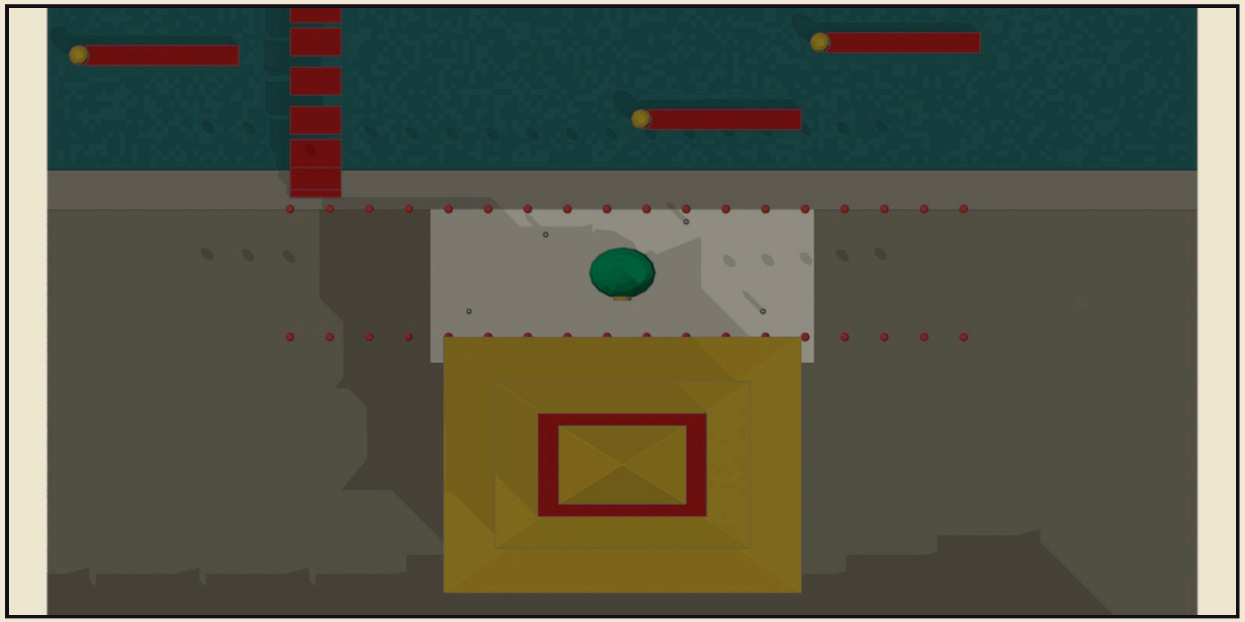
- Establishing: Bāfā Harbor at the Lantern Festival
- The Luck Exchange's live Omen boards
- The Ten Courts in ink-wash; Naihe Bridge

COLOUR SCRIPT

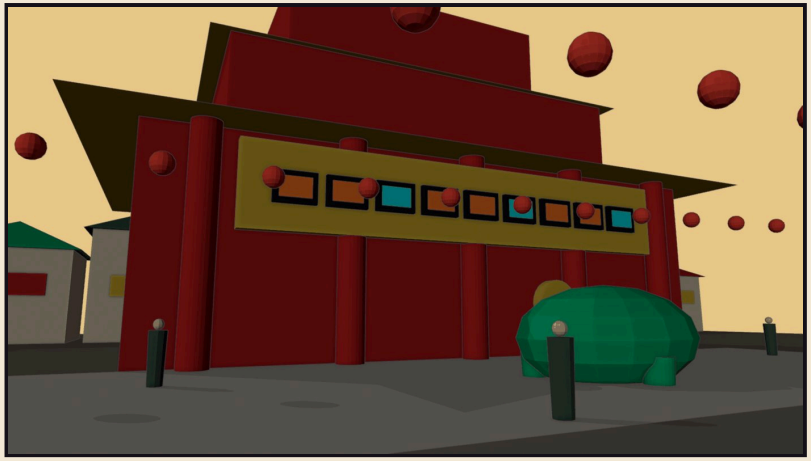
# THE RIVER EMPIRE · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

ACT II · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

| | |
|---|---|
| TIME | Golden afternoon (harbor) / misty dark (Courts) |
| KEY LIGHT | Low sun |
| FILL | Jade bounce |
| ATMOSPHERE | Incense, lantern smoke |

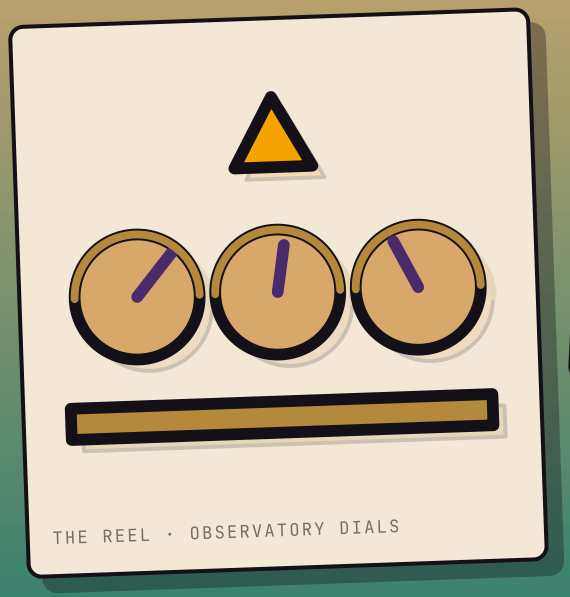
First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

# ŚŪNYAPURA

Act III · Indian myth & mathematics · miniature painting + monsoon light

| | |
|---|---|
| ACT | Act III |
| INSPIRED BY | Indian mythology, astronomy and mathematics; stepwells; open-air stone observatories. |
| LAW OF THE LAND | The Rule of Karma: every action is recorded and returns |
| AUDITOR | Rahu & Ketu, the Eclipse |
| KEEPER | Chitragupta |
| ENEMIES | Vetālas · Brass Yantra Guardians · Monsoon Nāgas |
| LITTLE THINGS | a lemon and seven chillies over every door; rangoli patterns; chai stalls; pigeons; monsoon puddles mirroring the instruments. |
| SOUND | sitar, tabla, temple bells, rain on stone. |
| MERIDIAN INTRUSION | Basilica surveyors re-measuring the observatory's numbers. |







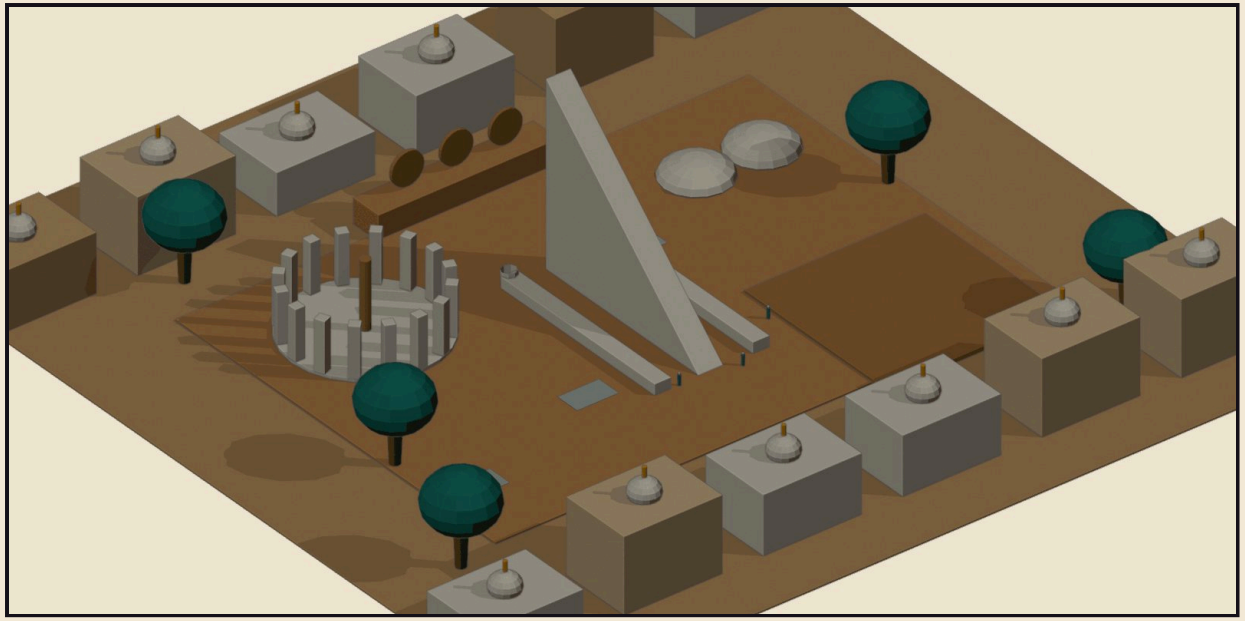
| Sandstone | Peacock | Saffron | Indigo | Brass | Eclipse |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| #D8A86B | #1E7B6F | #F4A300 | #3F3D99 | #B5893B | #4B2A6B |

**ART NEEDED · Śūnyapura paintings**

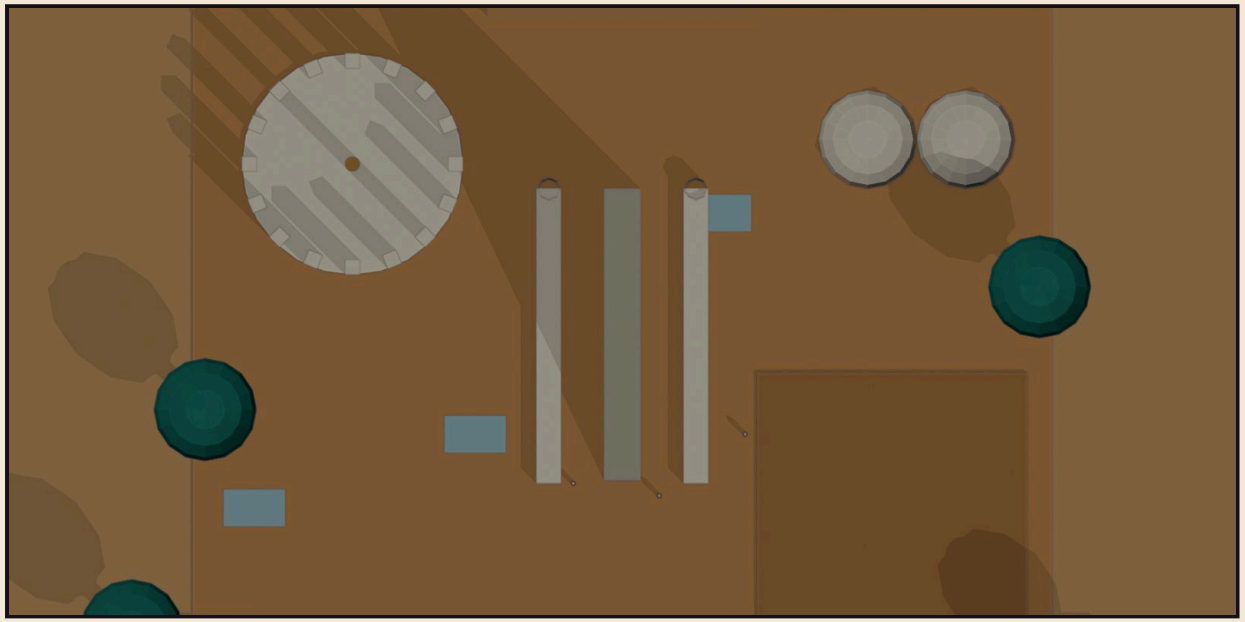
- Establishing: the Great Observatory in monsoon light
- The Stepwell of a Thousand Steps
- Chitragupta's Hall of palm-leaf records

COLOUR SCRIPT

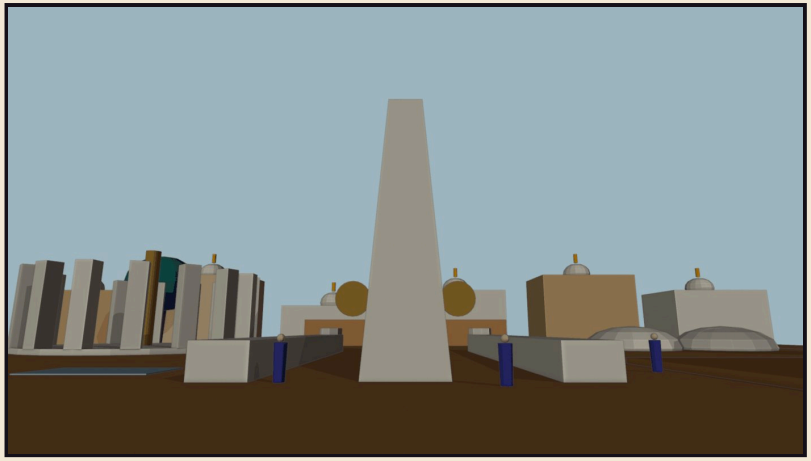
# ŚŪNYAPURA · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

ACT III · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

| | |
|---|---|
| TIME | Monsoon break |
| KEY LIGHT | Sun through cloud |
| FILL | Wet sandstone bounce |
| ATMOSPHERE | Rain sheets, puddle mirrors |

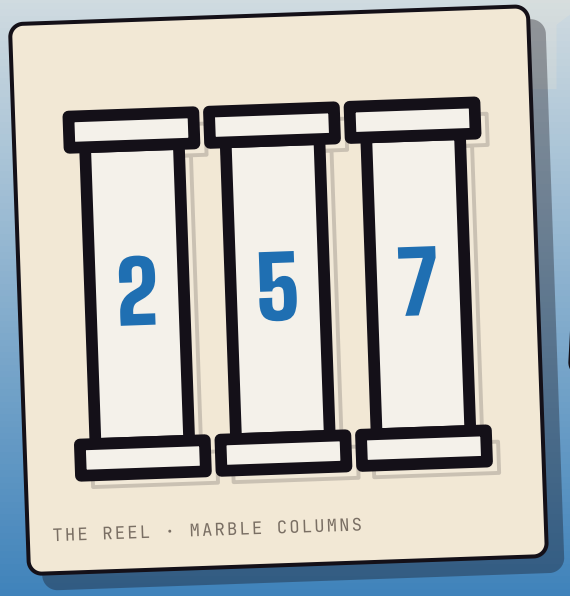
First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

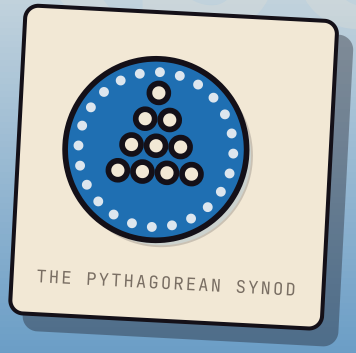
STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

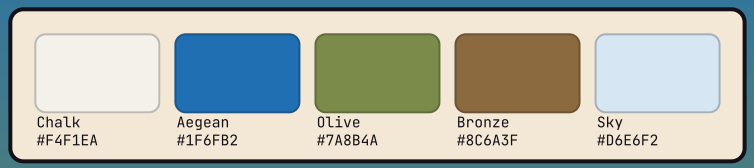
# KROTON NOVA

Act IV · Greek myth · marble, mosaic, Aegean noon

| | |
|---|---|
| ACT | Act IV |
| INSPIRED BY | Greek mythology and Pythagorean number mysticism. |
| LAW OF THE LAND | The Rule of Indivisibility: only primes pass |
| AUDITOR | Archon Seventeen |
| KEEPER | the Moirai |
| ENEMIES | Bronze Automata · Harpies · Composite Knights · Sirens |
| LITTLE THINGS | blue evil-eye beads; olive trees; goats on the terraces; mosaics of numbers. |
| SOUND | lyre, bouzouki, waves, chanting of primes. |
| MERIDIAN INTRUSION | the undercity of the "composite" people built from Basilica scrap. |



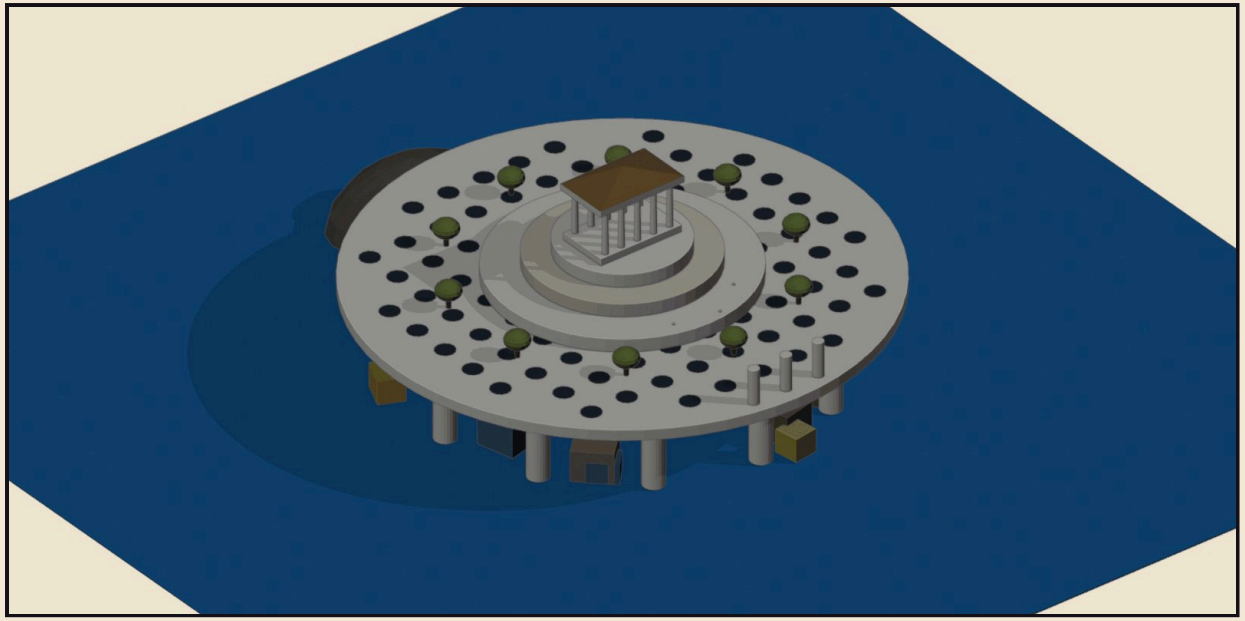




**ART NEEDED · Kroton Nova paintings**

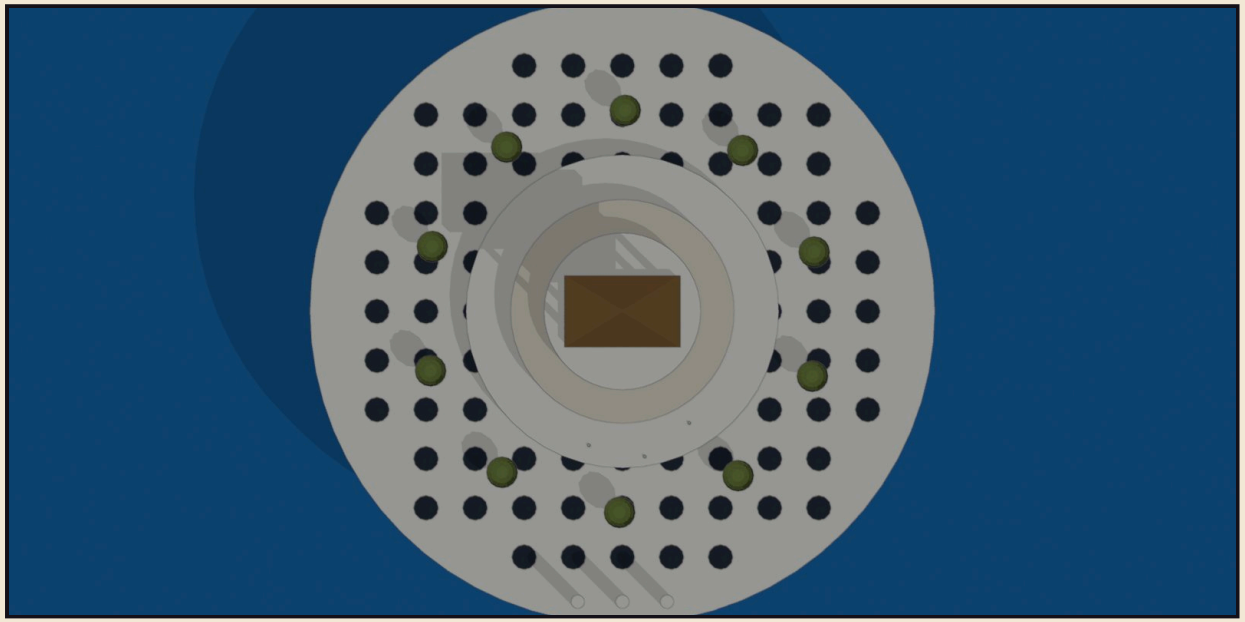
- Establishing: the white Sieve city at noon
- The undercity of the fallen under the Sieve
- The Moirai's cave

COLOUR SCRIPT

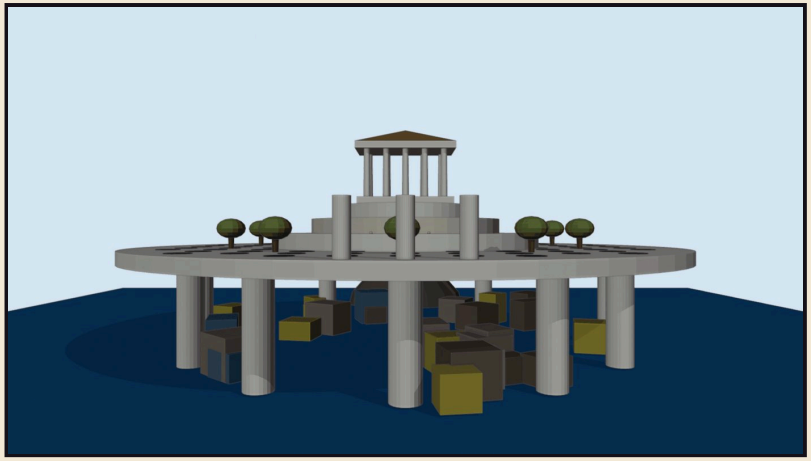
# KROTON NOVA · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

ACT IV · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

| | |
|---|---|
| TIME | Hard noon |
| KEY LIGHT | White sun |
| FILL | Aegean sky blue |
| ATMOSPHERE | Heat haze, sharp shadows |

First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

# THE CROSSROADS TERRITORY

Act V · American folklore · desert sunset + casino neon

| | |
|---|---|
| ACT | Act V |
| INSPIRED BY | American folklore: frontier tall tales, the blues crossroads legend, immigrant charms, desert highways and casinos. |
| LAW OF THE LAND | The Rule of the House: the night loops; every deal has a price |
| AUDITOR | The House (Octavian Nine) |
| KEEPER | the Stranger |
| ENEMIES | the Headless Horseman · Card-Sharp Automata · Tumbleweed Golems · the Ghost Train |
| LITTLE THINGS | horseshoes over doors (open end up); rabbit's-foot keychains; lucky pennies on the railway; diners; neon cacti. |
| SOUND | slide guitar, harmonica, a slot-machine choir, coyotes. |
| MERIDIAN INTRUSION | the casino is financed by the Basilica; Collectors deal blackjack. |







| Rust | Sage | Dusk violet | Sunset | Midnight | Neon pink |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| #B7410E | #9CAF88 | #5B3E73 | #F28C28 | #1D1A3A | #FF2E88 |

**ART NEEDED · The Crossroads Territory paintings**

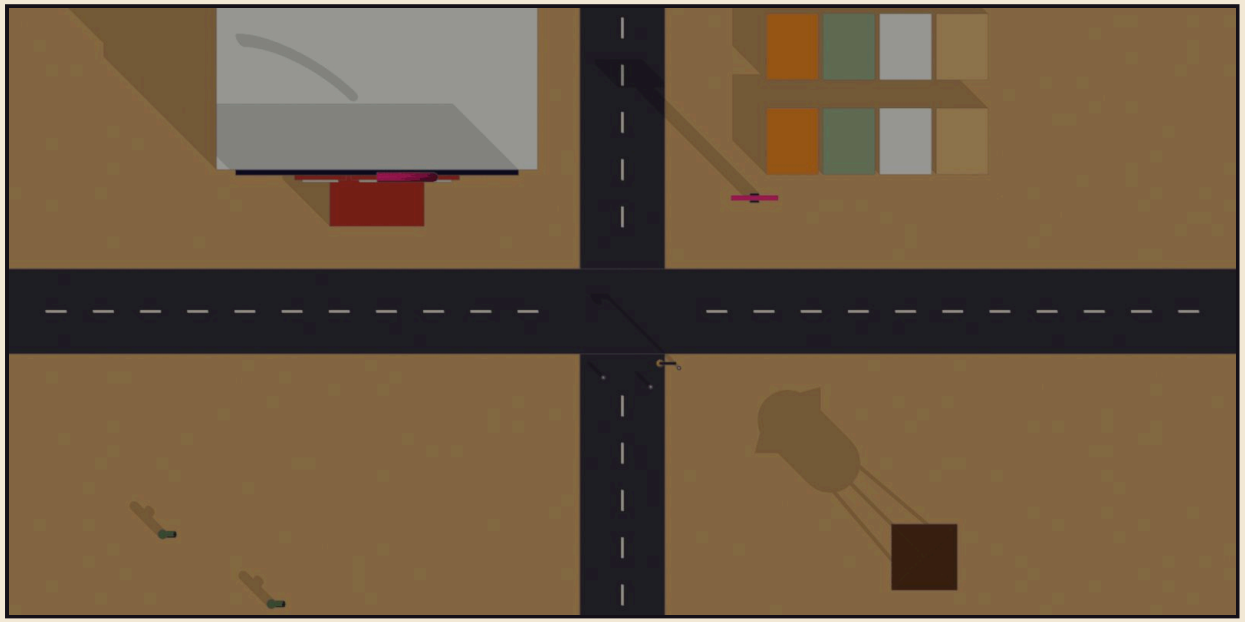
- Establishing: the midnight crossroads under one streetlamp
- Lucky Strike's casino strip, the same night repeating
- The Ghost Train

COLOUR SCRIPT

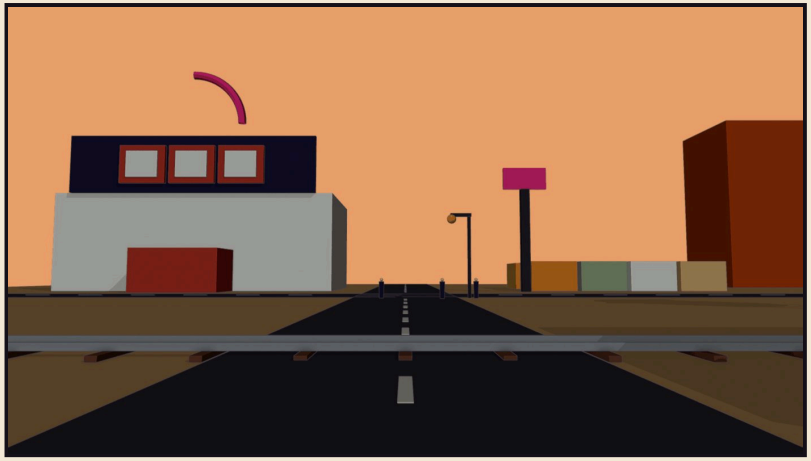
# THE CROSSROADS TERRITORY · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

ACT V · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

| | |
|---|---|
| TIME | Sunset → neon night |
| KEY LIGHT | Sunset orange / neon |
| FILL | Dusk violet |
| ATMOSPHERE | Dust, card storms |

First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

**STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT**

# THE BASILICA

Finale · the machine · brass and steel

| | |
|---|---|
| ACT | Finale |
| INSPIRED BY | a cosmopolitan modern capital; the immigrant quarters of every great port city. |
| LAW OF THE LAND | Fixed Fate |
| AUDITOR | Comptroller Lucan Thale |
| ENEMIES | every Auditor's echo |
| LITTLE THINGS | charms of every culture over every door; laundry between tenements; balcony gardens (a garden is luck you can see); cats; hand-painted lucky numbers. |
| SOUND | rain, Nixie hum, distant Dawn Tally bells, street musicians, Collector sirens. |







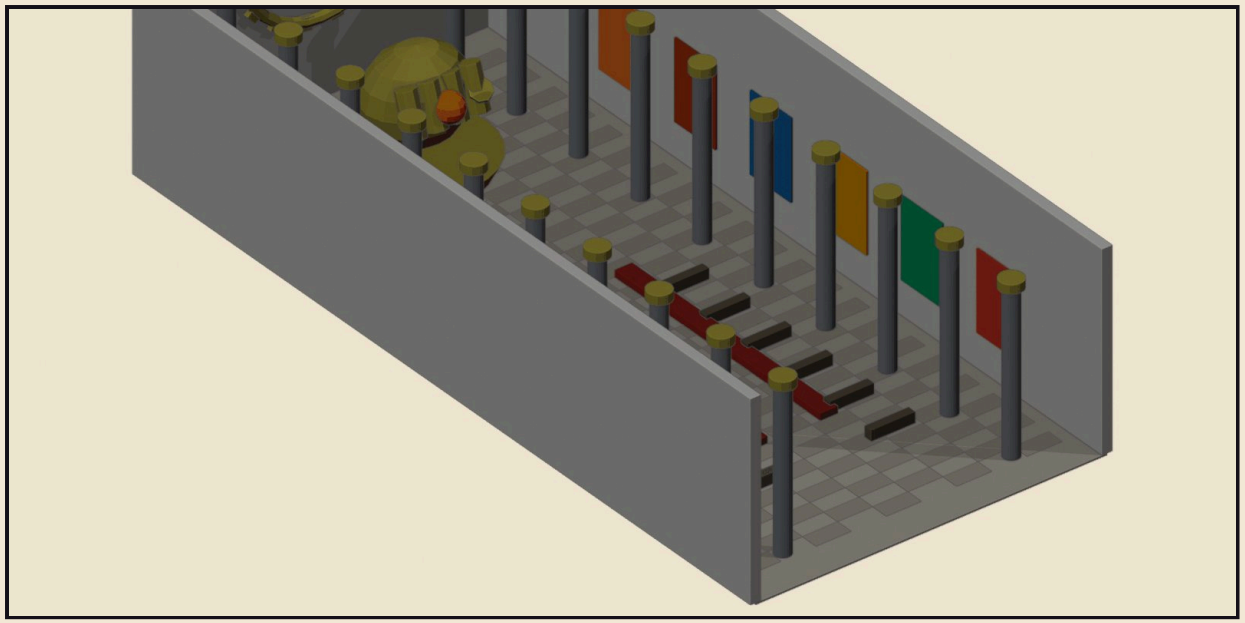



**ART NEEDED · The Basilica paintings**

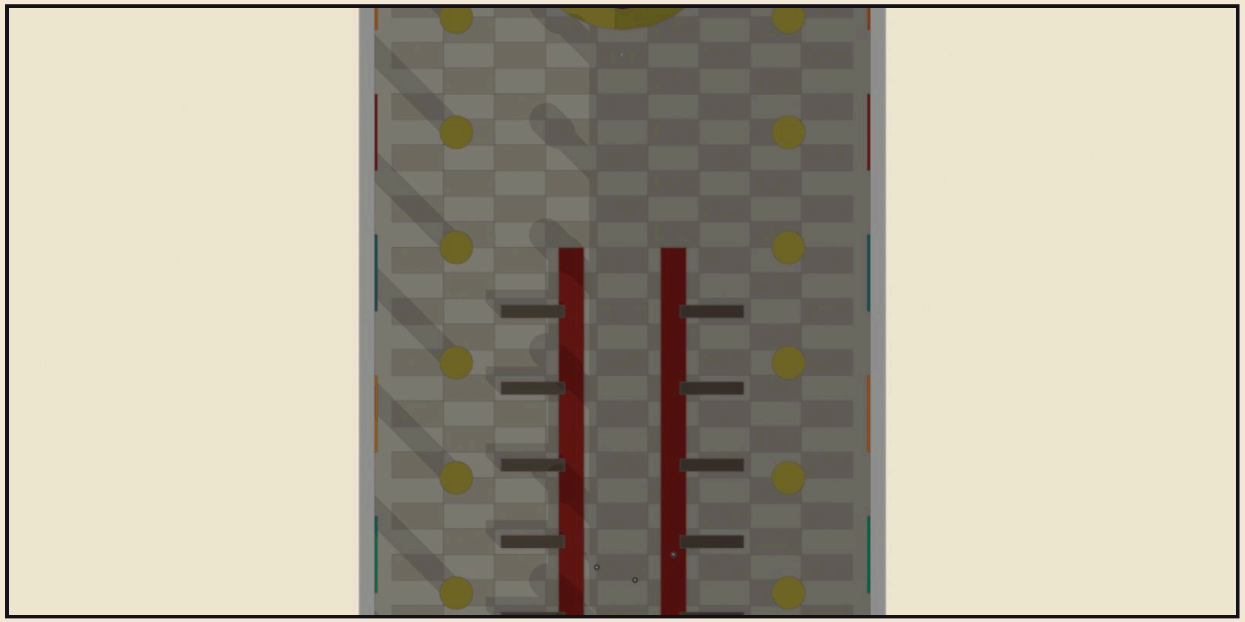
- Keyframe: the Basilica nave, every land's ledger on its walls
- The Upper Gate with seven Seal Digits
- Thale's three phases as one sequence

COLOUR SCRIPT

# THE BASILICA · 3D BLOCKOUT



2.5D · ORTHOGRAPHIC, PITCH 57°, YAW -38°



TOP-DOWN · PLAN



FRONT · BATTLE CAMERA (PERSPECTIVE)

FINALE · LIGHT AND ATMOSPHERE (ART SPEC §3.4)

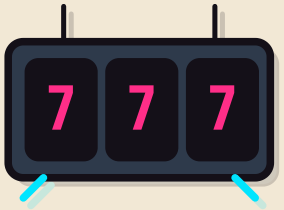
| | |
|---|---|
| TIME | Interior, no sun |
| KEY LIGHT | Nixie amber |
| FILL | Brass bounce |
| ATMOSPHERE | Still air, motes |

First-draft 3D blockout at true scale (1 unit = 1 m), flat colour key from the land's palette. Built by `tools/build_envs.py`; the painted register-A version paints over these exact cameras.

STAGE 1 · 3D BLOCKOUT

## THE REEL, LAND BY LAND

The three slots where stopped digits land are always an object from the world, never a UI panel (GDD §8). Same three digits, seven cultures.



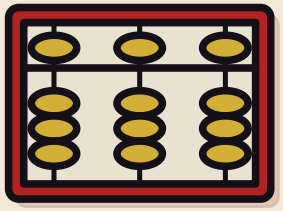

### Neon sign

Meridian Undercity



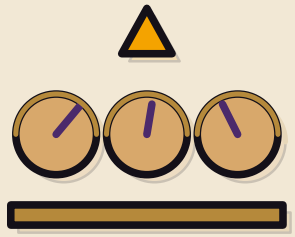

### Torii with three lanterns

Hyakki



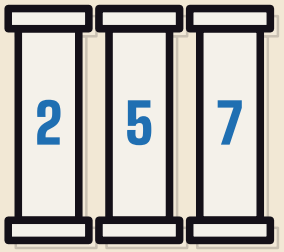
### Golden abacus

The River Empire



### Observatory dials

Śūnyapura




### Marble columns

Kroton Nova




### Slot machine

The Crossroads Territory




### The Basilica clock

The Basilica

PART IV

# THE CAST

Every character, outfit, boss, keeper, story character and faction archetype as a first-draft 3D model, front, left, right and back at one scale.

1. Main character
2. Companions
3. Secret recruits
4. Bosses
5. Keepers
6. The god of luck
7. Story characters
8. Factions and jobs

# CAST · READABILITY

Every character must read as a solid black silhouette at 64 px and by colour alone (Character Bible §0). Shared scale, true relative heights: heroes on top, Auditors below.





NIL
Player's choice



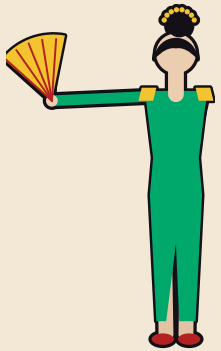
Vesper Sette
7



Maeve Triskel
3



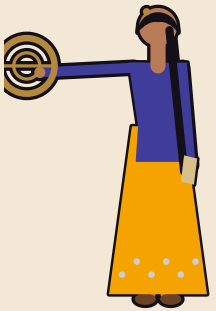
Hina
9



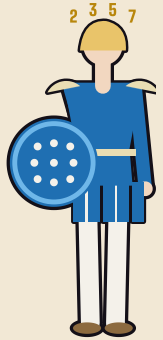
Ba Jinling
8



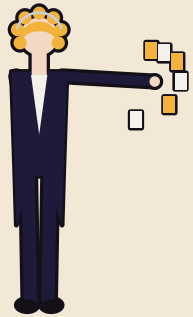

Bai Si
4



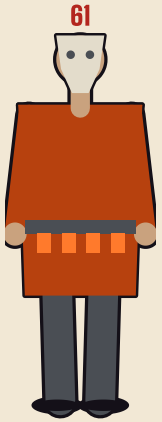
Shunya
0



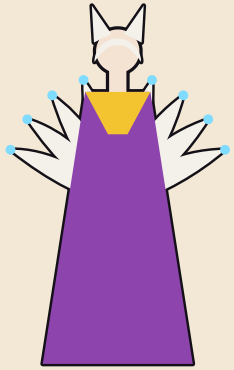

Prima
2



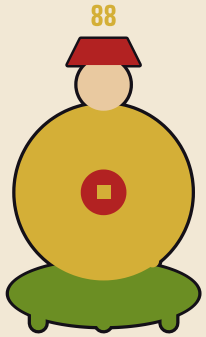
Fibi Leone
Fibonacci



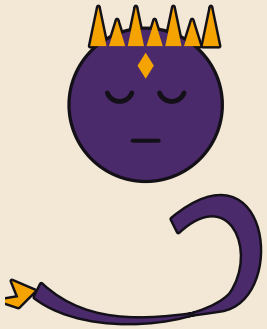

Varro Kade
61



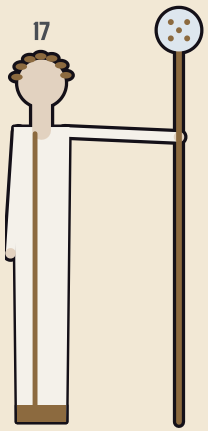
Tamamo
Nine tails



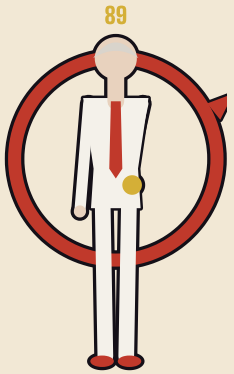

Jin Chan
88



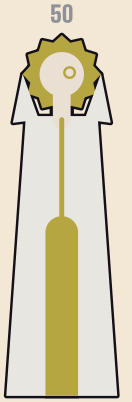
Rahu & Ketu
Eclipse




Archon Seventeen
17




The House
89




Lucan Thale
50 (steel)


KEYFRAME · NIL
NAN?
PLACEHOLDER · PASS 1 ART

# NIL · OUTFITS

The main character's four story outfits, front and back at one scale. Each gets a full turnaround on its own page.




## Wanderer's coat (default, Prologue onward)

Long asymmetric black actuary's coat (left tail longer), high collar, three brass ledger clasps on the right, fingerless gloves, slim trousers, tall boots. Cracked brass decoder fused into the RIGHT wrist. Broken holographic NaN halo.




## Remainder rags (intro, Rain Alley 9)

Hooded ash-grey poncho patched with Remainder scrap over black clothes; a satchel; the decoder wrapped in rag. The coat is earned later (Vesper buys it in Act I).




## Night Parade disguise (Act I, Hyakki)

An indigo festival robe borrowed from the parade, worn over the black coat; a paper fox mask pushed to the side of the head; a hand lantern.



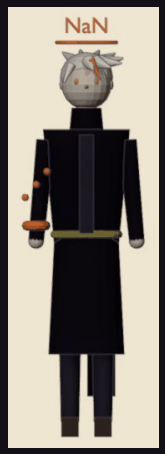

## The Open Hand (finale,

The coat turned inside out: i
every land's ledger in gold th
The halo resolves into the pl

THE CAST

# MAIN CHARACTER

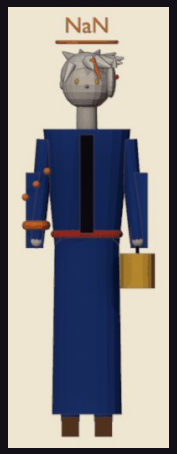
4 models · front views at one shared scale.




Wanderer's coat




Remainder rags

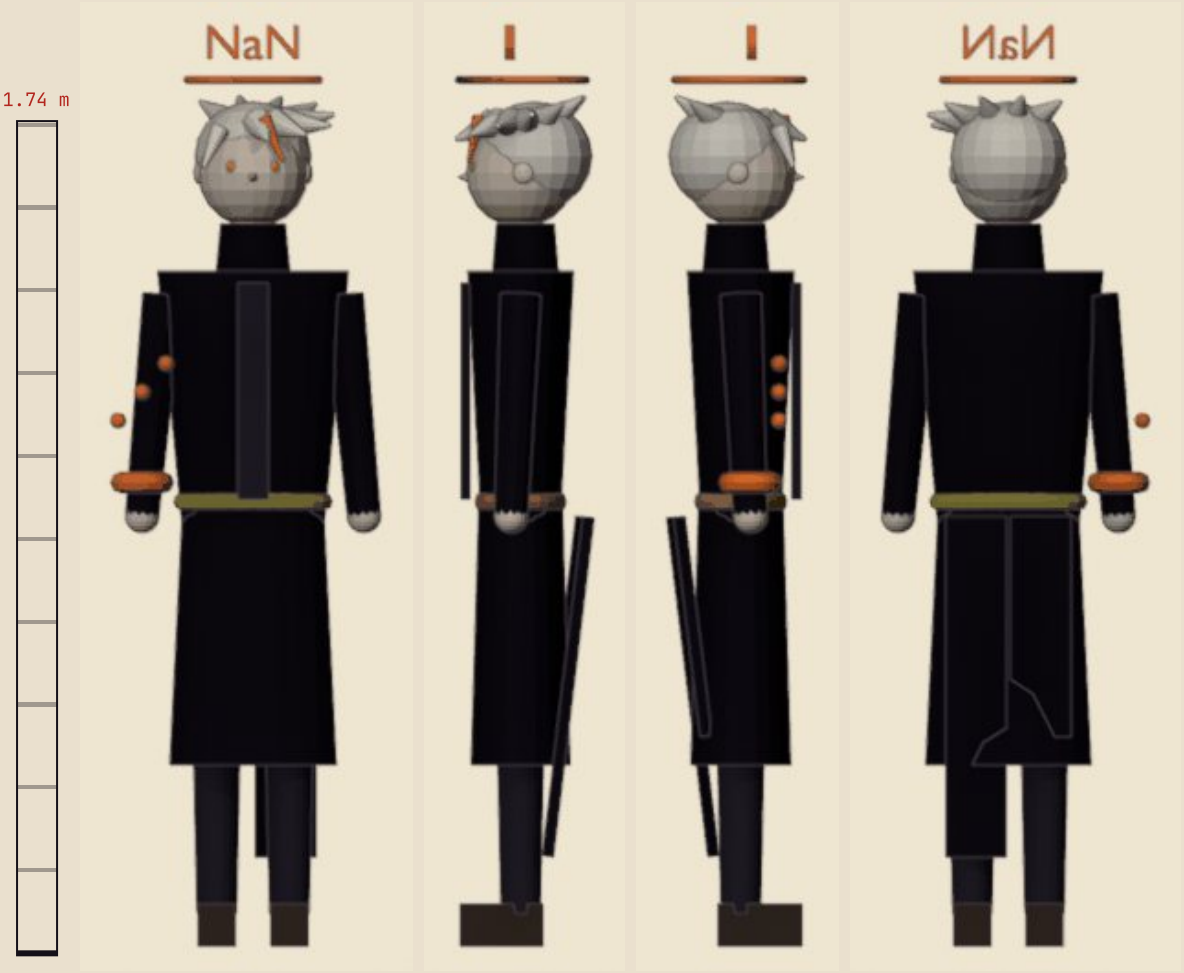



Night Parade disguise




The Open Hand

# MAIN CHARACTER NIL




Ink
Nixie #FF7A2C
Bone #EDE6DA
Brass #B5A642

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Main character |
| OUTFIT | Wanderer's coat (default, Prologue onward) |
| ROLE | Protagonist · the Remainder |
| LAND | Meridian Undercity |
| LUCKY DIGIT | player's choice |
| OMEN | NaN |
| HEIGHT | 1.74 m |

## DESIGN

Long asymmetric black actuary's coat (left tail longer), high collar, three brass ledger clasps on the right, fingerless gloves, slim trousers, tall boots. Cracked brass decoder fused into the RIGHT wrist. Broken holographic NaN halo.

## PROPS

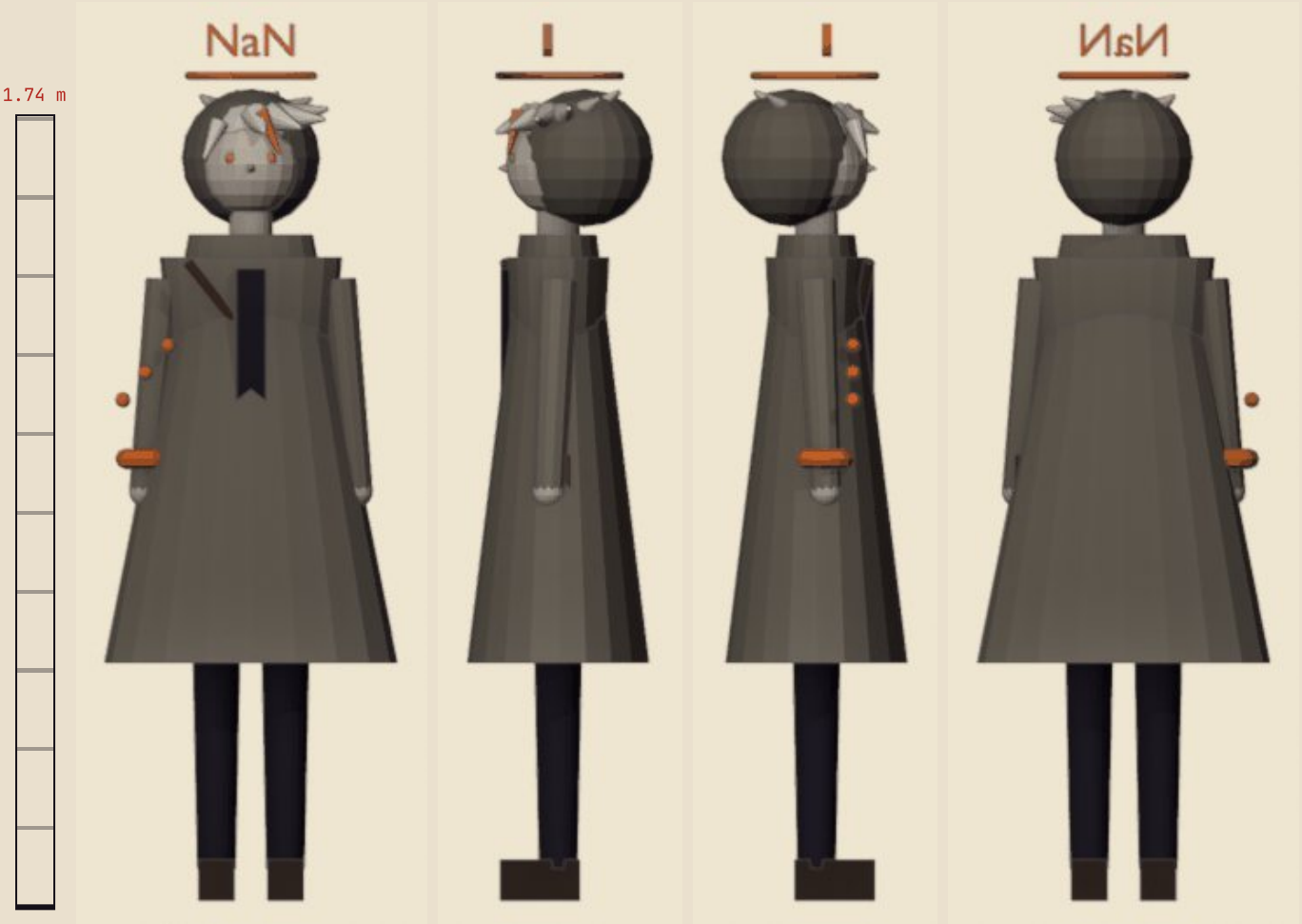
Cracked brass decoder fused into the right wrist; leaks orange light and tiny floating digits when emotional

## CANON LOCKS

- Decoder on the RIGHT wrist
- One orange streak in white hair
- Halo reads exactly "NaN"
- Coat's left tail is longer
- Amber eyes

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# MAIN CHARACTER NIL




| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Main character |
| OUTFIT | Remainder rags (intro, Rain Alley 9) |
| ROLE | Protagonist · first appearance |
| LAND | Meridian Undercity |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | NaN |
| HEIGHT | 1.74 m |

Ash #8A7F72 Ink #141018 Nixie #FF7A2C

## DESIGN

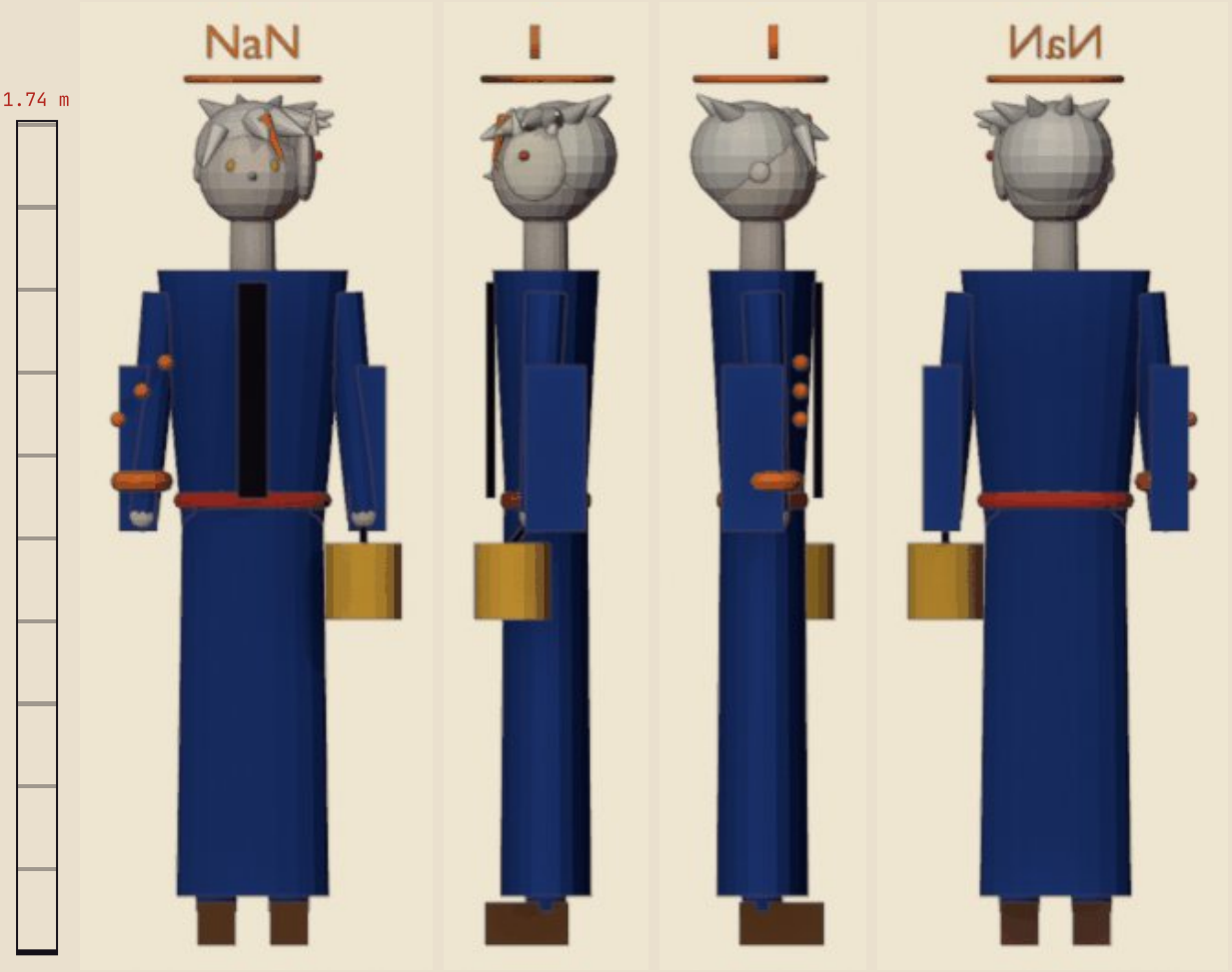
Hooded ash-grey poncho patched with Remainder scrap over black clothes; a satchel; the decoder wrapped in rag. The coat is earned later (Vesper buys it in Act I).

## CANON LOCKS

- Hood up until the Naming Rite
- Decoder visible under the rag

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# MAIN CHARACTER NIL




Indigo #26428B

Vermilion #E34234

Paper #F2E6C9

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Main character |
| OUTFIT | Night Parade disguise (Act I, Hyakki) |
| ROLE | Protagonist · festival disguise |
| LAND | Hyakki |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | NaN |
| HEIGHT | 1.74 m |

## DESIGN

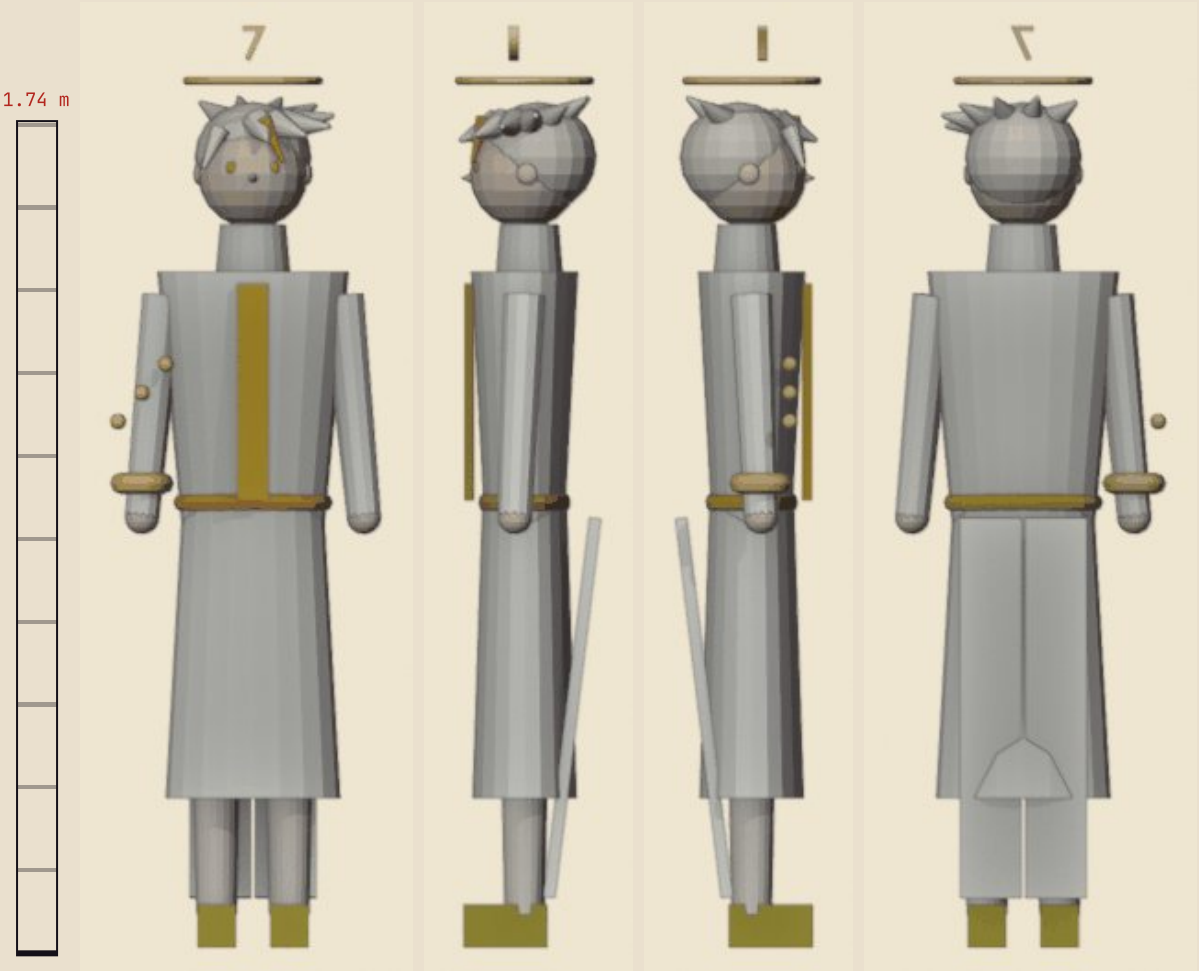
An indigo festival robe borrowed from the parade, worn over the black coat; a paper fox mask pushed to the side of the head; a hand lantern.

## CANON LOCKS

- The NaN still shows: the disguise hides the face, never the halo

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# MAIN CHARACTER NIL




| Bone | Gold | Nixie |
|---|---|---|
| #F4F1EA | #D4AF37 | #FF7A2C |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Main character |
| OUTFIT | The Open Hand (finale, true ending) |
| ROLE | Protagonist · finale |
| LAND | The Basilica |
| LUCKY DIGIT | yours |
| OMEN | your number |
| HEIGHT | 1.74 m |

## DESIGN

The coat turned inside out: its bone-white lining embroidered with every land's ledger in gold thread. Both tails even for the first time. The halo resolves into the player's digit.

## CANON LOCKS

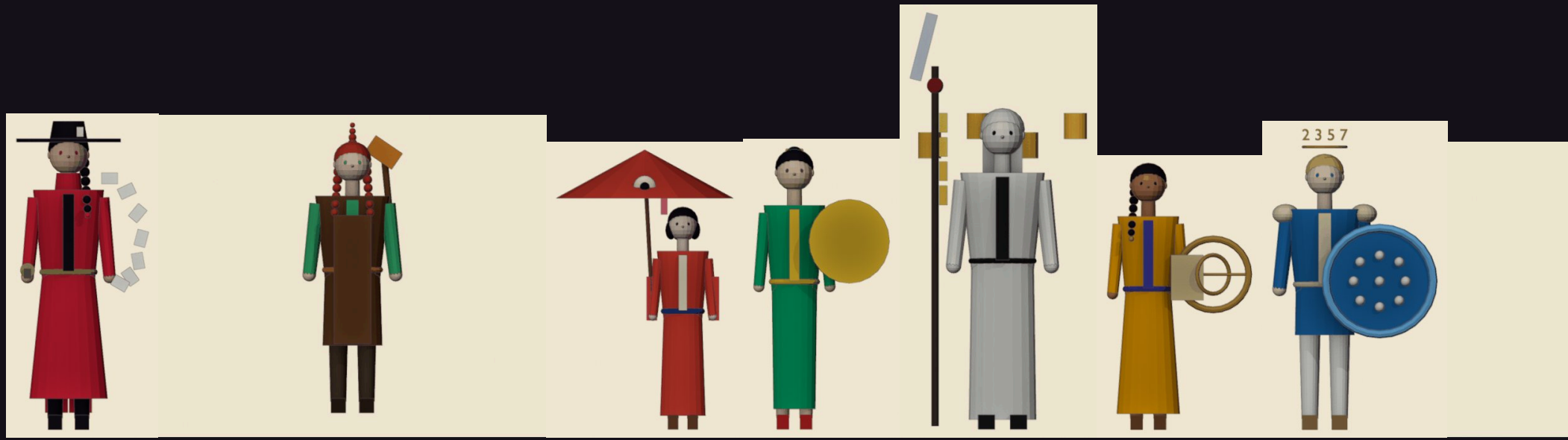
- Only in the true ending
- The halo shows the player's chosen digit

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

THE CAST

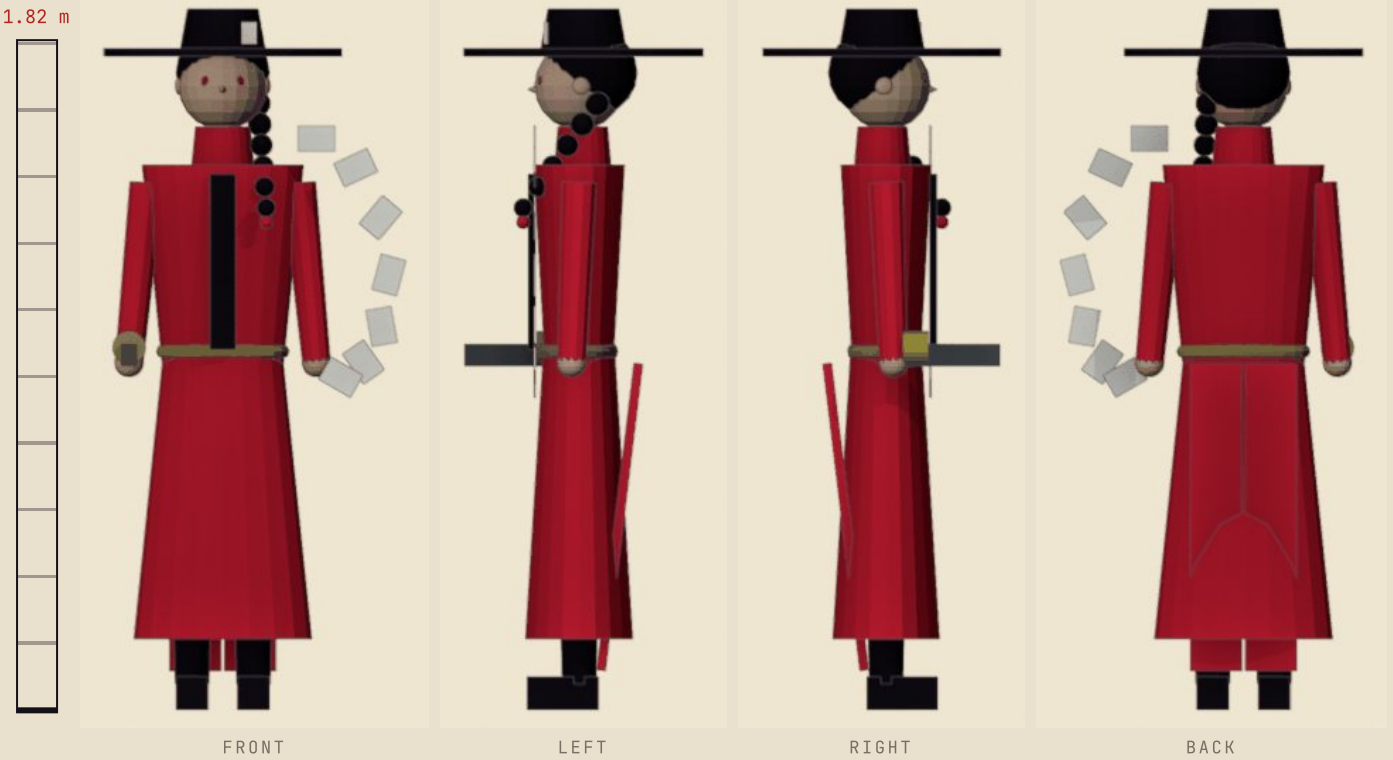
# COMPANIONS

8 models · front views at one shared scale.




Vesper Sette · Maeve Triskel · Hina of the Ninety-Nine · Ba Jinling · Bai Si · Shunya · Prima of Kroton

# COMPANIONS Vesper Sette




Crimson

Black
#141018

Brass
#B5A642

Shirt
#F4F1EA

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Companions |
| ROLE | Gunslinger · companion |
| LAND | Meridian / Crossroads |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 7 |
| OMEN | 77 |
| HEIGHT | 1.82 m |

## DESIGN

Wide-brim black hat with two playing cards in the band; crimson duster with triangular tails; black croupier waistcoat; white shirt, sleeves rolled; cards in her garters

## PROPS

Revolver with a seven-chamber cylinder engraved 1–7; a worn silver coin she flips before every decision and ignores

## CANON LOCKS

- Exactly 7 chambers
- scar on the lip
- crimson + black + brass only
- braid over the LEFT shoulder

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS

# Maeve Triskel




Copper

Clover
#3BB273

Leather
#6B4226

Red hair
#C0392B

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Companions |
| ROLE | Charm-smith · companion |
| LAND | Meridian, Celtic quarter |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 3 |
| OMEN | 33 |
| HEIGHT | 1.65 m |

## DESIGN

Leather forge apron, rolled work shirt, heavy boots; red hair in three braids

## PROPS

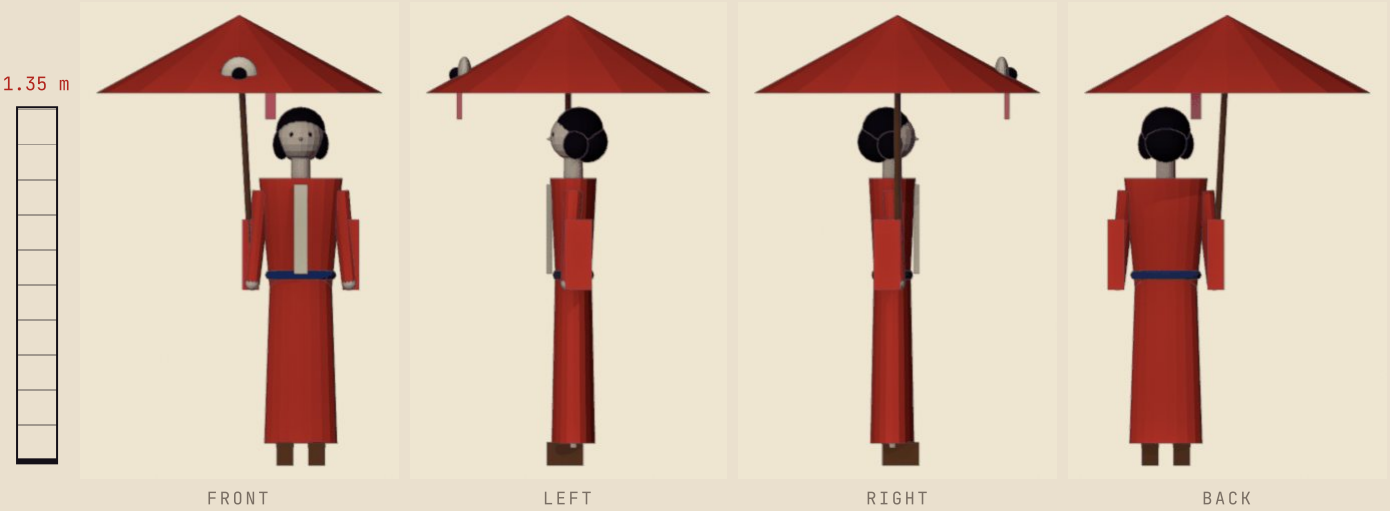
Horseshoe-knuckle gauntlets (glow copper-hot when charged); forge hammer with a triskele burned into the head; four-leaf-clover pin

## CANON LOCKS

- Exactly 3 braids
- triskele on the hammer
- clover pin on the collar

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# COMPANIONS Hina of the Ninety-Nine




Vermilion

Indigo
#26428B

Paper
#F2E6C9

Gold
#F2B33D

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Companions |
| ROLE | Tsukumogami · companion |
| LAND | Hyakki |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 9 |
| OMEN | 99 |
| HEIGHT | 1.35 m |

## DESIGN

Furisode kimono in indigo and vermilion patterned with numbers 1–99; big obi bow; geta sandals; black bob

## PROPS

Red-and-white oiled-paper umbrella with one eye and a long tongue (it's her true body; it has its own expressions)

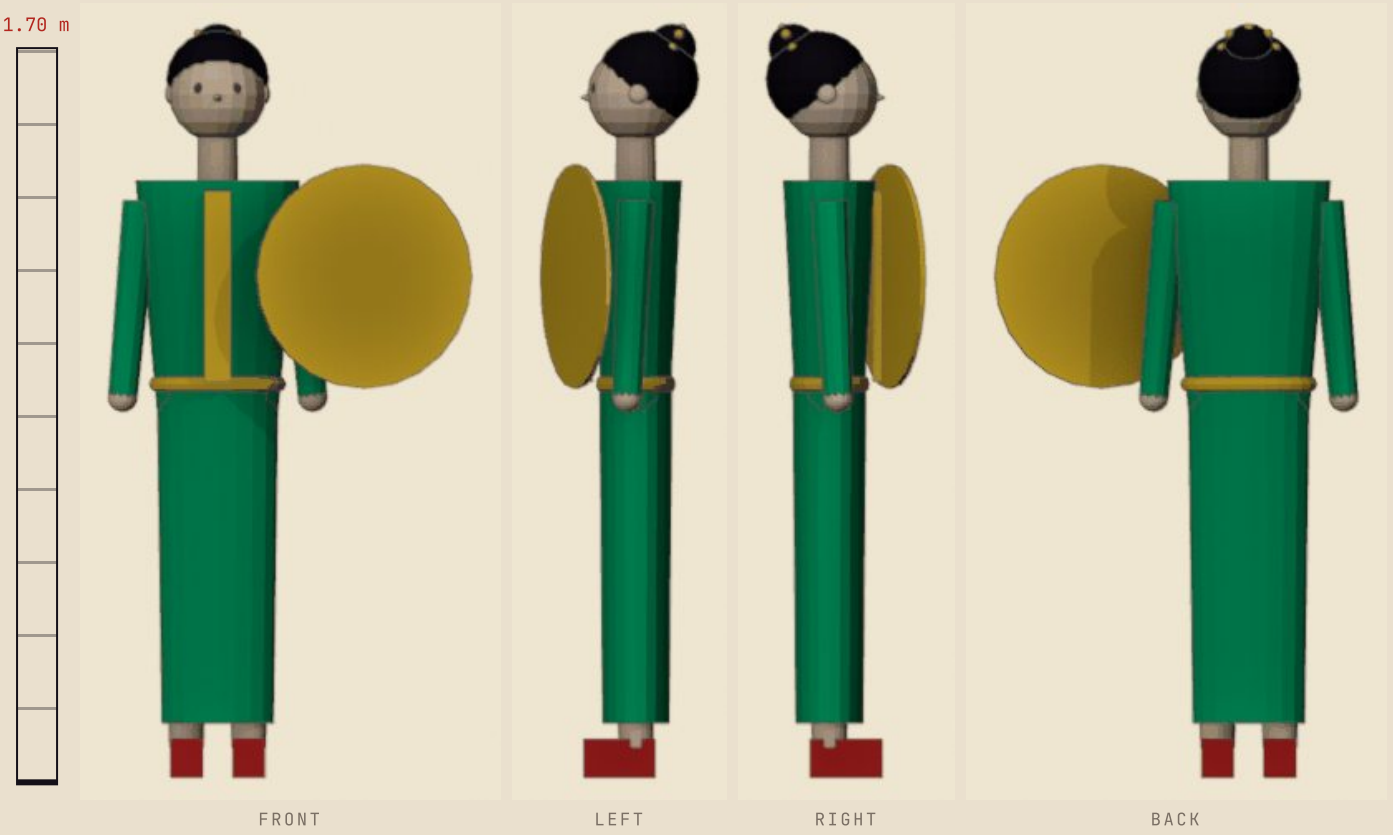
## CANON LOCKS

- The umbrella has ONE eye
- kimono numbers stop at 99
- she never reaches 100 before the finale

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS

# Ba Jinling




Jade

Gold
#F4C430

Lacquer
#B22222

Violet
#5D3A7A

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Companions |
| ROLE | Financier · companion |
| LAND | River Empire |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 8 |
| OMEN | 88 |
| HEIGHT | 1.70 m |

## DESIGN

Modern jade-and-gold qipao with a high slit and structured shoulders; eight tiny golden bells in hair ornaments and anklets

## PROPS

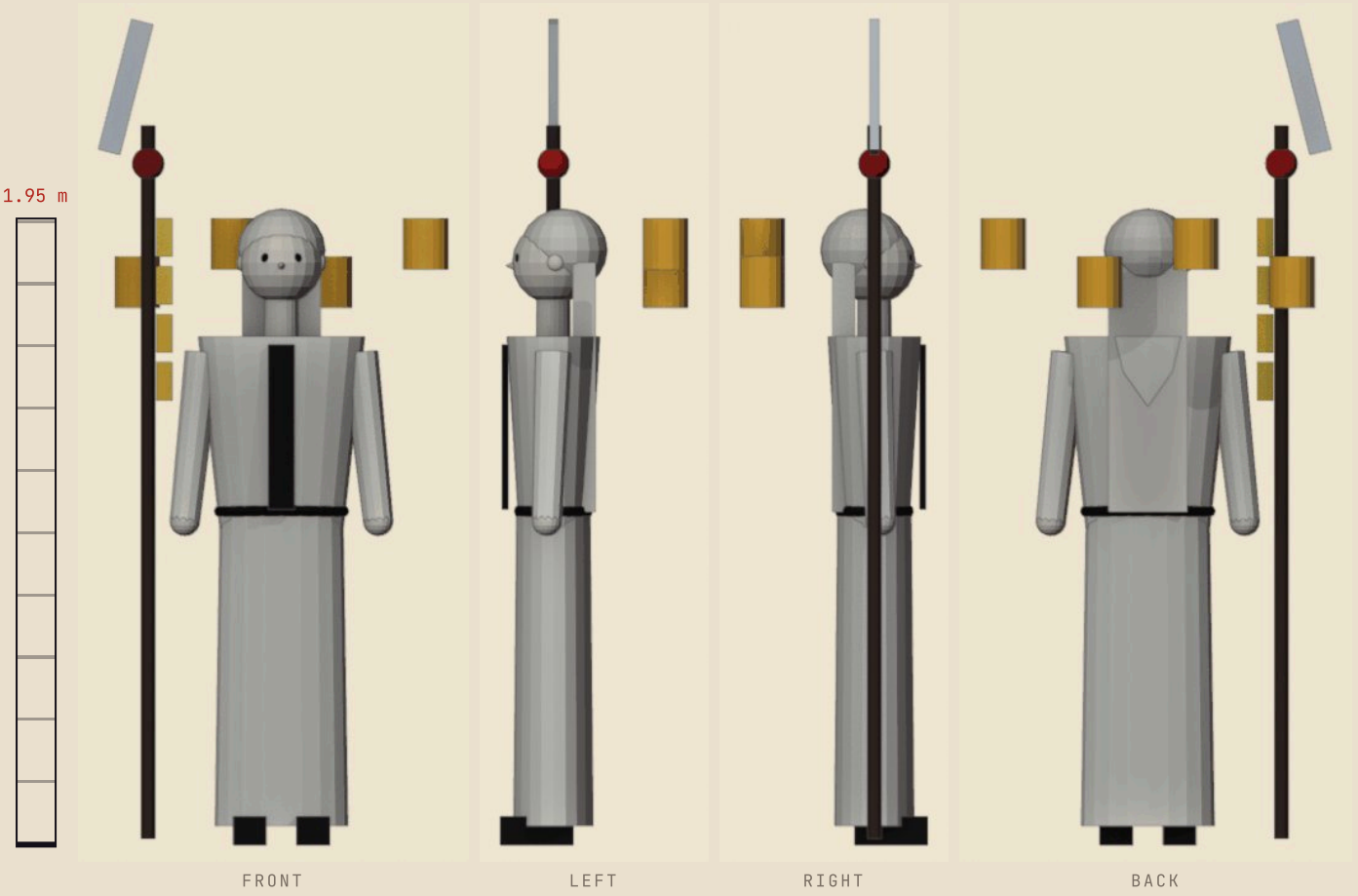
Folding fan whose ribs are abacus rods (beads fly as projectiles)

## CANON LOCKS

- Exactly 8 bells
- the abacus fan
- jade + gold palette

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# COMPANIONS Bai Si




Mourning white

Ink
#1B1B1B

Talisman
#E8C547

Lantern
#F2B33D

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Companions |
| ROLE | Executioner · companion |
| LAND | River Empire (Ten Courts) |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 4 |
| OMEN | 44 |
| HEIGHT | 1.95 m |

## DESIGN

White mourning robes (white is the mourning colour in Chinese tradition) inked with 四; black funeral ribbon in long white hair

## PROPS

Huge guandao-style blade hung with four paper talismans; joss paper drifts around him; four floating lanterns

## CANON LOCKS

- Always 4 lanterns and 4 talismans
- white robes, never coloured
- never smiles before Act IV

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# COMPANIONS Shunya




Indigo
Saffron
#F4A300
Brass
#B5893B
Mirror
#C9CED6

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Companions |
| ROLE | Astronomer · companion |
| LAND | Śūnyapura |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 0 |
| OMEN | 00→ |
| HEIGHT | 1.62 m |

## DESIGN

Indigo-and-saffron layered clothing with mirror-work embroidery; long dark braid with brass astrolabe hairpins; ink-stained fingers

## PROPS

Brass astrolabe (spun as a weapon), palm-leaf manuscripts tied at her hip

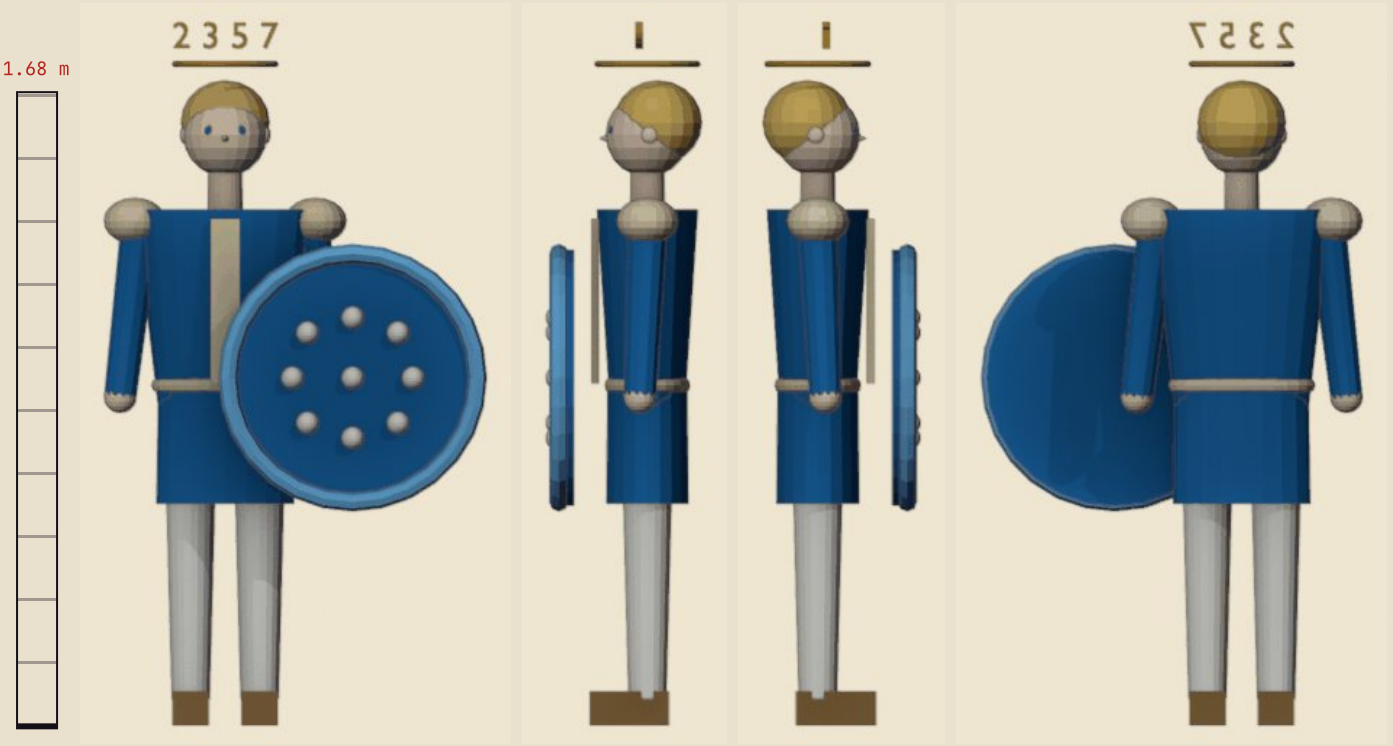
## CANON LOCKS

- The astrolabe
- mirror-work embroidery
- the line "Zero isn't nothing."

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS

# Prima of Kroton




Aegean

White gold
#E9DDB3

Chalk
#F4F1EA

Glass
#6FB7E9

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Companions |
| ROLE | Paladin · companion |
| LAND | Kroton Nova |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 2 |
| OMEN | 02 |
| HEIGHT | 1.68 m |

## DESIGN

White-and-gold armour with Greek-key borders; short blonde hair; blue eyes

## PROPS

Giant round shield shaped like a sieve set with blue glass; a halo of floating glyphs 2-3-5-7

## CANON LOCKS

- The sieve shield
- the 2-3-5-7 halo
- short hair

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

COMPANIONS

# Fibi Leone

Gold

Midnight
#1D1A3A

Card white
#F4F1EA

Neon pink
#FF2E88

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Companions |
| ROLE | Dealer · companion |
| LAND | The Crossroads |
| LUCKY DIGIT | Fibonacci |
| OMEN | 89 |
| HEIGHT | 1.60 m |

## DESIGN

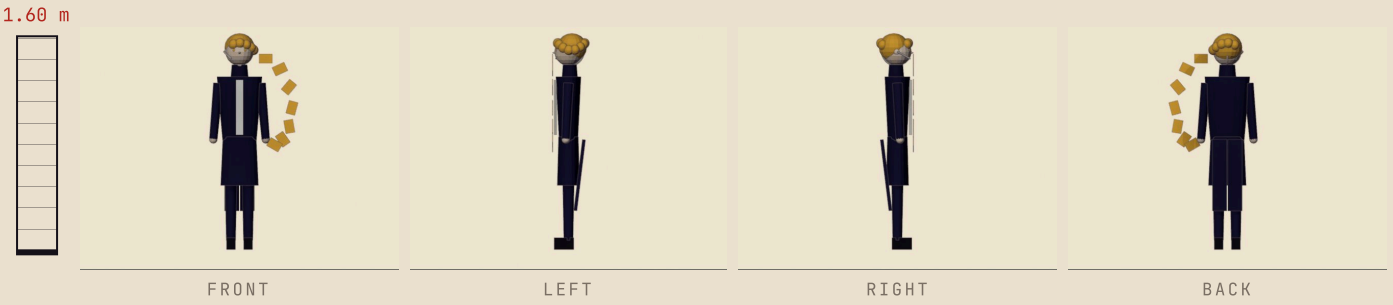
Tailored croupier tailcoat and headset; golden spiral curls; spiral-patterned irises

## PROPS

A deck of glowing cards that flows around her in a golden spiral

## CANON LOCKS

- 1,597 nights
- spiral irises
- her digit changes every round




3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

THE CAST

# SECRET RECRUITS

3 models · front views at one shared scale.



Varro Kade



Kyūsuke the Kappa



Granny Liu Shun

SECRET RECRUITS

# Varro Kade




Rust #B7410E

Gunmetal #4A4E54

Bone #E3DCCB

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Secret recruits |
| OUTFIT | Ally (Act V on) |
| ROLE | Secret recruit · digit 1 |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 1 |
| OMEN | 61 |
| HEIGHT | 2.05 m |

## DESIGN

The same rust trench armour with its debt jars smashed; the hound-skull mask pushed up on his head, never worn over the face again.

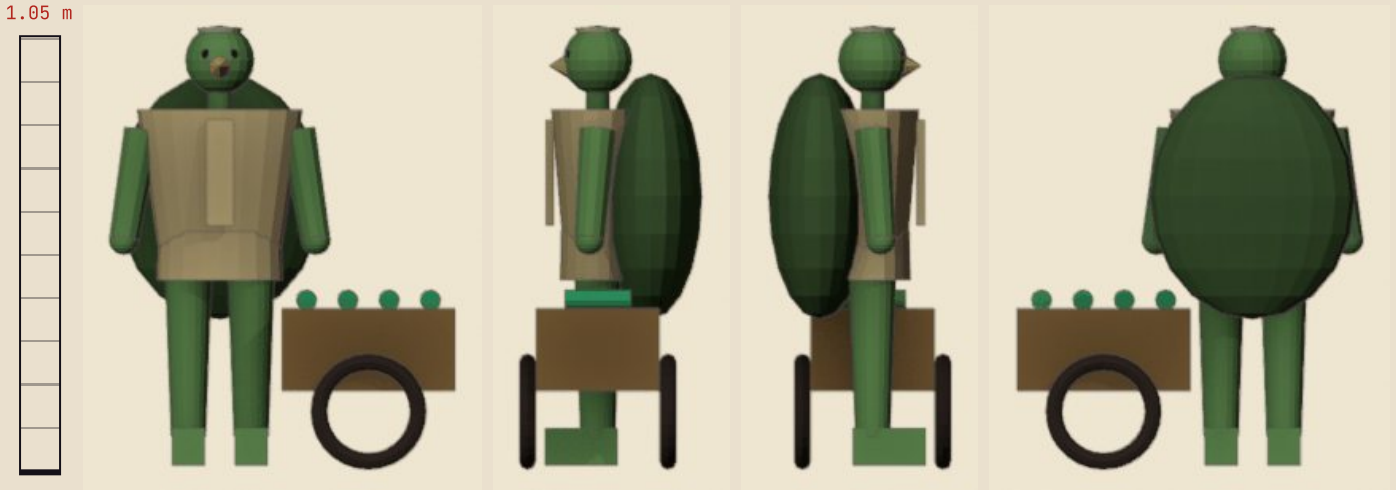
## CANON LOCKS

- Mask up, face visible
- Jars empty and cracked

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

SECRET RECRUITS

# Kyūsuke the Kappa




Kappa green
#6E9B5A

Straw
#D8C08A

Cucumber
#3BB273

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Secret recruits |
| ROLE | Secret recruit · digit 5 |
| LAND | Hyakki |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 5 |
| OMEN | 55 |
| HEIGHT | 1.05 m |

## DESIGN

A small river imp: green skin, beak, turtle shell, a water dish on his head, a straw vest, and a cucumber cart.

## CANON LOCKS

- The water dish is always full
- Never seen without the cart

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

SECRET RECRUITS

# Granny Liu Shun




| Jade | Cardigan | Lacquer |
|---|---|---|
| #00A86B | #B4A7C8 | #B22222 |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Secret recruits |
| ROLE | Secret recruit · digit 6 |
| LAND | River Empire |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 6 |
| OMEN | 66 |
| HEIGHT | 1.48 m |

## DESIGN

Tiny, eighty-ish, a lavender cardigan over a red qipao, jade bangles, a mahjong-tile purse and a cane she points with.

## CANON LOCKS

- Never loses at mahjong on screen

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

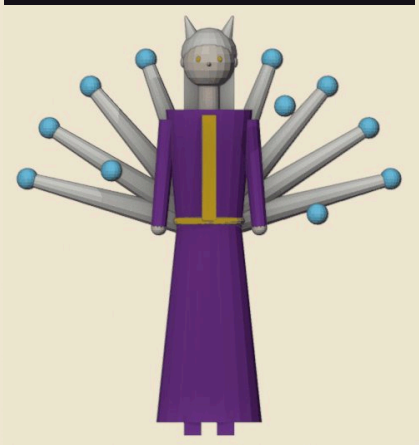
THE CAST

# BOSSES

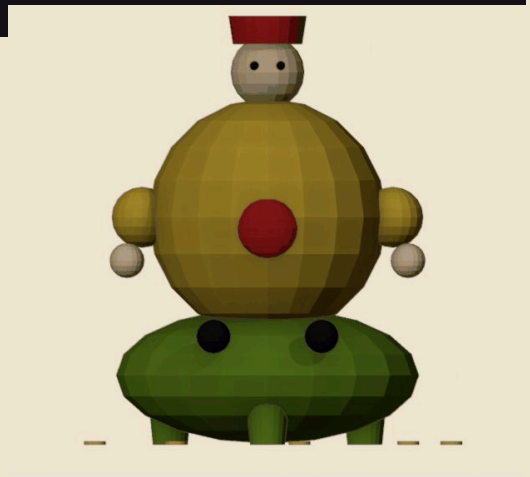
7 models · front views at one shared scale.



Varro Kade, the Ledgerhound



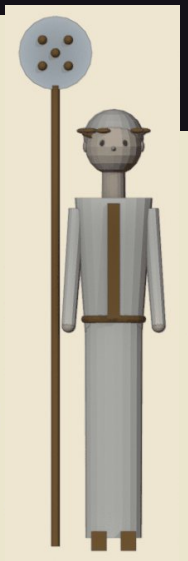
Tamamo, the Nine-Tailed Auditor



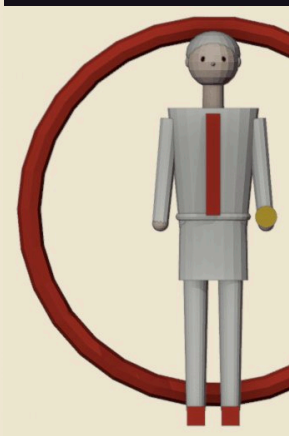
Chancellor Jin Chan



Rahu & Ketu, the Eclipse



Archon Seventeen



The House, Octavian N

BOSSES

# Varro Kade, the Ledgerhound




Rust

Gunmetal
#4A4E54

Debt glow
#FF7A2C

Bone
#E3DCCB

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Bosses |
| ROLE | Prologue boss |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 61 |
| HEIGHT | 2.05 m |

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# BOSSES Tamamo, the Nine-Tailed Auditor

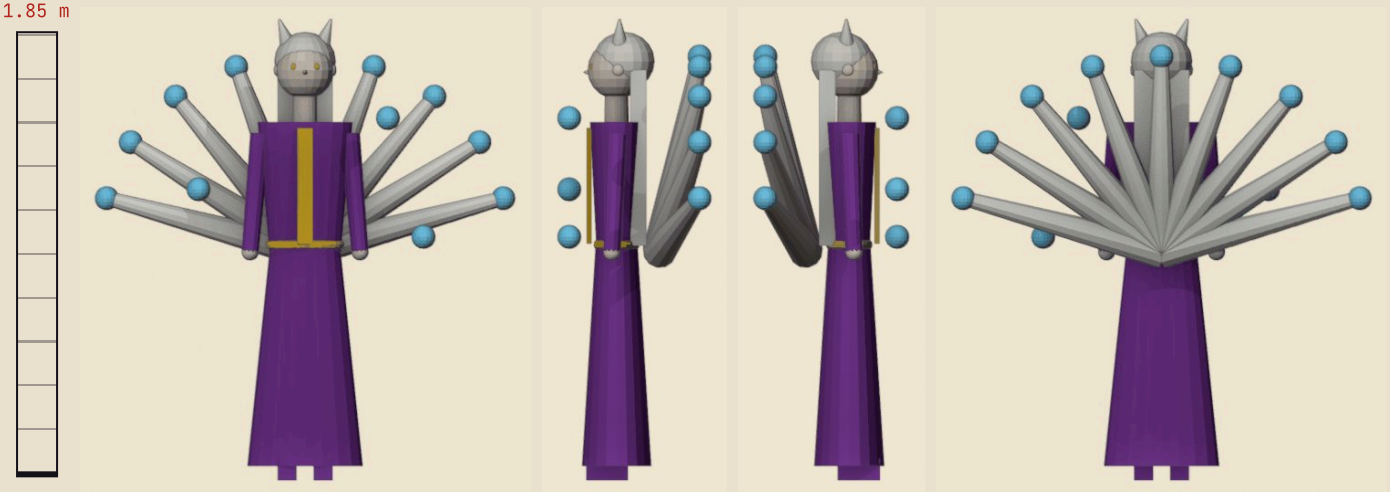
Violet

Gold
#F4C430

Foxfire
#7FDBFF

White
#F4F1EA

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Bosses |
| ROLE | Act I boss |
| LAND | Hyakki |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 9 |
| OMEN | 99 ×9 |
| HEIGHT | 1.85 m |




3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

BOSSES

# Chancellor Jin Chan

Gold
#D4AF37

Toad green
#6B8E23

Red
#B22222

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Bosses |
| ROLE | Act II boss |
| LAND | River Empire |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 8 |
| OMEN | 88 |
| HEIGHT | 2.05 m |

2.05 m



FRONT LEFT RIGHT BACK

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

BOSSES

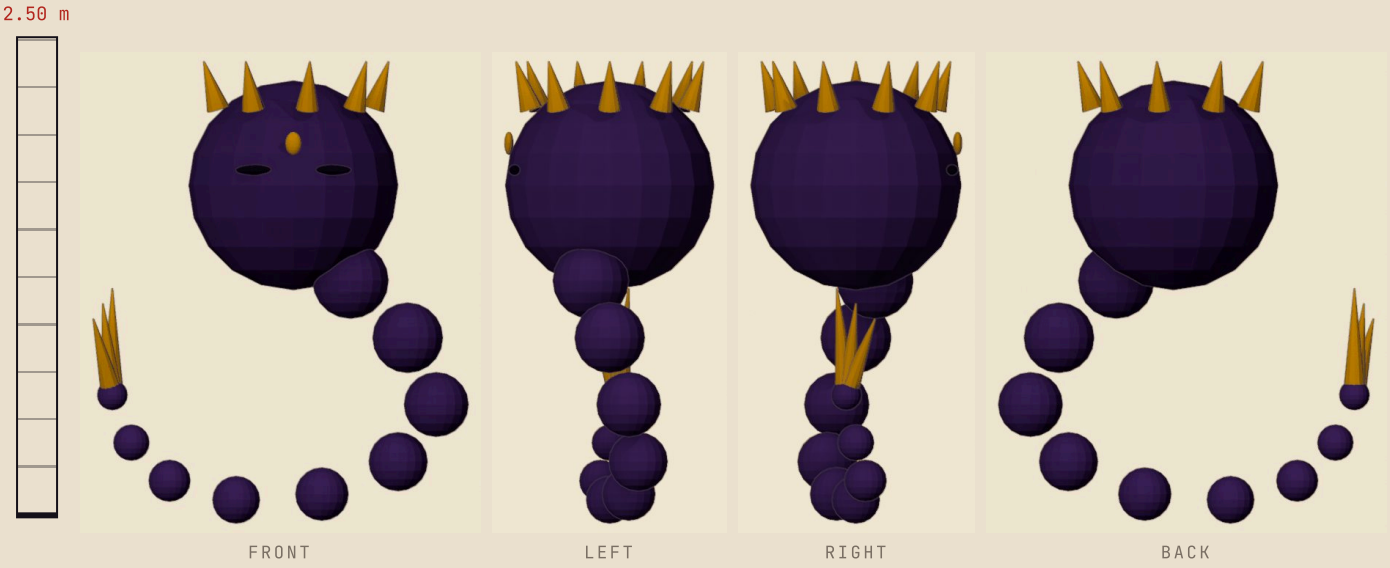
# Rahu & Ketu, the Eclipse

Eclipse
#4B2A6B

Corona
#F4A300

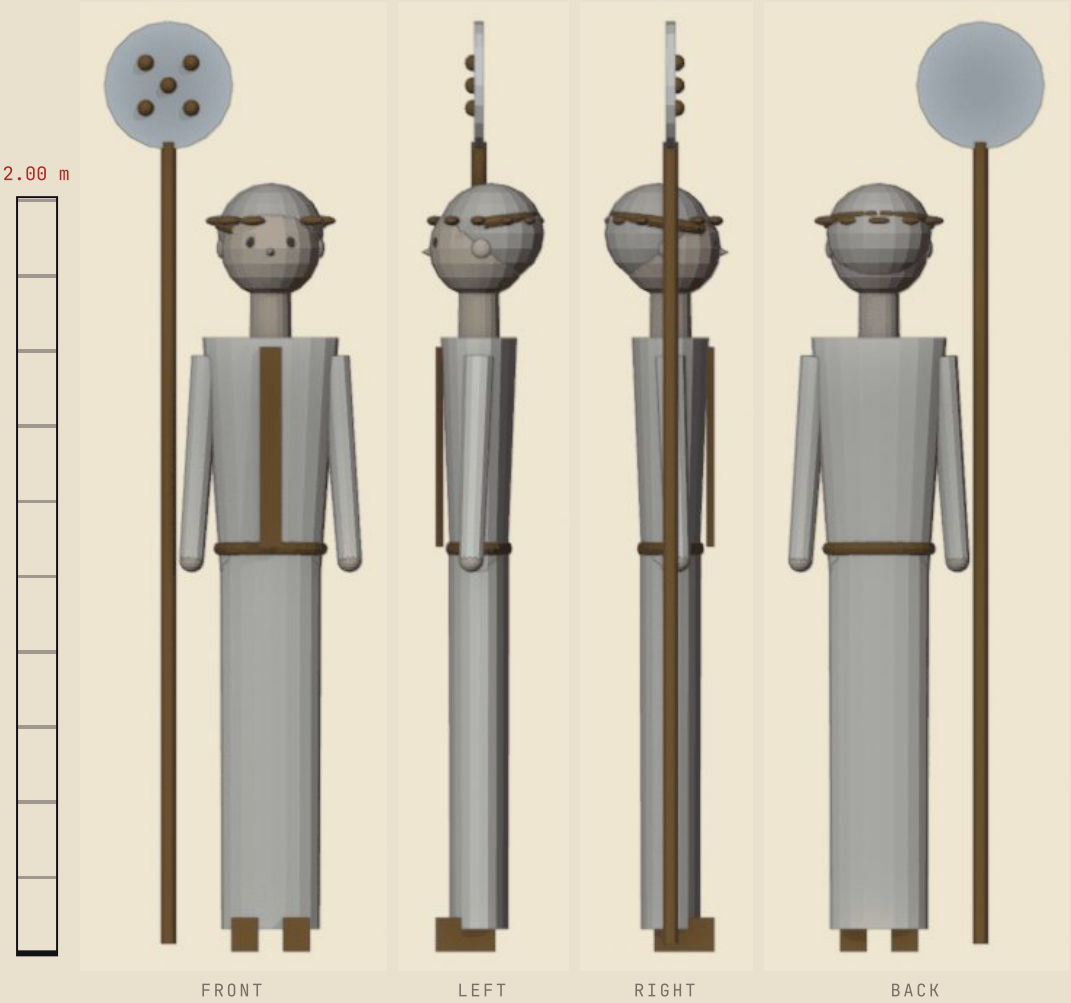
Night
#141018

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Bosses |
| ROLE | Act III boss (cultural review required) |
| LAND | Śūnyapura |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | eclipsed |
| HEIGHT | 2.50 m |




CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

# BOSSES Archon Seventeen



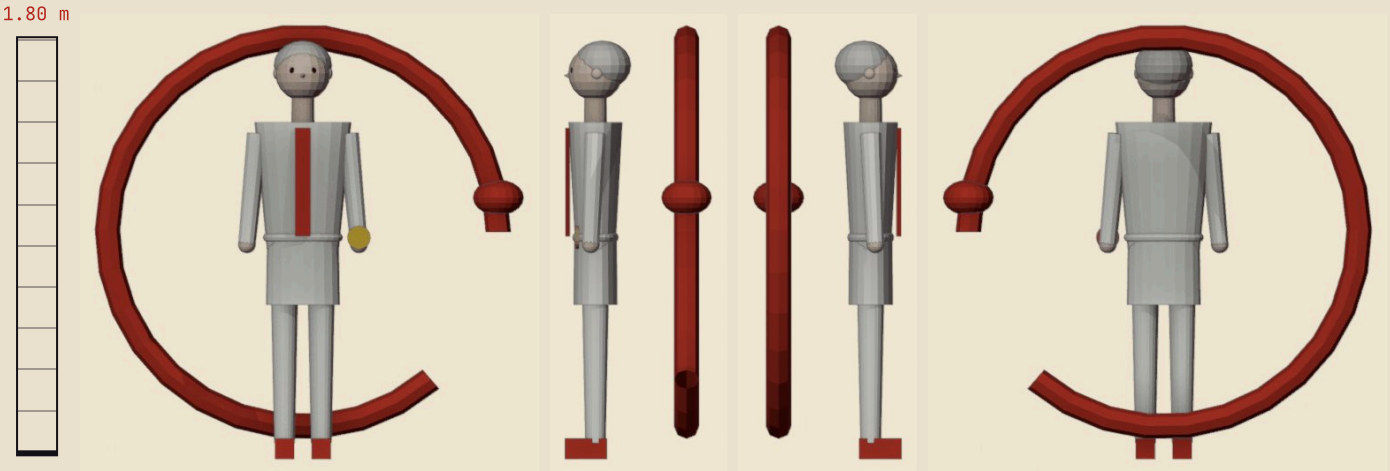

| | |
|---|---|
| Bronze #8C6A3F | |
| Chalk #F4F1EA | |
| Sieve white #DDE6EE | |
| GROUP | Bosses |
| ROLE | Act IV boss |
| LAND | Kroton Nova |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 17 |
| HEIGHT | 2.00 m |

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# BOSSES The House, Octavian Nine

| Ivory | Casino red | Gold |
|---|---|---|
| #F4F1EA | #C0392B | #D4AF37 |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Bosses |
| ROLE | Act V boss |
| LAND | The Crossroads |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 89 |
| HEIGHT | 1.80 m |




3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# BOSSES Comptroller Lucan Thale




Steel white

Brass
#B5A642

Nixie
#FF7A2C

Steel
#8E9196

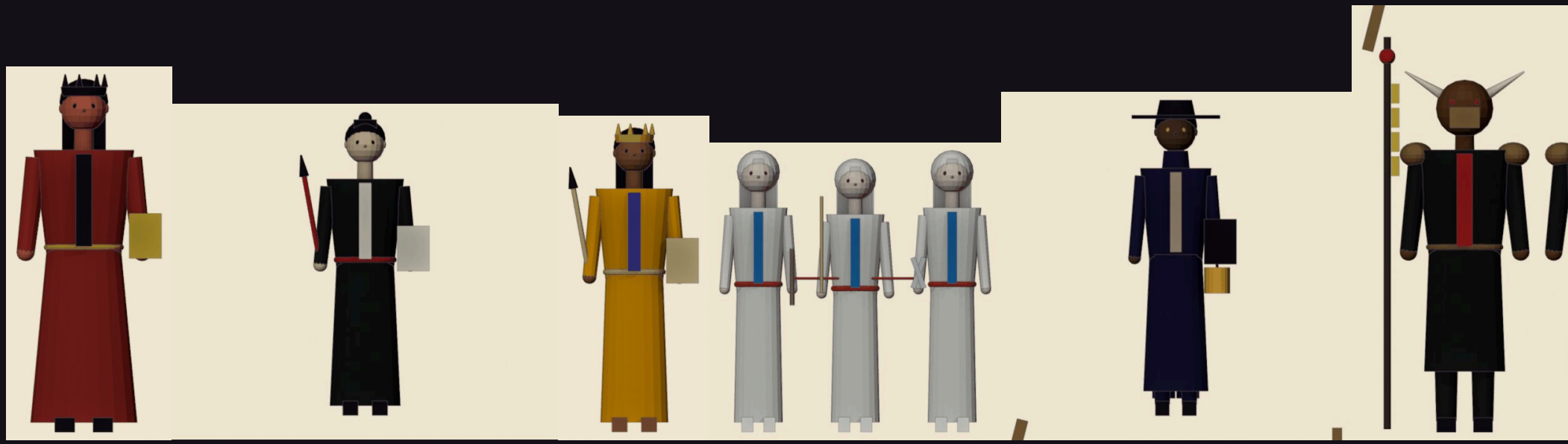
| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Bosses |
| ROLE | Final antagonist |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 50 (steel) |
| HEIGHT | 1.90 m |

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

THE CAST

# KEEPERS

6 models · front views at one shared scale.



Enma · Judge Cui · Chitragupta · The Moirai · The Stranger · Ox-Head and Horse

# KEEPERS Enma




Court red
#9E2B25

Black
#141018

Gold
#D4AF37

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Keepers |
| ROLE | Keeper of Hyakki's gate of the dead |
| LAND | Hyakki |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | — |
| HEIGHT | 2.15 m |

## DESIGN

A solemn judge in layered court robes and a judge's crown, holding the ledger of the dead. Shown with reverence: never monstrous.

## CANON LOCKS

- Never an enemy; his trial ends with a bow
- Design reviewed by a Japanese consultant before final art

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

# KEEPERS Judge Cui

Ink
#1B1B1B

Rice paper
#E9E2D0

Lacquer
#B22222

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Keepers |
| ROLE | Keeper of the Brush, the Ten Courts |
| LAND | River Empire |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | — |
| HEIGHT | 1.80 m |

## DESIGN

An official of the underworld courts in black robes with a giant brush and the Book of Life and Death.

## CANON LOCKS

- Writes every number twice
- Chinese consultant review




CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

# KEEPERS Chitragupta




Saffron #F4A300

Palm leaf #D8C08A

Indigo #3F3D99

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Keepers |
| ROLE | Keeper of the records of deeds |
| LAND | Śūnyapura |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | — |
| HEIGHT | 1.85 m |

## DESIGN

The divine scribe with a stylus and palm-leaf records. Placeholder blockout only: final design must come from Indian cultural consultants.

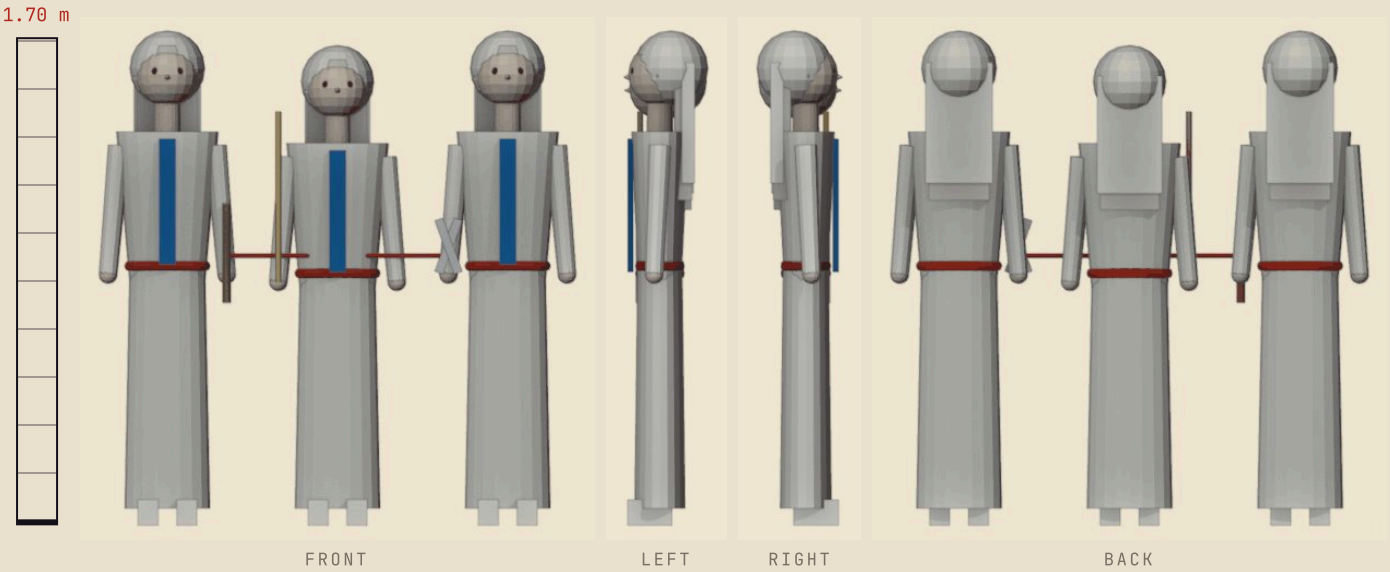
## CANON LOCKS

- Revered figure: no stylisation without consultant sign-off

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

KEEPERS

# The Moirai




| | |
|---|---|
| Chalk | #F4F1EA |
| Thread red | #C0392B |
| Aegean | #1F6FB2 |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Keepers |
| ROLE | Keepers of the thread (Clotho, Lachesis, Atropos) |
| LAND | Kroton Nova |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | — |
| HEIGHT | 1.70 m |

## DESIGN

Three sisters in white peplos and veils: Clotho with a spindle, Lachesis with a measuring rod, Atropos with shears; one red thread runs through all three.

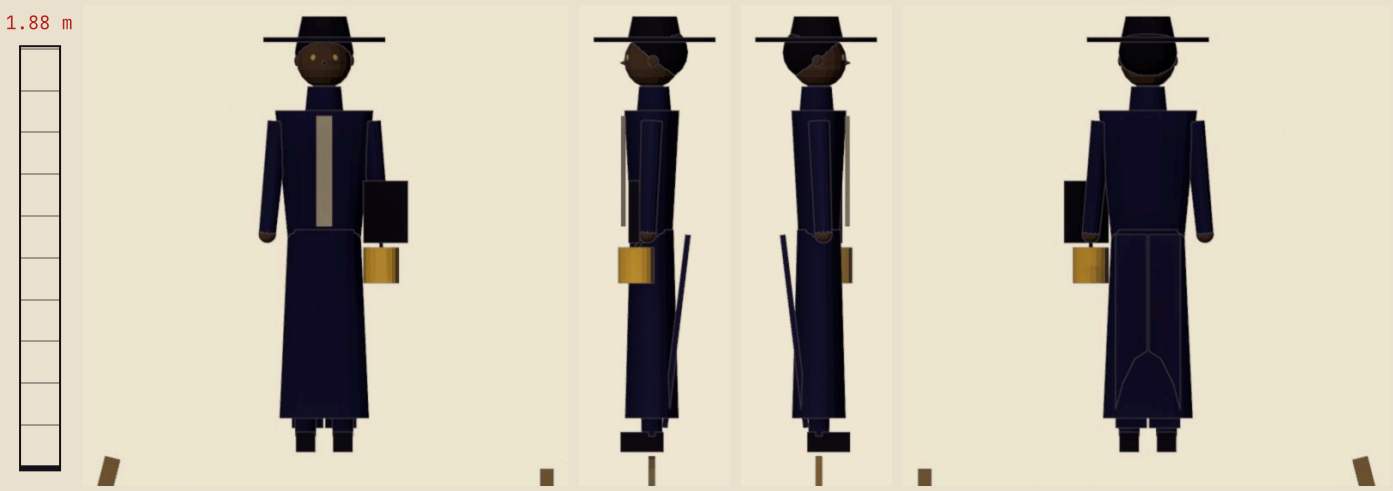
## CANON LOCKS

- Always three
- The red thread connects them

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

KEEPERS

# The Stranger




Midnight
#1D1A3A

Lamp gold
#F2B33D

Dust
#B9A58A

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Keepers |
| ROLE | Keeper of the crossroads |
| LAND | The Crossroads |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | — |
| HEIGHT | 1.88 m |

## DESIGN

A tall figure at the midnight crossroads with a long dusty coat, a wide hat and the black book. Fair, patient, never a devil.

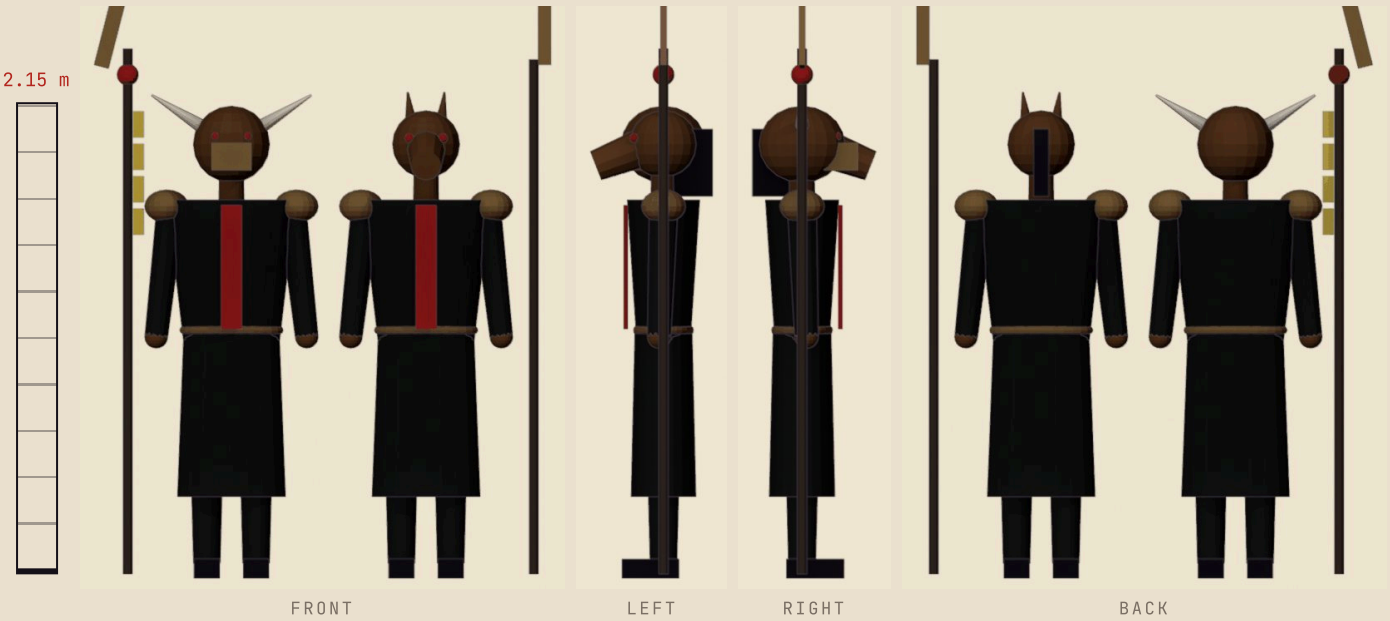
## CANON LOCKS

- Never a villain
- American consultant review of the blues crossroads legend

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

KEEPERS

# Ox-Head and Horse-Face




| | |
|---|---|
| Bronze | #8C6A3F |
| Ink | #1B1B1B |
| Lacquer | #B22222 |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Keepers |
| ROLE | Wardens of the Ten Courts (trial) |
| LAND | River Empire |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | — |
| HEIGHT | 2.15 m |

## DESIGN

Two towering wardens with an ox's head and a horse's head, in black lamellar armour, carrying halberds. A trial, not villains.

## CANON LOCKS

- Always a pair
- Shown as guardians, never demons

CULTURAL REVIEW REQUIRED

THE CAST

# THE GOD OF LUCK

1 model · front views at one shared scale.




Hap

THE GOD OF LUCK

# Hap




| | |
|---|---|
| Star black #141026 | |
| Dice ivory #F4F1EA | |
| Every land's accent #FF7A2C | |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | The god of luck |
| ROLE | The god of luck (never an enemy) |
| LAND | Everywhere |
| LUCKY DIGIT | 0–9 |
| OMEN | — |
| HEIGHT | 2.20 m |

## DESIGN

A vast, gentle figure of night sky: a robe full of stars, two dice for eyes, every digit 0–9 orbiting its head, and the open hand with a die. Its face changes per land; the dice eyes and orbiting digits never do.

## CANON LOCKS

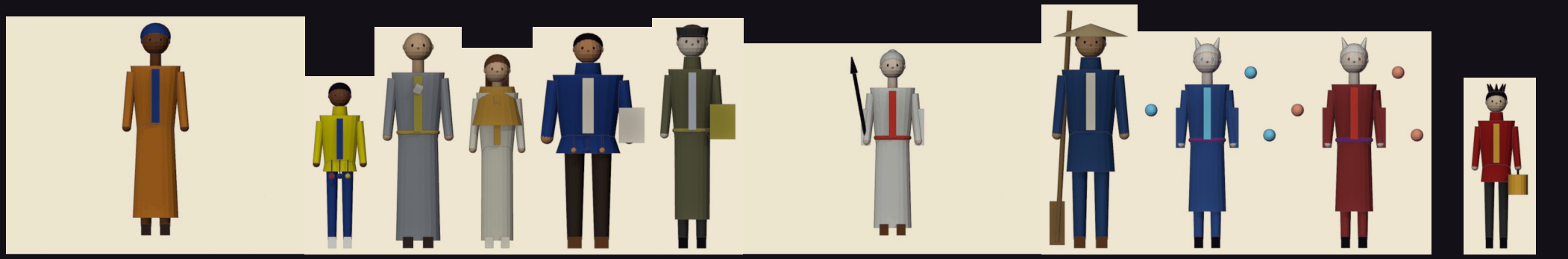
- Never the same face twice
- Never a monster or a stand-in for a real deity

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

THE CAST

# STORY CHARACTERS

18 models · front views at one shared scale.



STORY CHARACTERS

# Ama Okoro

Wax print
#D9822B

Indigo
#26428B

Ash
#8A7F72

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Wards mother; the intro's Omen 01 |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 01→07 |
| HEIGHT | 1.66 m |

## DESIGN

A wax-print dress under a worn Remainder shawl, a head wrap, a laundry bag. Tired, proud.

## CANON LOCKS

- Her Omen goes 01 → 07 in the intro




3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Tobi Okoro




Hoodie yellow
#F5E400

Denim
#26428B

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Ama's son, age 9; NIL's first follower |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 31 |
| HEIGHT | 1.30 m |

## DESIGN

Oversized yellow hoodie with a hand-painted 7, patched jeans, a string of bottle-cap charms.

## CANON LOCKS

- Counts NIL's wins on his fingers

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Brother Nought




| | |
|---|---|
| Faded steel | #9CA0A6 |
| Brass | #B5A642 |
| Open Hand gold | #D4AF37 |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Defrocked Ledger-priest; secret Open Hand |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 09 |
| HEIGHT | 1.72 m |

## DESIGN

A Ledger-priest's steel-grey robe with the seals torn off; a die on a string where the Basilica pendant should be.

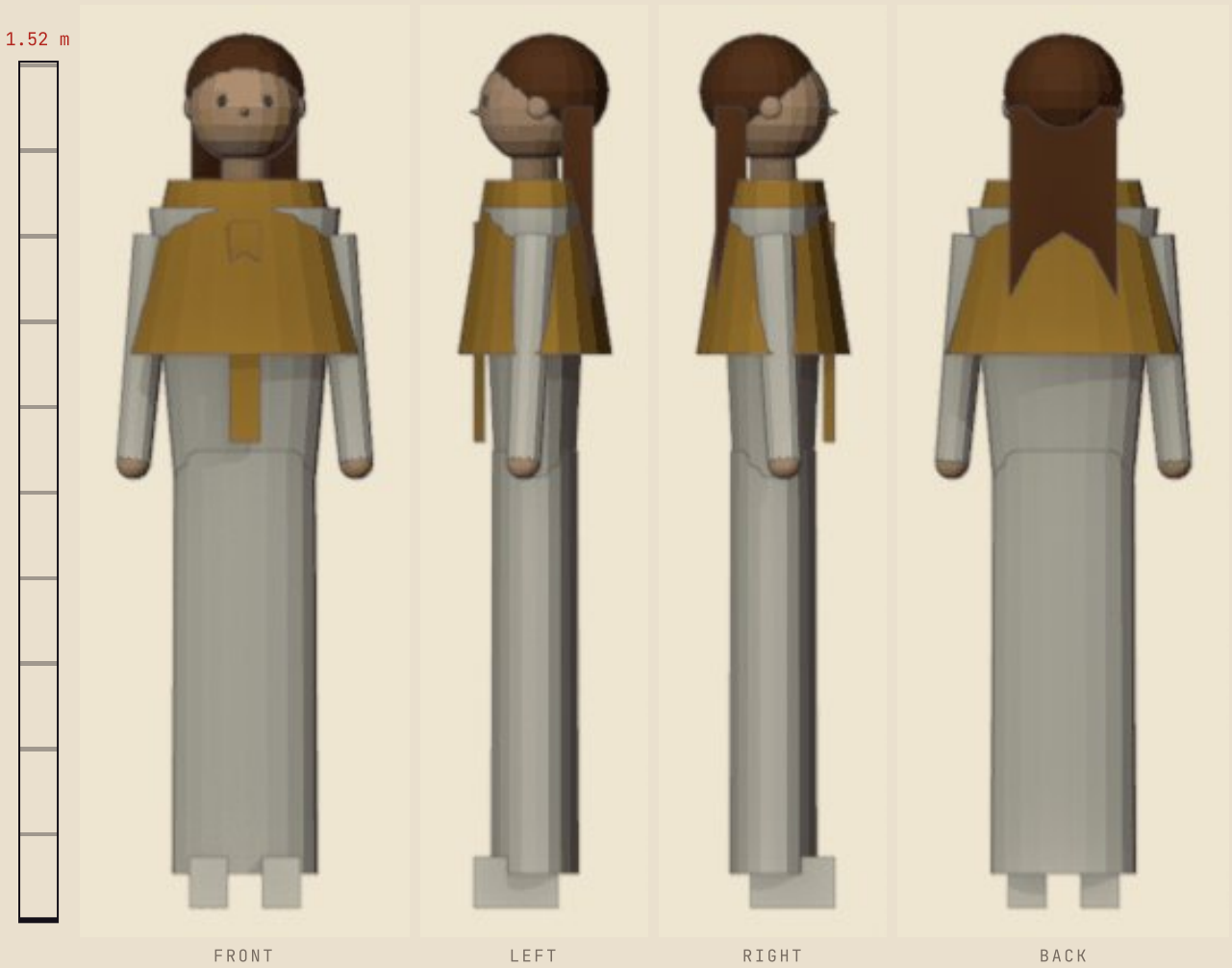
## CANON LOCKS

- Rounds everything up out of spite

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Livia Kade




Blanket
#C8963E

Nightgown
#E9E2D0

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Varro's sister, Omen 06 |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 06 |
| HEIGHT | 1.52 m |

## DESIGN

Thin, wrapped in a mustard blanket over a nightgown; a dog-shaped charm her brother carved.

## CANON LOCKS

- Never seen outside until Act V

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Gus Mendoza




| | |
|---|---|
| Bowling shirt | #26428B |
| Gold chains | #D4AF37 |
| Cream | #F2E8D5 |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Charm Bazaar fixer |
| LAND | Meridian / Crossroads |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 47 |
| HEIGHT | 1.70 m |

## DESIGN

A bowling shirt covered in every culture's charms, gold chains, a receipt book.

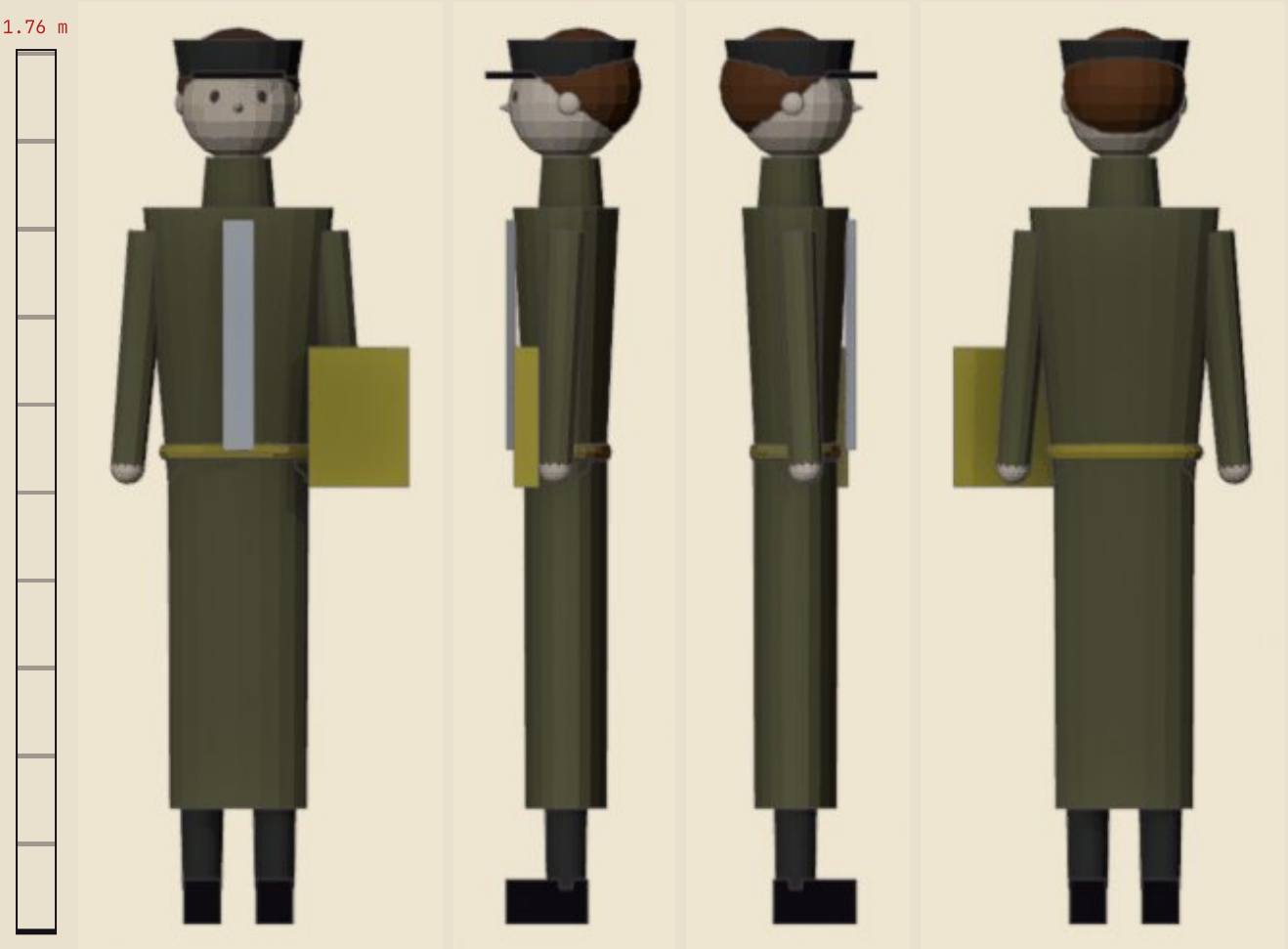
## CANON LOCKS

- Haggles in sevens

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Clerk Ivo Marr




Ledger olive #6E6B4E

Steel #C9CED6

Brass #B5A642

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Thale's assistant (defects in the finale) |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 50 |
| HEIGHT | 1.76 m |

## DESIGN

Basilica clerk's olive uniform, sleeve guards, a ledger held like a shield.

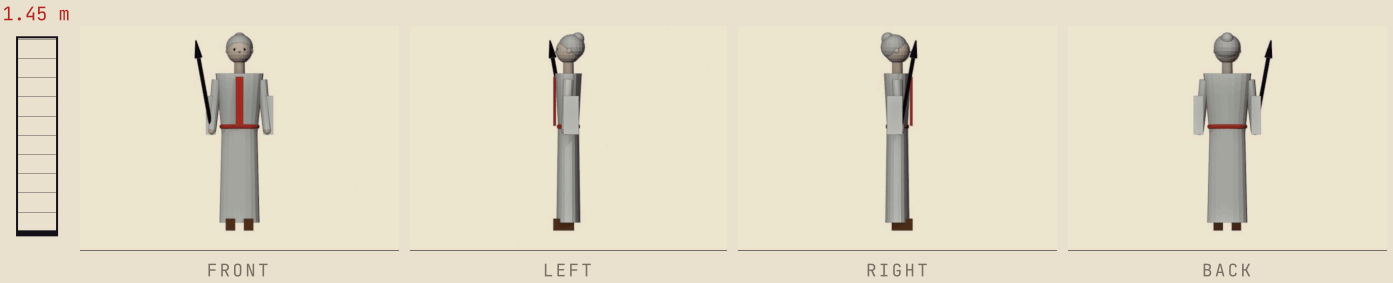
## CANON LOCKS

- Files everything in triplicate

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Ofuku




| | |
|---|---|
| Shrine white | #F4F1EA |
| Vermilion | #E34234 |
| Daruma red | #C0392B |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Keeper of the Seven Lucky Gods' shrine |
| LAND | Hyakki |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 77 |
| HEIGHT | 1.45 m |

## DESIGN

An elderly shrine keeper in white and red, a calligraphy brush for daruma eyes.

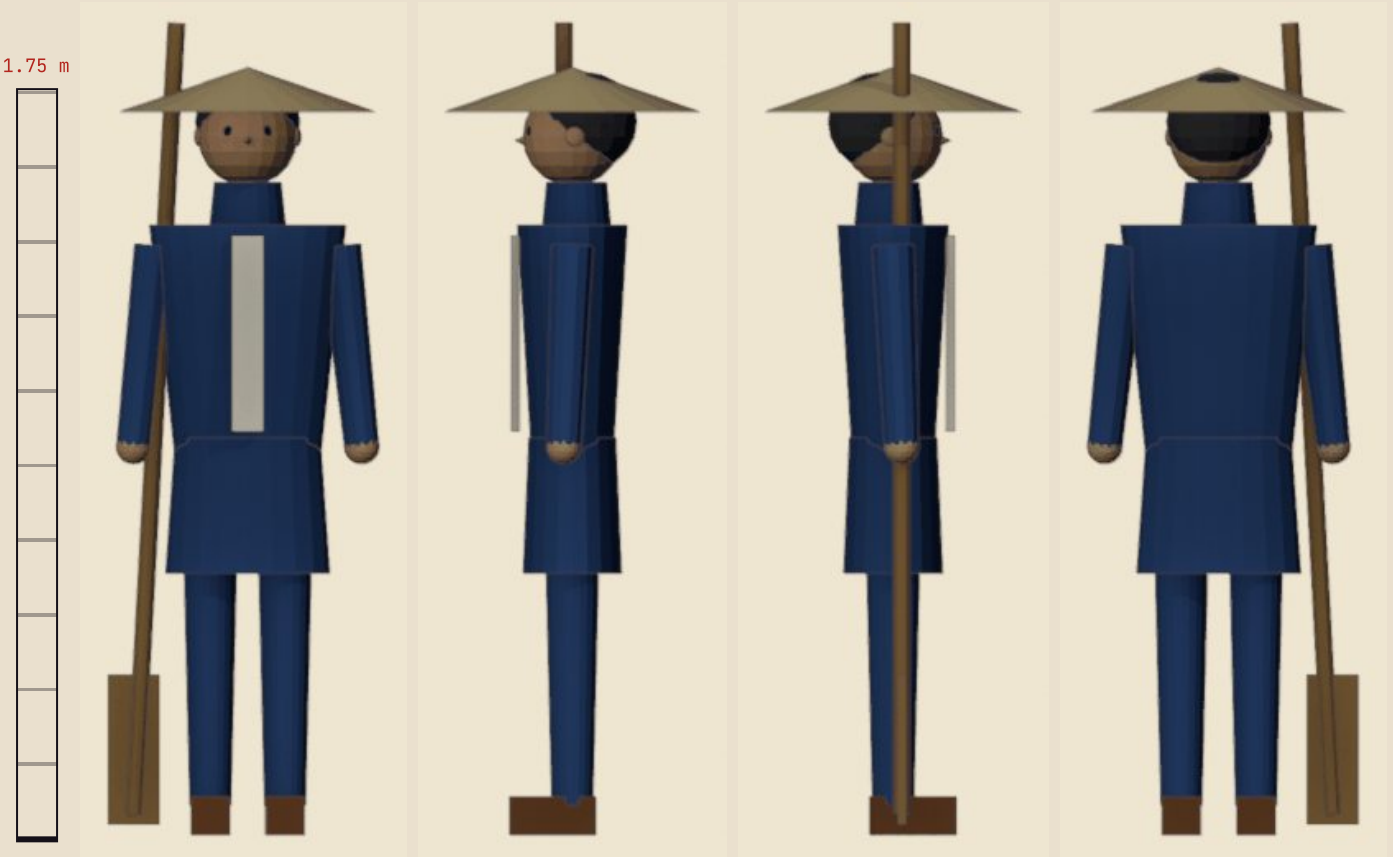
## CANON LOCKS

- Paints one daruma eye a day

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Tetsu




Indigo work
#2E4A7A

Straw
#D8C08A

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Ferryman; former Collector |
| LAND | Hyakki |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 38 |
| HEIGHT | 1.75 m |

## DESIGN

Indigo work jacket over a Collector's old undershirt, a wide straw hat, a long oar.

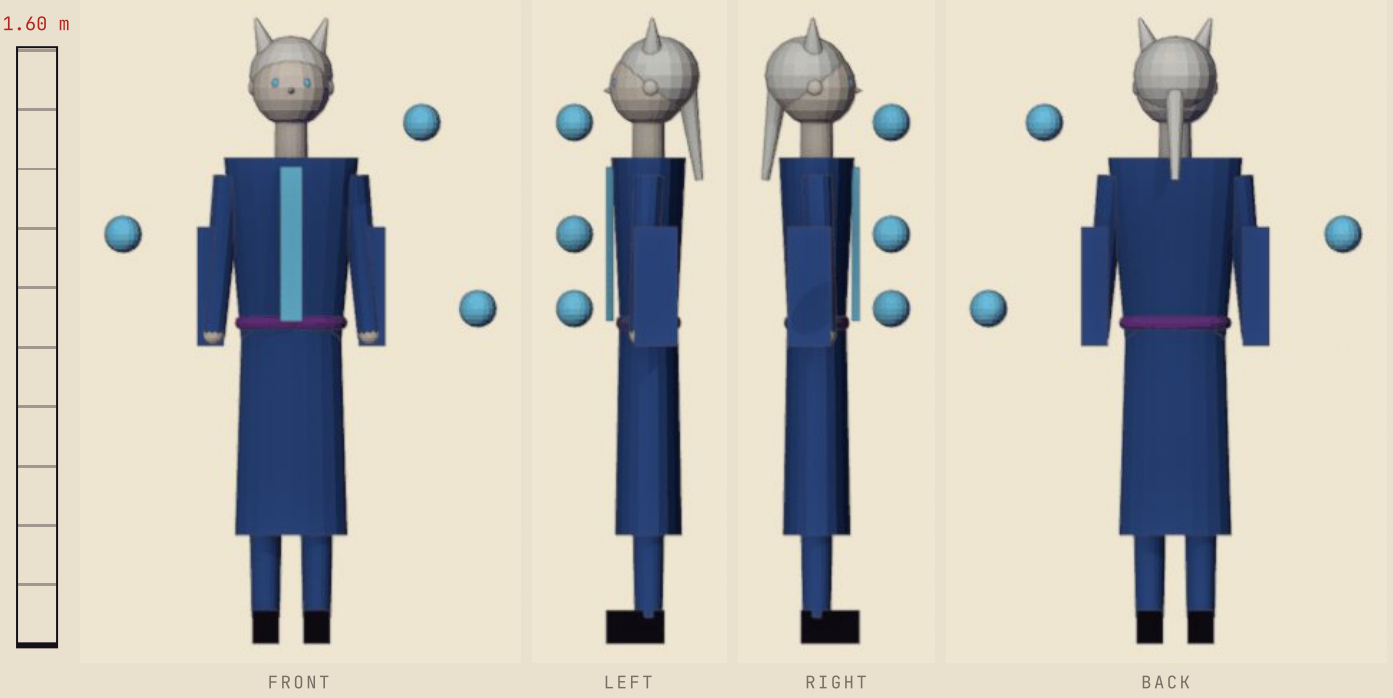
## CANON LOCKS

- Counts strokes of the oar

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Ao (Kitsune twin)




Foxfire blue
#7FDBFF

Violet
#8E44AD

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Tamamo's foxfire retainer |
| LAND | Hyakki |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 44 |
| HEIGHT | 1.60 m |

## DESIGN

Blue twin of the pair; fox ears, a single tail, cold blue foxfire.

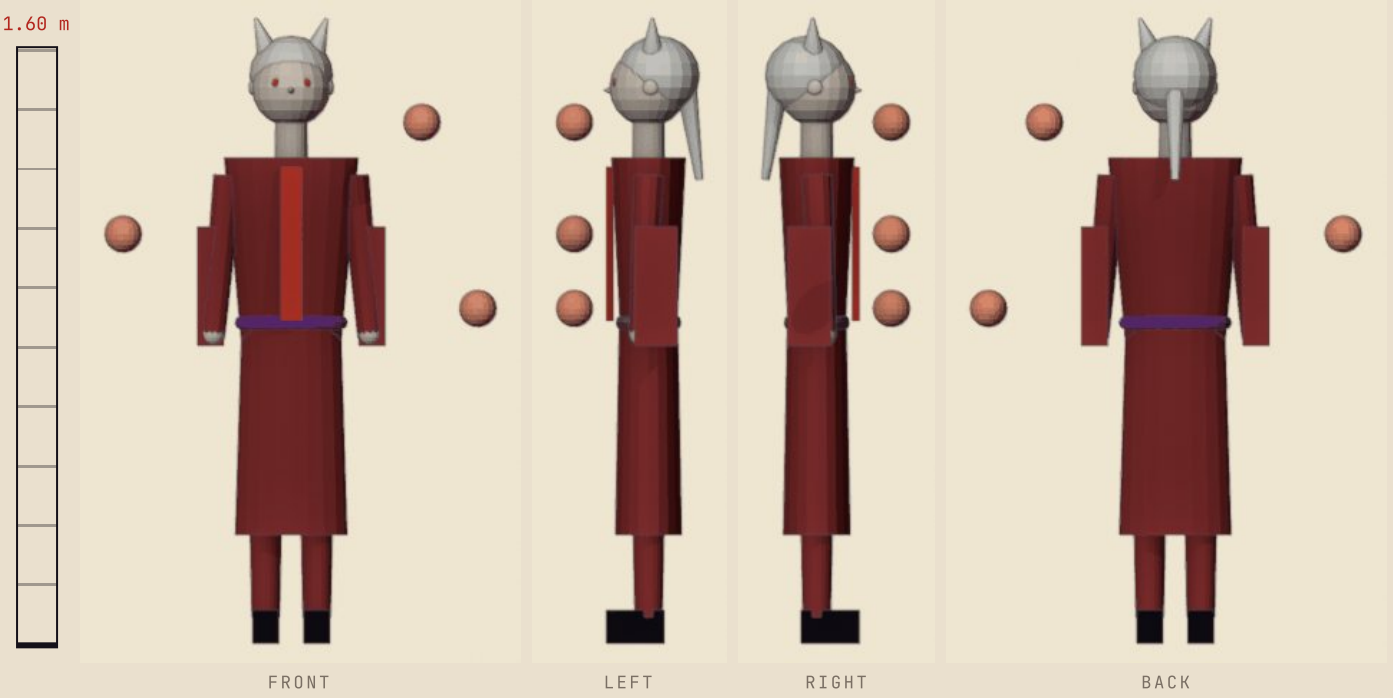
## CANON LOCKS

- Speaks only in pairs with Aka

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Aka (Kitsune twin)




Foxfire red
#E34234

Violet
#8E44AD

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Tamamo's foxfire retainer |
| LAND | Hyakki |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 44 |
| HEIGHT | 1.60 m |

## DESIGN

Red twin; mirror of Ao (his ponytail on the other side).

## CANON LOCKS

- Mirror of Ao

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Little Lantern (Xiao Deng)




Festival red
#B22222

Lantern gold
#F2B33D

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Festival orphan messenger |
| LAND | River Empire |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 18 |
| HEIGHT | 1.25 m |

## DESIGN

A too-big red festival jacket, a paper lantern on a stick, quick feet.

## CANON LOCKS

- Counts lanterns

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Acharya Vidya Rao




| | |
|---|---|
| Khadi white | #F4F1EA |
| Saffron | #F4A300 |
| Brass | #B5893B |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Shunya's teacher, the observatory |
| LAND | Śūnyapura |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 70 |
| HEIGHT | 1.70 m |

## DESIGN

White kurta and shawl, round spectacles, a walking stick, star charts under the arm.

## CANON LOCKS

- Counts in Sanskrit numerals

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# STORY CHARACTERS Meera

Peacock
#1E7B6F

Sandstone
#D8A86B

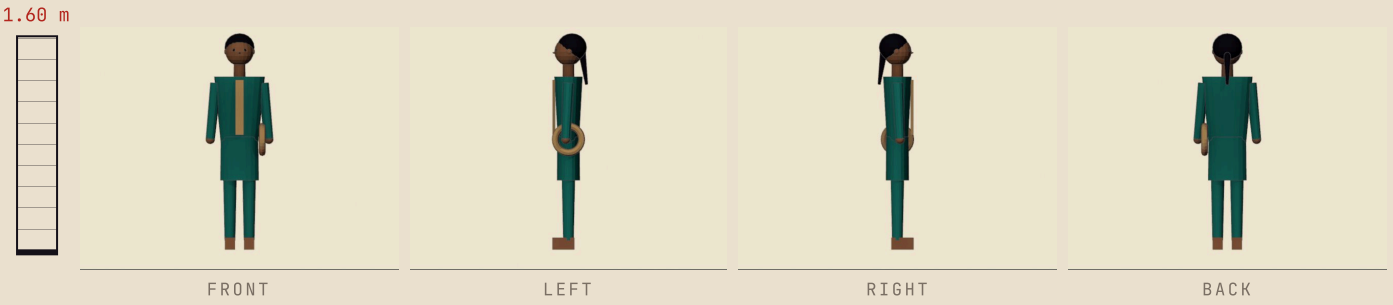
| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Stepwell guide and diver |
| LAND | Śūnyapura |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 21 |
| HEIGHT | 1.60 m |

## DESIGN

A peacock-green diving tunic, a coil of rope, a lamp on her belt.

## CANON LOCKS

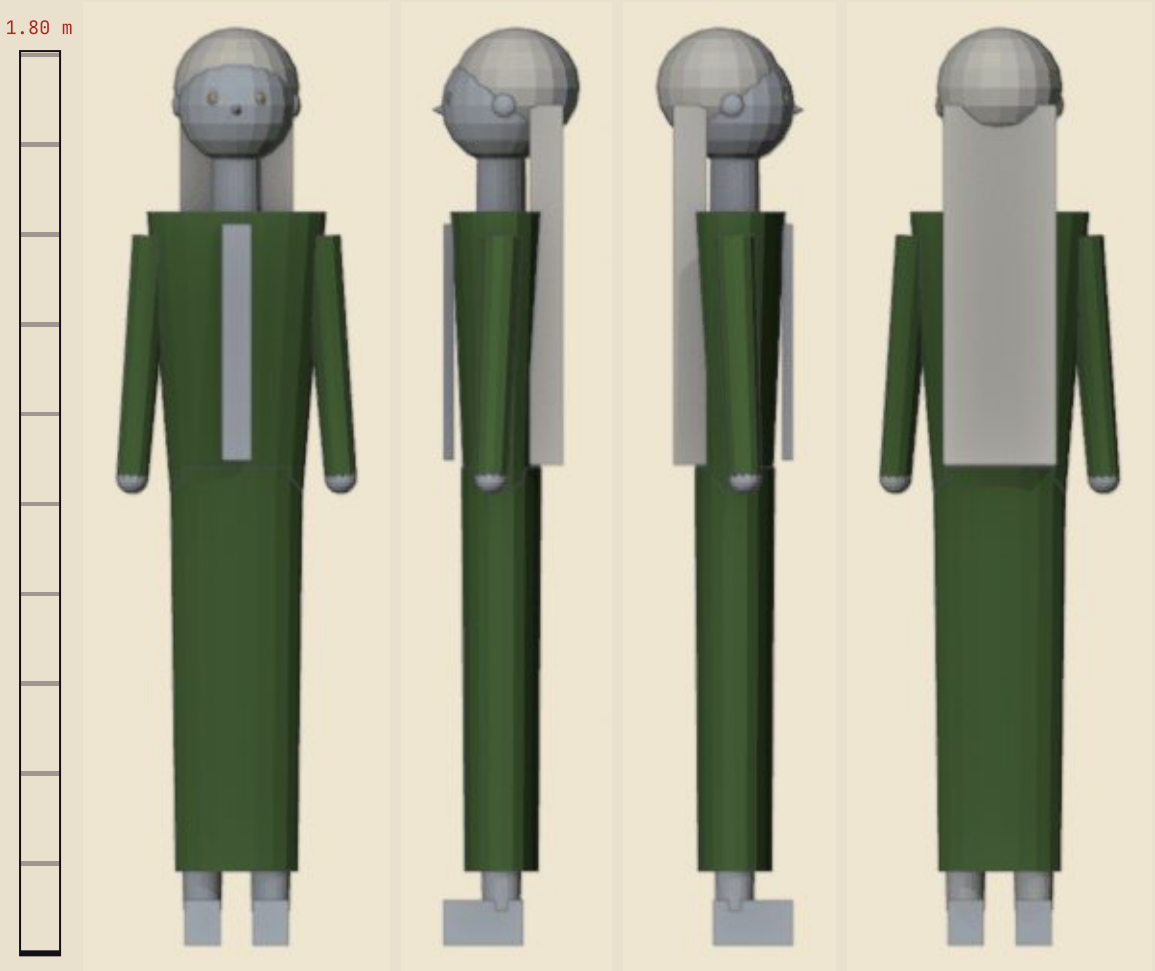
- Counts the 1,001 steps




3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Baital




Ghost pale
#C9CED6

Banyan
#5E7D4A

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Vetāla who riddles travellers |
| LAND | Śūnyapura |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | ?? |
| HEIGHT | 1.80 m |

## DESIGN

A gaunt, pale spirit draped in banyan-green cloth who hangs upside down from a branch to ask riddles. Eerie, witty, never gory.

## CANON LOCKS

- Answers only in questions

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Mother Kallisto




Patched blue
#4A6E8C

Scrap brass
#B5A642

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Leader of the undercity of the fallen |
| LAND | Kroton Nova |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 24 |
| HEIGHT | 1.68 m |

## DESIGN

A patched blue peplos stitched with Basilica scrap, a tall staff of welded pipe.

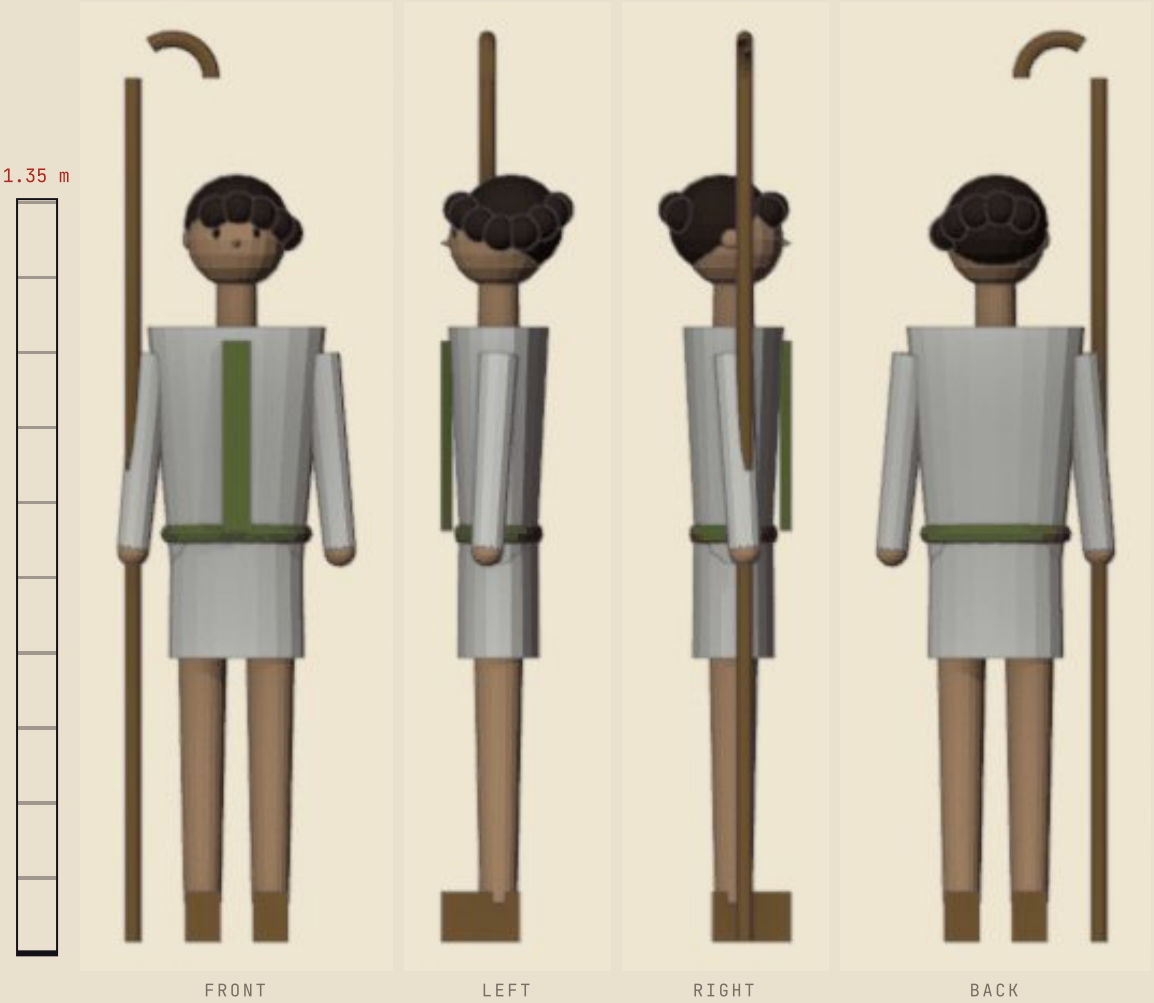
## CANON LOCKS

- Counts in composites, proudly

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Niko




Olive
#7A8B4A

Chalk
#F4F1EA

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Goat-herd kid |
| LAND | Kroton Nova |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 12 |
| HEIGHT | 1.35 m |

## DESIGN

A chalk-white tunic with an olive sash, a crook taller than he is.

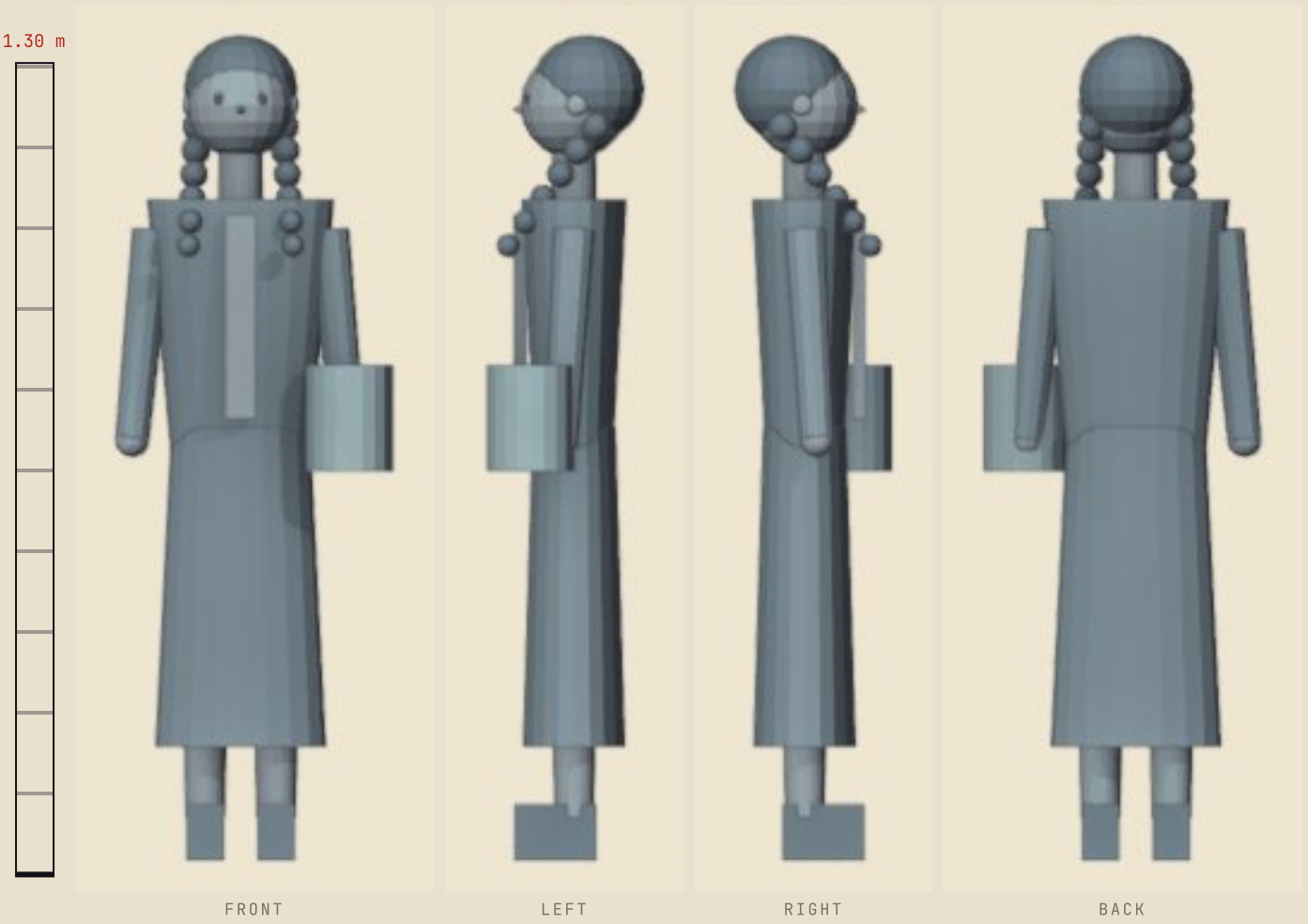
## CANON LOCKS

- Always one goat short

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Penny




Ghost blue
#C9D6DE

Copper
#B87333

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Ghost girl on the railway |
| LAND | The Crossroads |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 01 |
| HEIGHT | 1.30 m |

## DESIGN

A translucent pale-blue pinafore dress from another century, pigtails, a jar of 1,596 copper pennies.

## CANON LOCKS

- Never smiles until the 1,597th penny

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

STORY CHARACTERS

# Sheriff Dolores Vance




| | |
|---|---|
| Sage | #9CAF88 |
| Rust | #B7410E |
| Badge gold | #D4AF37 |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Story characters |
| ROLE | Lucky Strike's sheriff |
| LAND | The Crossroads |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 11 |
| HEIGHT | 1.75 m |

## DESIGN

Sage duster, rust shirt, a notched star badge, a cattleman hat.

## CANON LOCKS

- Notches her badge each night

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

THE CAST

# FACTIONS AND JOBS

9 models · front views at one shared scale.



# Collector

Rust
#B7410E

Gunmetal
#4A4E54

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Factions and jobs |
| ROLE | The Collectors · bailiff |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 40–60 |
| HEIGHT | 1.88 m |

## DESIGN

Rust armoured trench coat, peaked cap, a ledger chained to the belt, debt jars.

## CANON LOCKS

- Never glowing numbers: Collectors wear steel




3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

FACTIONS AND JOBS

# Ledger-priest




Steel white
#E8E6E1

Brass
#B5A642

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Factions and jobs |
| ROLE | The Basilica · clergy of the Dawn Tally |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 50 |
| HEIGHT | 1.80 m |

## DESIGN

White-and-brass vestments, a tall gear-crested mitre, a chained ledger.

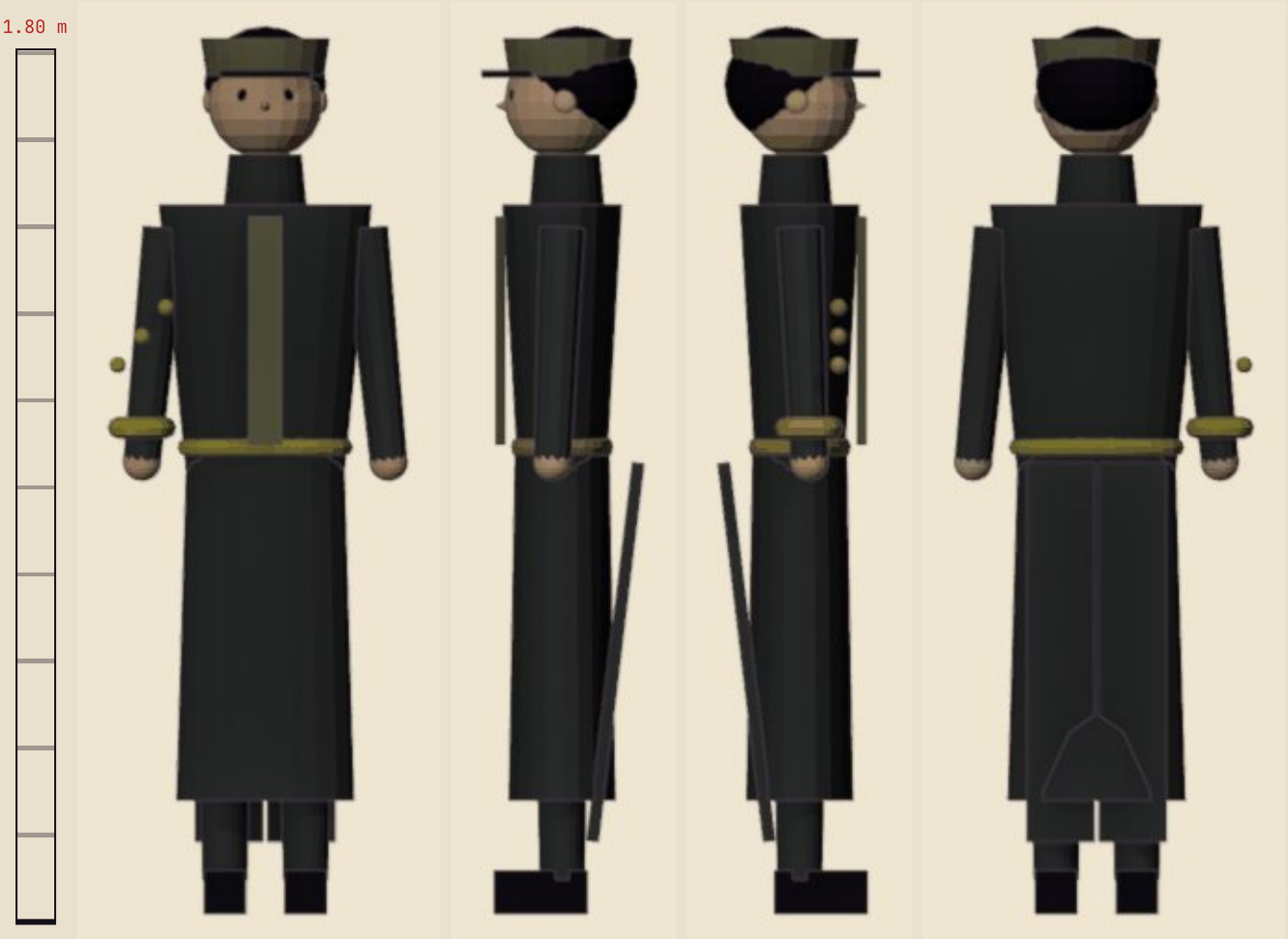
## CANON LOCKS

- Steel numerals only

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

FACTIONS AND JOBS

# Basilica Auditor




| | |
|---|---|
| Olive | #6E6B4E |
| Brass | #B5A642 |
| Nixie | #FF7A2C |

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Factions and jobs |
| ROLE | The Basilica · licensed Auditor |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 60–80 |
| HEIGHT | 1.80 m |

## DESIGN

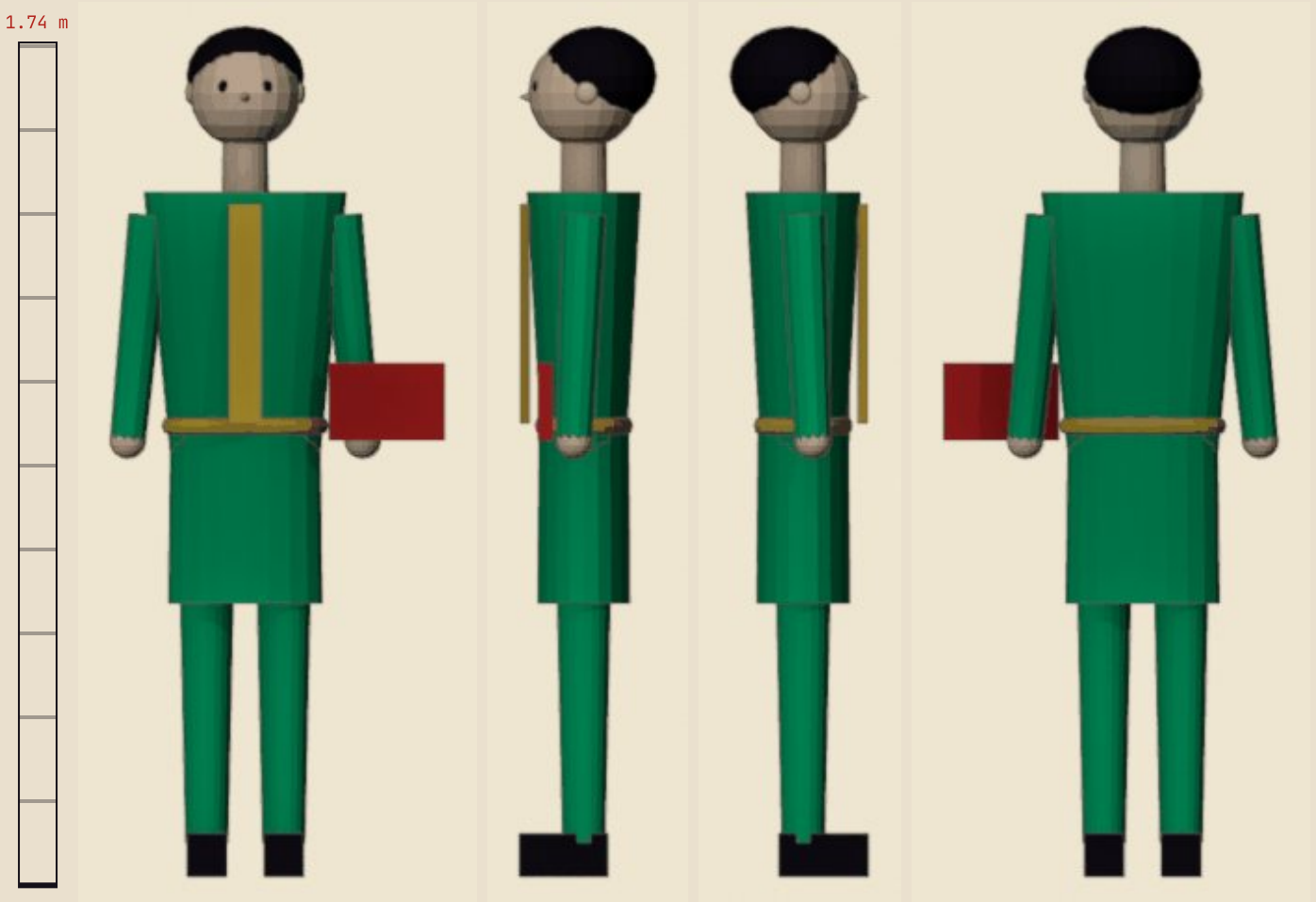
Dark field coat with a licensed brass wrist-wheel (a lawful decoder), olive cap. They summon Fate Wheels by law.

## CANON LOCKS

- Licence number on the wrist-wheel

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# Exchange Broker




Jade
#00A86B

Gold
#D4AF37

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Factions and jobs |
| ROLE | The Luck Exchange · trader |
| LAND | River Empire |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 88 |
| HEIGHT | 1.74 m |

## DESIGN

Jade mandarin-collar suit, gold trim, a pocket abacus, an ear-clip price ticker.

## CANON LOCKS

- Gold numerals: Gilded Fortune

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

FACTIONS AND JOBS

# Charm Bazaar local




Magenta #FF2E88

Sign yellow #F5E400

Cyan #00E5FF

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Factions and jobs |
| ROLE | Charm Bazaar guilds · street |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 17–77 |
| HEIGHT | 1.70 m |

## DESIGN

A puffer jacket hung with every culture's charms, a painted lucky number, a fake holo-halo.

## CANON LOCKS

- Charmpunk: luck over sense

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

# Wards mechanic




Ash
#8A7F72

Old brass
#C8963E

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Factions and jobs |
| ROLE | Remainder Wards · worker |
| LAND | Meridian |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 03–20 |
| HEIGHT | 1.76 m |

## DESIGN

Patched poncho, scrap-brass tools, a cracked Nixie tube on a cord instead of a glowing Omen.

## CANON LOCKS

- Remainder: survival over luck

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

FACTIONS AND JOBS

# Composite Knight

Bronze
#8C6A3F

Chalk
#F4F1EA

Aegean
#1F6FB2

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Factions and jobs |
| ROLE | The Pythagorean Synod · guard |
| LAND | Kroton Nova |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | prime |
| HEIGHT | 1.90 m |

## DESIGN

Bronze cuirass, chalk tunic, a round shield pierced like a sieve.

## CANON LOCKS

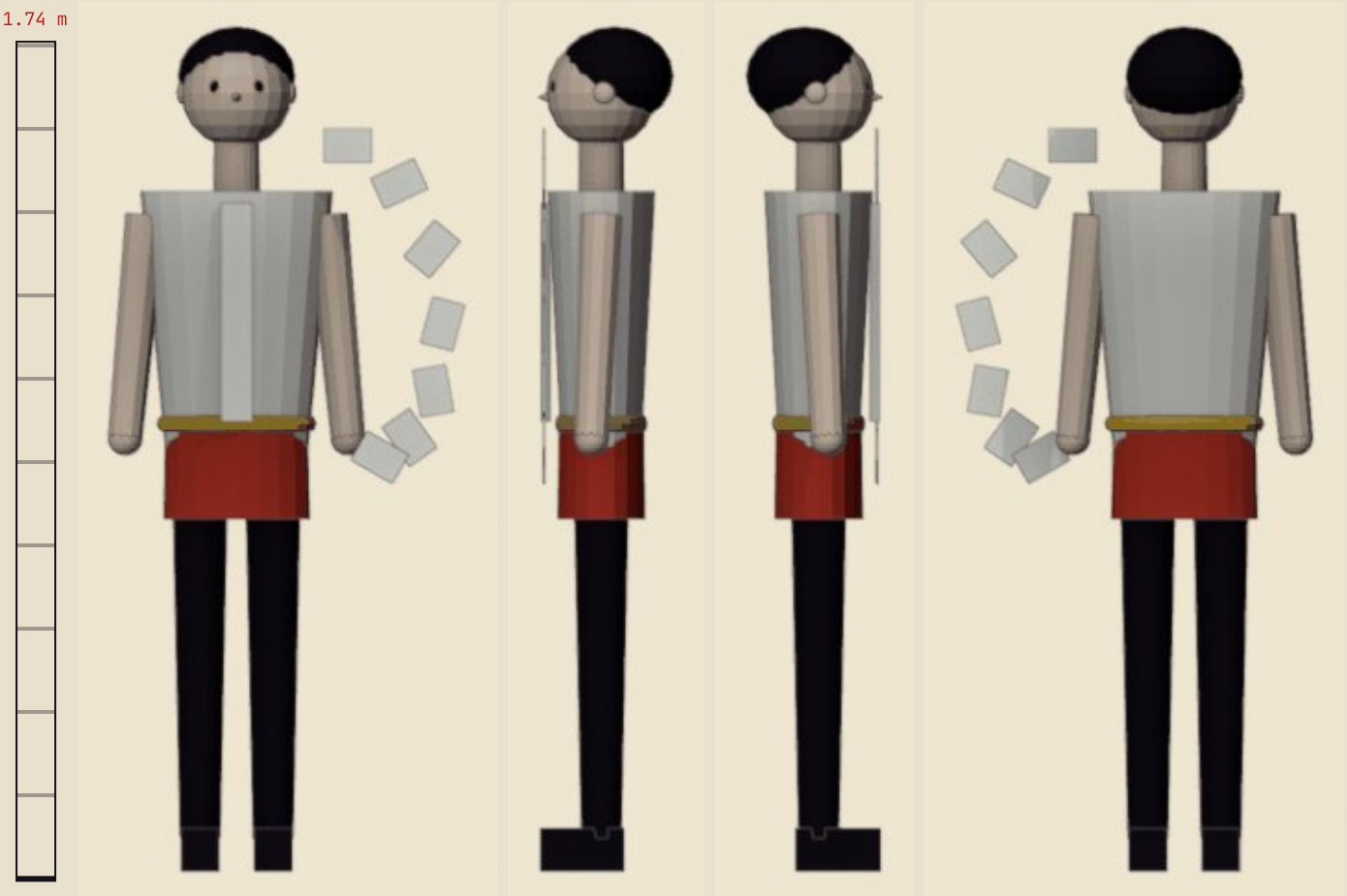
- Shield glyph 4·6·8·9




3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

FACTIONS AND JOBS

# House dealer




Casino red
#C0392B

Black
#141018

Gold
#D4AF37

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Factions and jobs |
| ROLE | The House · croupier |
| LAND | The Crossroads |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | 21 |
| HEIGHT | 1.74 m |

## DESIGN

Red waistcoat, sleeve garters, a green-felt card tray.

## CANON LOCKS

- Never counts money at the table

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

FACTIONS AND JOBS

# Open Hand pilgrim




Road dust
#B9A58A

Open Hand gold
#D4AF37

| | |
|---|---|
| GROUP | Factions and jobs |
| ROLE | The Open Hand · outlawed faith of Hap |
| LAND | Everywhere |
| LUCKY DIGIT | — |
| OMEN | any |
| HEIGHT | 1.70 m |

## DESIGN

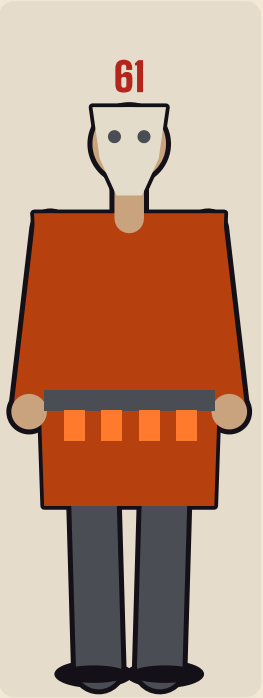
A travelling cloak, a carved open hand on a cord, a die worn smooth by thumbs.

## CANON LOCKS

- The die is never weighted

3D BLOCKOUT · FIRST DRAFT

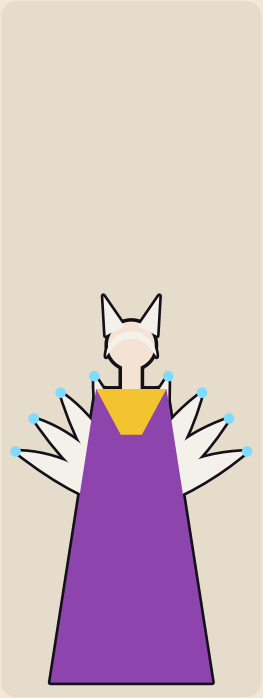
# AUDITORS




## Varro Kade

PROLOGUE BOSS → ALLY · MERIDIAN

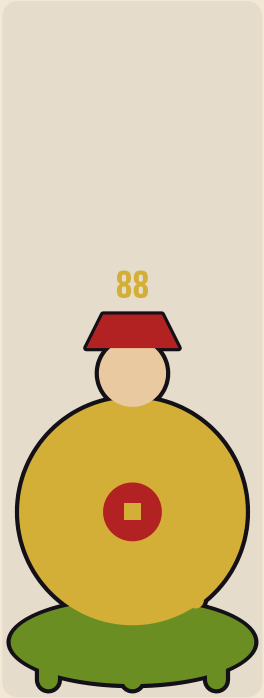
Steals your last reel digit into a debt jar; 3 parries shatter it



## Tamamo

ACT I BOSS · HYAKKI

9 tails, each with its own small Balance; foxfire illusion faces on your wheels (show one digit, land as another); 9s curse you unless Hina is in the party




## Chancellor Jin Chan

ACT II BOSS · RIVER EMPIRE

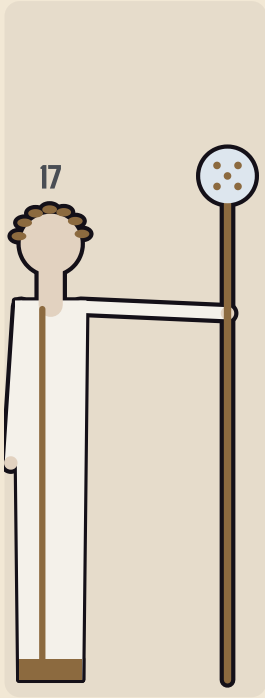
His Balance gains interest each round; taxes your Jackpots; phase 2 swallows a hero (land a Pair to free them)



## Rahu & Ketu

ACT III BOSS · ŚŪNYAPURA

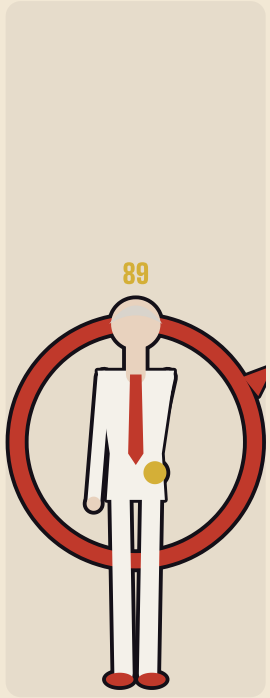
Two bodies: Rahu darkens one reel tube each round; Ketu strikes with a blind random wheel; if their Balances drift >10% apart they rejoin and heal




## Archon Seventeen

ACT IV BOSS · KROTON NOVA

Strikes digits off your wheels each round (Sieve of Eratosthenes); composite strikes halved




## The House

ACT V BOSS · CROSSROADS

Rewinds time every 3 rounds (your reel and charms persist); copies your last pattern; offers a mid-fight deal




## Comptroller Lucan Thale

FINAL ANTAGONIST · MERIDIAN

P1 Regression to the Mean · P2 Fixed Fate (wheels don't spin: a puzzle) · P3 Zero (NIL alone; companions return as Link Arts)

---

**Keepers, not villains.** Enma (Hyakki) · Judge Cui (the Ten Courts) · Chitragupta (Śūnyapura) · the Moirai (Kroton Nova) · the Stranger (the Crossroads). Shown with reverence, never as monsters; they test the party and are never "defeated", only satisfied (World Bible §10).

# FACTIONS & SYMBOLS




## The Basilica

A brass gear around the Basilica's eye, which reads as a 0. Order, the Ledger, Fixed Fate.



## The Collectors

A hound skull on a ledger seal. Debts and bounties.




## Charm Bazaar guilds

A ring of mixed charms around a lucky 7. Folk luck, trade, survival.



## The Yokai Courts

Nine foxfire flames around a violet heart. The spirits of Hyakki.



## The Luck Exchange

The three-legged money toad with a coin. Luck as profit.



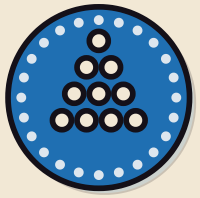
## The Ten Courts

The Judge's brush over the river of the dead.



## The Observatory

An astrolabe around a zero. Truth by measurement.



## The Pythagorean Synod

The tetractys of ten dots inside a sieve ring. Purity of number.




## The House

The ouroboros around 89. The night that never ends.

# CHARMS OF THE WORLD



### Beckoning Cat
HYAKKI
+1 fen per strike ending in your digit



### Daruma
HYAKKI
When you land your digit three times in a fight, paint the second eye: ×2 Mult for the rest of the fight



### Red Envelope
RIVER EMPIRE
+8 fen on a Jackpot



### Door God
RIVER EMPIRE
Parries also deal the enemy's strike back



### Lemon and Seven Chillies
ŚŪNYAPURA
Cancels one enemy curse per fight; +7 tens per 7 on the reel



### 108 Beads
ŚŪNYAPURA
Every 108th point of damage in a round counts double (rewards huge numbers)



### Evil-Eye Bead
KROTON NOVA
The enemy's wheel shows its next digit faintly



### Fortuna's Wheel
KROTON NOVA
Once per fight, spin the reel itself: all three digits re-roll



### Horseshoe
CROSSROADS
Your digit's cells are 50% wider



### Seven-Come-Eleven Dice
CROSSROADS
If a round's strikes total 7 or 11 (or 70/110/700…), ×7 Mult



### Four-Leaf Clover
MERIDIAN (CELTIC)
1-in-4 chance per strike to duplicate its digit on the reel



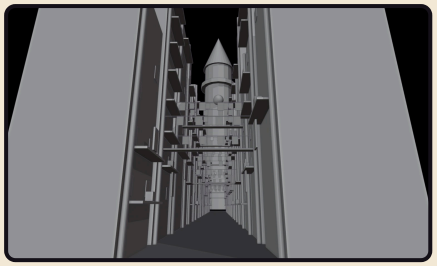
### Black Cat
MERIDIAN
The first Bust each fight becomes a Pair

Rules quoted from GDD §3.1. Twelve of the ~90 planned; sets by land grant set bonuses.

# PIPELINE · FROM BASE TO PAINTING

How every environment in this book is made (Art Book Production Guide §4): perspective and scale solved in 3D, colour decided on a flat key, then painted, then overpainted by hand.

## REMAINDER WARDS



1 · 3D BASE (BLENDER)



1B · COLOUR KEY

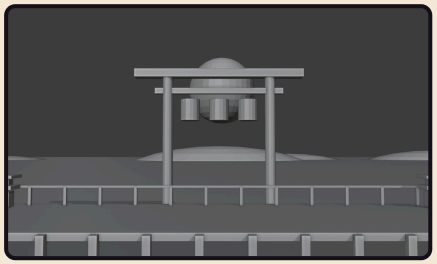
PENDING

2 · PAINT PASS (HIGGSFIELD / FLUX)

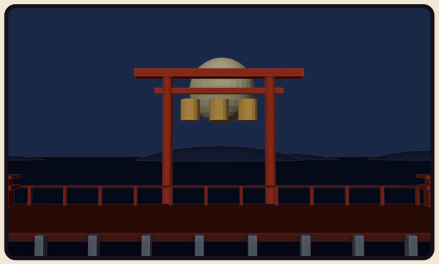
PENDING

3 · HUMAN OVERPAINT

## MOON PIER



1 · 3D BASE (BLENDER)



1B · COLOUR KEY

PENDING

2 · PAINT PASS (HIGGSFIELD / FLUX)

PENDING

3 · HUMAN OVERPAINT

DRAFT v1.0

# ART PENDING

v1.0 is complete as a design bible: every character and land exists as a first-draft 3D blockout at true scale with fixed specs. The register-A paintings fill in over these exact models and cameras, starting with these twelve (Art Book Production Guide §7). Rebuild: python3 tools/build_artbook.py (renders: tools/render_cast.py, tools/build_envs.py, tools/postprocess_renders.py).

1. Meridian Undercity environment painting (register A)
   `stand-in: colour key`
2. Remainder Wards line-up (6 locals)
   `stand-in: design figures + 3D base`
3. Four-eras comparison (4 figures)
   `stand-in: design figures`
4. NIL keyframe (action, graffiti overlay)
   `pass-1 placeholder`
5. NIL design sheet (front/side/back + callouts)
   `stand-in: design figure`
6. Vesper design sheet
   `stand-in: design figure`
7. Maeve design sheet
   `stand-in: design figure`
8. Hina design sheet
   `stand-in: design figure`
9. Hyakki Moon Pier environment painting
   `stand-in: colour key`
10. Hyakki yokai line-up (Night Parade)
    `pass-1 placeholder`
11. Varro keyframe
    `stand-in: design figure`
12. Tamamo keyframe
    `stand-in: design figure`